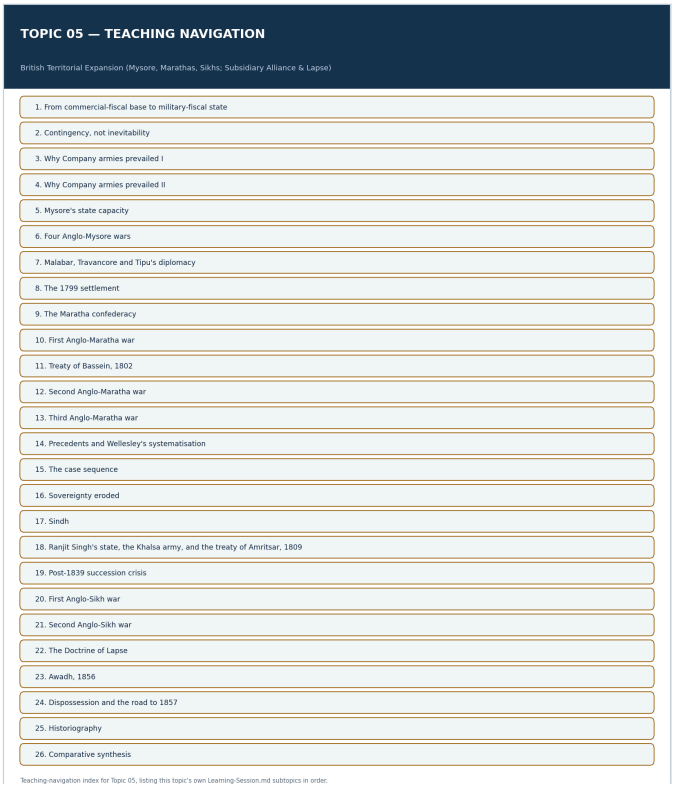
COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

# British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs; Subsidiary Alliance & Lapse) - Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing




*Study visual for this topic; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.*

Built from this topic's own repository knowledge and clearly marked current linkage. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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# British Territorial Expansion (Mysore, Marathas, Sikhs; Subsidiary Alliance & Lapse) - Complete Learning Session

## BASIC LEARNING SESSION

### DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

| Control | Binding rule for this package |
|---|---|
| Syllabus boundary | Complete Modern History Core is taught chronologically and causally before optional enrichment. |
| Evidence method | Claim -> named Act/treaty/record/organisation/person/region or scholarly evidence -> analysis -> qualification. |
| Date discipline | Event, proposal, enactment, commencement, official policy, implementation and later interpretation remain distinct. |
| Historiography | Colonial, nationalist, Marxist, subaltern, Cambridge, feminist and other relevant arguments are attributed and tested, never used as labels alone. |
| Practice contract | Every solved item has demand decoding, an examiner-grade model, an executable answer/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement. |
| Approval | This immutable successor remains `approved: false` pending explicit approval. |

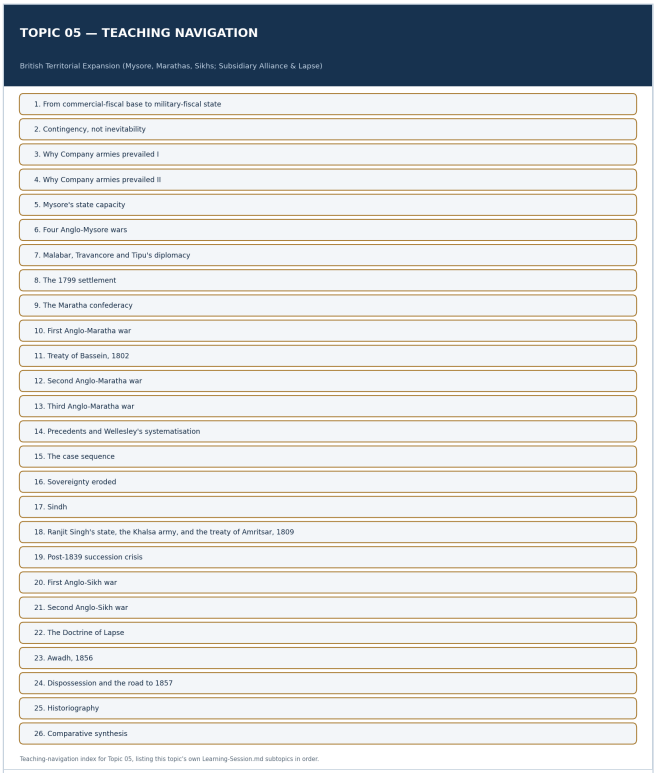
**Canonical Basic/Core owner:** `upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\basic\05_British-Territorial-Expansion.md` **Canonical topic owner:** `upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\basic\05_British-Territorial-Expansion.md` **Optional Advanced owner:** `upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\advanced\05_British-Territorial-Expansion.md` **Official syllabus mapping:** `upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Modern-Indian-History\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md`

### EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Official and primary evidence:** Acts, charters, treaties, proclamations, committee reports, proceedings, organisational resolutions, speeches and contemporary records are dated and read for authorship and purpose.
- **Regional and social evidence:** petitions, newspapers, memoirs, local studies and material geography qualify elite or all-India generalisation.
- **Economic and quantitative evidence:** revenue, trade, price, wage, craft and mortality claims retain unit, region, period and uncertainty; statistics are never invented.
- **Scholarly interpretation:** historian schools are competing explanations tied to named evidence, not memorised verdicts.
- **PYQ discipline:** repository ledgers and locally held official papers control wording and metadata; reconstructed wording and unavailable official keys remain explicitly labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-04:** ASI's 2025-26 Srirangapatna sub-circle maintenance tender and Bangalore Circle museum-building expression of interest establish an official, current heritage-management link for Tipu-era sites. They are used only for heritage continuity, not as evidence for eighteenth-century military causation.

**Live/primary context sources:**

- `https://asi.nic.in/HQ/tenders/?p=12`
- `https://asi.nic.in/admin/jobsvacancie/download/42`




*Teaching navigation*

*Embedded teaching-navigation image, listing this topic's own subtopics in order. No separate graphical flowchart package is included with this final package; the standalone register/recall view is the ASCII Master Flowchart deliverable, below.*

### Source audit, progression and syllabus boundary

- **Foundation:** chronology, institutions, actors and exact terminology.
- **Core:** mechanisms, comparisons, causal chains, Indian agency and exam traps.
- **Core synthesis:** historiography, answer architecture, boundaries and bridges.
- **Optional Advanced:** the separate owner is taught only after Basic practice.
- **PYQ integrity:** The verified 2018 Prelims Subsidiary Alliance demand is retained with its locally unavailable official key clearly labelled. The verified 2022 GS-I Company-armies question is this topic's direct Mains owner and is solved in full.

### Live-linkage block

FACT: **Bounded official heritage fact:** ASI's 2025-26 tender list includes maintenance under the Srirangapatna sub-circle, and the Bangalore Circle issued an expression of interest concerning a museum building at the Tipu Sultan Museum, Daria Daulat Bagh.

ANALYSIS: **Inference boundary:** these records establish present heritage management only. They do not prove any claim about the causes, strength or outcome of the Anglo-Mysore Wars.

# SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - 1. FROM COMMERCIAL-FISCAL BASE TO MILITARY-FISCAL STATE: RING-FENCE, BUFFER, SUBSIDIARY DEPENDENCY, PARAMOUNTCY, ANNEXATION

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** British territorial expansion was a graduated process in which the Company moved from protecting buffers to controlling allies and finally annexing selected territories.

**Technical definition:** The expansion ladder joined ring-fence strategy, subsidiary dependency, the claim of paramountcy and direct annexation to a Bengal-financed fiscal-military state.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> Company expansion after 1765 combined changing policy postures with an expanding fiscal-military capacity rather than following one predetermined blueprint.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

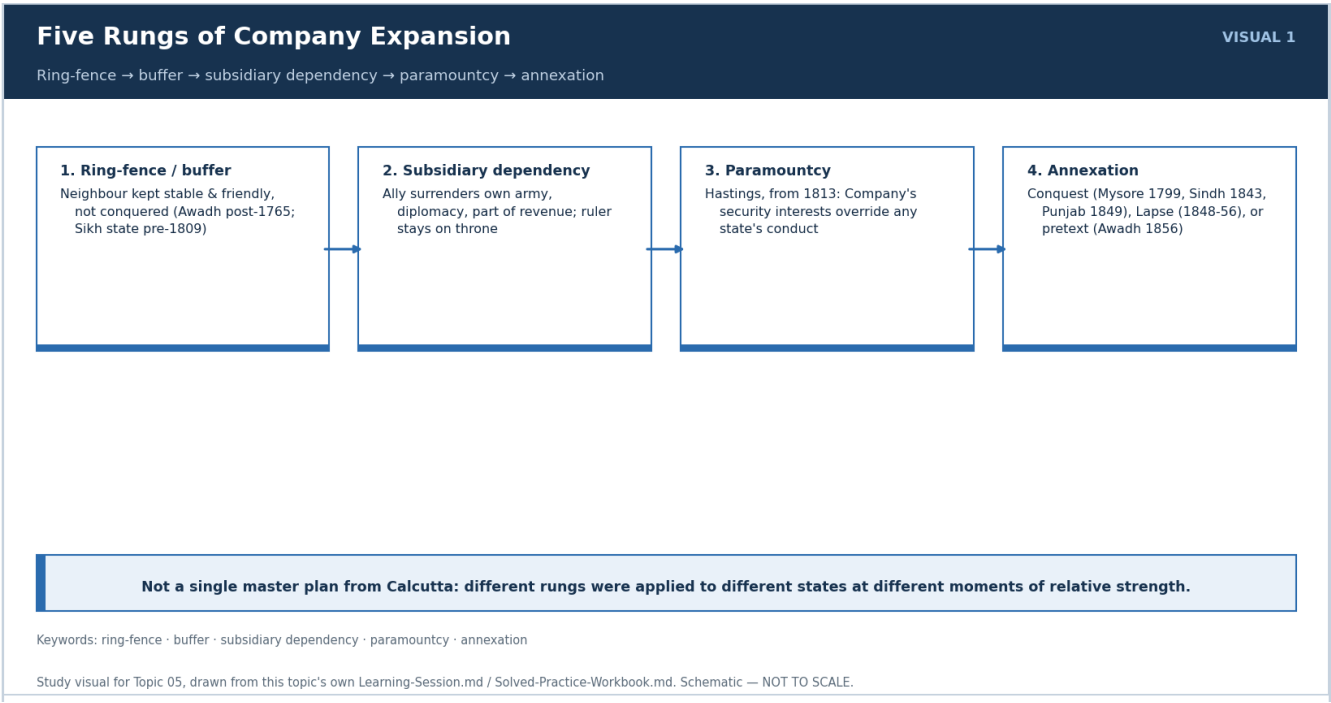
- **ring-fence**
- **buffer**
- **subsidiary dependency**
- **paramountcy**
- **annexation**
- **fiscal-military state**

**How to use them:** Define ring-fence and buffer policy first, show how subsidiary dependency removed effective sovereignty, then connect paramountcy and annexation to the Company's fiscal-military state.

Topic 04 established that Buxar and the 1765 Treaty of Allahabad converted the Company from a trading concern with political leverage into Bengal's direct revenue sovereign. This topic begins where that one ends: it asks how a firm holding one province's Diwani became, within roughly sixty years, the paramount power over virtually the entire subcontinent except the Punjab and Sindh. The honest answer is not a single master plan executed from Calcutta, but a recognisable escalating ladder of policy postures that different Governors-General climbed at different speeds, for different local reasons, using the same underlying fiscal-military capacity built on Bengal's revenues.

FACT: five successive postures recur across this topic and are worth naming precisely, because examiners routinely test whether a candidate can place a specific episode on the correct rung. **Ring-fence/buffer policy** treated a neighbouring state as a security perimeter to be kept stable and friendly, not conquered -- the Company's early stance toward Awadh after 1765 and its early stance toward the Sikh state before 1809 both fit this description. **Subsidiary dependency** (examined fully in Part IV) converted a formally sovereign ally into a state that had surrendered its own army, diplomacy and, often, part of its revenue, while its ruler remained on the throne. **Paramountcy**, a term historians attribute to Lord Hastings's explicit articulation from 1813, asserted that the Company's own security interests entitled it to override, arbitrate, or threaten any Indian state's internal or external conduct, whether or not a subsidiary treaty existed. **Annexation** -- the direct absorption of territory into Company-administered provinces -- was the final rung, reached by outright conquest (Mysore's core territory in 1799, Sindh in 1843, the Punjab in 1849), by succession doctrine (the Lapse cases culminating in 1848-56), or by an administrative pretext (Awadh, 1856).

ANALYSIS: reading these five postures as a ladder, rather than as unrelated episodes, does two things for an answer. First, it explains why the same decade could see the Company simultaneously act as a cautious neighbour (toward the Sikh state before 1839), an intrusive over-lord (toward Hyderabad and Awadh after 1798-1801), and an outright conqueror (toward Mysore in 1799) -- these were not contradictory policies but different rungs applied to different states at different moments of relative strength. Second, it prevents the common error of treating "expansion" as one uniform process; a 15- or 20-mark answer earns marks precisely by naming which rung a given episode belongs to, rather than describing all of Company expansion as generic "conquest."




*Visual 1: five rungs of Company expansion -- ring-fence, buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation*

*Visual 1: five rungs of Company expansion -- ring-fence, buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - 1. FROM COMMERCIAL-FISCAL BASE TO MILITARY-FISCAL STATE: RING-FENCE, BUFFER, SUBSIDIARY DEPENDENCY, PARAMOUNTCY, ANNEXATION

```
START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - 1. From commercial-fiscal base to military-fiscal state: ring-fence,
buffer, subsidiary dependency, paramountcy, annexation
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: ring-fence · buffer · subsidiary dependency · paramountcy · annexation · fiscal-
military state
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Bengal revenue sustained permanent armies and diplomacy, allowing the Company
to isolate opponents, subordinate surviving rulers through subsidiary treaties and absorb
territories through conquest or legal pretexts.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Different regions could simultaneously remain buffers, become dependent
allies or face annexation, while every territorial gain strengthened the resource base for further
expansion.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not treat ring-fence, Subsidiary Alliance, paramountcy and annexation as
synonyms or describe the 1856 territorial map as inevitable from Plassey.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Company expansion after 1765 combined changing policy postures with an
expanding fiscal-military capacity rather than following one predetermined blueprint.
```

# SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - 2. CONTINGENCY, NOT INEVITABILITY: READING TERRITORIAL EXPANSION AS A SEQUENCE OF CHOICES

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** the clearest textbook evidence for genuine contingency is that the Company lost battles and signed treaties it did not dictate on its own terms.

**Technical definition:** The correct formulation, and the one that earns marks in a "was British expansion inevitable" question, is that expansion was structurally favoured but not predetermined: each governor-general's forward policy was itself a contested choice, reversible in principle, whose cumulative effect nonetheless built an increasingly

self-reinforcing advantage.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> the clearest textbook evidence for genuine contingency is that the Company lost battles and signed treaties it did not dictate on its own terms.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **not inevitability**
- **reading territorial expansion as a sequence of choices**
- **structurally favoured but not predetermined**
- **2. Contingency**
- **1767-1856**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define not inevitability, connect reading territorial expansion as a sequence of choices with structurally favoured but not predetermined to explain the mechanism, and use 2. Contingency for the decisive comparison or qualification.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: a persistent temptation in narrating 1767-1856 is to write it backwards -- to treat the 1856 map of British India as the predetermined destination of a single continuous plan set in motion at Plassey. Every governor-generalship examined in this package resists that reading. Company directors in London genuinely wavered between expansion and retrenchment: Warren Hastings's era mixed opportunistic war with real caution; the Court of Directors recalled Wellesley in 1805 specifically because his wars had produced a financial crisis, not because London approved of unlimited conquest; Cornwallis returned in 1805 with explicit non-intervention instructions; and even Dalhousie's annexations were debated, not unanimous, within Company and parliamentary circles of the day. Local governors-general on the spot frequently exceeded, reinterpreted, or reversed instructions from London based on immediate security or revenue calculations, meaning the trajectory of expansion was produced by repeated local decisions, not executed from a single fixed blueprint.

FACT: the clearest textbook evidence for genuine contingency is that the Company lost battles and signed treaties it did not dictate on its own terms. Haidar Ali forced the Madras Council to accept peace on his terms in 1769; the Marathas defeated a British force at Wadgaon in 1779, forcing the humiliating Convention of Wadgaon; the First Anglo-Maratha War ended in 1782 with the negotiated Treaty of Salbai, a genuine settlement rather than a dictated surrender; and Yeshwant Rao Holkar fought Company forces to a standstill in 1804-05, contributing to Wellesley's recall. None of these outcomes fit a narrative of predetermined, uncontested conquest.

ANALYSIS: this does not mean expansion was accidental or that no consistent pattern existed -- the pattern (war, alliance, and annexation feeding a growing fiscal-military base that made the next round of expansion easier) is real and repeats across all three fronts this topic covers. The correct formulation, and the one that earns marks in a "was British expansion inevitable" question, is that expansion was **structurally favoured but not predetermined**: each governor-general's forward policy was itself a contested choice, reversible in principle, whose cumulative effect nonetheless built an increasingly self-reinforcing advantage.

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - 2. CONTINGENCY, NOT INEVITABILITY: READING TERRITORIAL EXPANSION AS A SEQUENCE OF CHOICES

```
START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - 2. Contingency, not inevitability: reading territorial expansion as a
sequence of choices
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · not inevitability · reading territorial expansion as a sequence of
choices · structurally favoured but not predetermined · 2. Contingency · 1767-1856
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Local governors-general on the spot frequently exceeded, reinterpreted, or
reversed instructions from London based on immediate security or revenue calculations, meaning the
trajectory of expansion was produced by repeated local decisions, not executed from a single fixed
blueprint.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The correct formulation, and the one that earns marks in a "was British
expansion inevitable" question, is that expansion was structurally favoured but not predetermined:
each governor-general's forward policy was itself a contested choice, reversible in principle,
whose cumulative effect nonetheless built an increasingly self-reinforcing advantage.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Company directors in London genuinely wavered between expansion and
retrenchment: Warren Hastings's era mixed opportunistic war with real caution; the Court of
Directors recalled Wellesley in 1805 specifically because his wars had produced a financial crisis,
not because London approved of unlimited conquest; Cornwallis returned in 1805 with explicit non-
intervention instructions; and even Dalhousie's annexations were debated, not unanimous, within
Company and parliamentary circles of the day.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: the clearest textbook evidence for genuine contingency is that the
Company lost battles and signed treaties it did not dictate on its own terms.
```

# SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - 3. WHY COMPANY ARMIES PREVAILED I: BENGAL REVENUE, THE SEPOY ARMY, OFFICERS, ARTILLERY AND LOGISTICS

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** FOUNDATION - 3. Why Company armies prevailed I: Bengal revenue, the sepoy army, officers, artillery and logistics comprises FOUNDATION, Bengal revenue and the sepoy army as its core connected dimensions.

**Technical definition:** three structural features distinguished this force from most opposing Indian armies of the period, and each is a legitimate, source-grounded exam point.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> Integrated logistics: a functioning commissariat, credit network and transport system let Company armies sustain campaigns far from their home bases (Wellesley's armies fighting simultaneously in the Deccan and north India in 1803 is the clearest example), whereas several opposing forces depended on more localised, less continuous supply arrangements.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

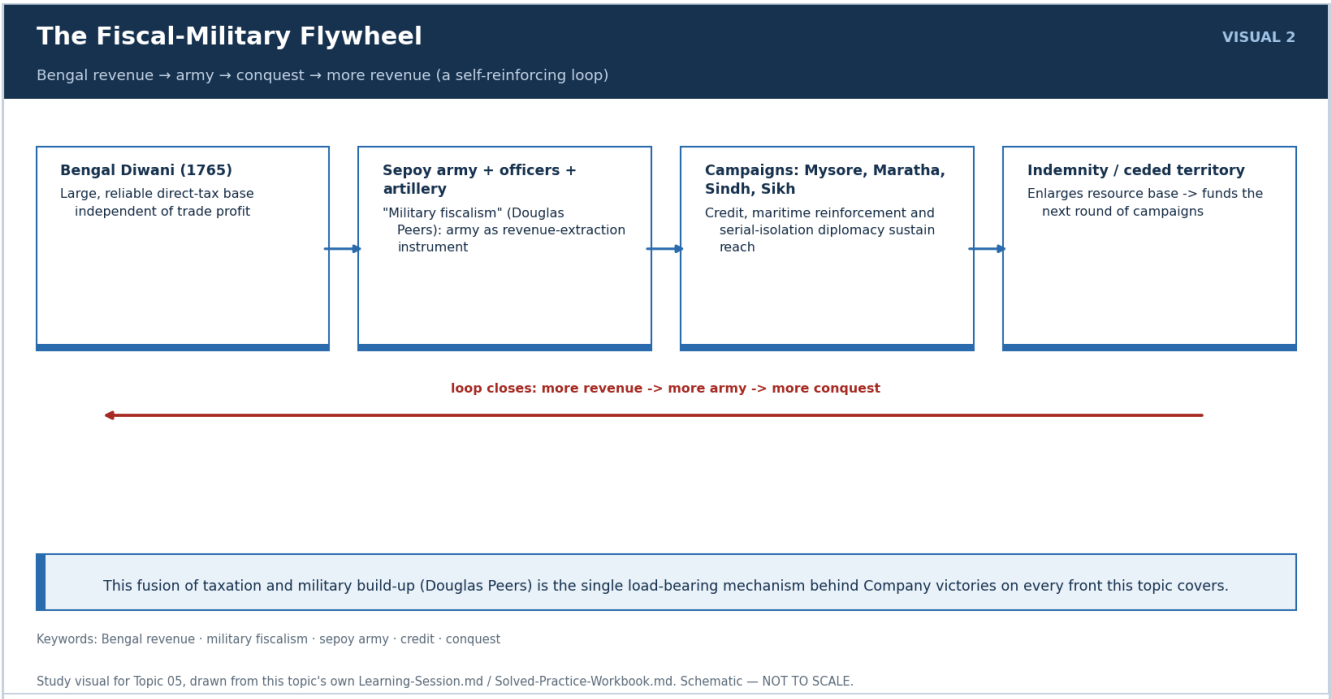
- **FOUNDATION**
- **Bengal revenue**
- **the sepoy army**
- **officers**
- **artillery**
- **3. Why Company armies prevailed I**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define Bengal revenue, connect the sepoy army with officers to explain the mechanism, and use artillery for the decisive comparison or qualification.

**Directly answers the 2022 Mains GS-I Q2 demand** (examined in full as a solved Mains model in Part IX): why did Company armies, mostly Indian soldiers, defeat larger and often well-equipped Indian armies with such consistency? The first and most load-bearing part of the answer is fiscal: Bengal's Diwani, secured in 1765, gave the Company a large, increasingly reliable direct-tax base entirely independent of trade profit or metropolitan remittance, and this revenue is what financed every subsequent campaign this topic covers -- Mysore, Maratha, Sindh and Sikh alike. Historians studying the Company's army (notably Douglas Peers) describe this fusion of taxation and military build-up as a form of **"military fiscalism"**: the army was not merely funded by the state, it was itself one of the state's primary instruments for extracting and defending revenue, creating a self-reinforcing loop between fiscal capacity and military capacity.

FACT: the Company's sepoy armies expanded steadily after the conquest of Bengal and were composed predominantly of Indian soldiers under a comparatively thin European officer corps. Their strategic importance came from permanence, regular finance, drill, artillery support and organised logistics rather than from an unsupported aggregate headcount. Recruitment drew heavily from north Indian military-labour networks, while later expansion brought additional regional groups into Company service.

ANALYSIS: three structural features distinguished this force from most opposing Indian armies of the period, and each is a legitimate, source-grounded exam point. **Permanence and regularity of pay**: soldiers who are paid reliably, in cash, on a fixed schedule are more disciplined and less prone to desertion or extortion of the local population than irregularly paid troops, and several regional Indian states struggled to match this regularity once their own revenue bases were strained by war. **A standing officer corps and artillery arm**: European-trained artillery and engineering officers gave the Company a durable technical edge in siege warfare (decisive at Seringapatam in 1799 and repeatedly in the Maratha wars), even where individual Indian armies matched or exceeded Company numbers. **Integrated logistics**: a functioning commissariat, credit network and transport system let Company armies sustain campaigns far from their home bases (Wellesley's armies fighting simultaneously in the Deccan and north India in 1803 is the clearest example), whereas several opposing forces depended on more localised, less continuous supply arrangements.




*Visual 2: the fiscal-military flywheel -- Bengal revenue, army, conquest, more revenue*

*Visual 2: the fiscal-military flywheel -- Bengal revenue, army, conquest, more revenue. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - 3. WHY COMPANY ARMIES PREVAILED I: BENGAL REVENUE, THE SEPOY ARMY, OFFICERS, ARTILLERY AND LOGISTICS

```
START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - 3. Why Company armies prevailed I: Bengal revenue, the sepoy army,
officers, artillery and logistics
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · Bengal revenue · the sepoy army · officers · artillery · 3. Why Company
armies prevailed I
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the Company's sepoy armies expanded steadily after the conquest of Bengal and
were composed predominantly of Indian soldiers under a comparatively thin European officer corps.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Historians studying the Company's army (notably Douglas Peers) describe
this fusion of taxation and military build-up as a form of "military fiscalism": the army was not
merely funded by the state, it was itself one of the state's primary instruments for extracting and
defending revenue, creating a self-reinforcing loop between fiscal capacity and military capacity.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the first and most load-bearing part
of the answer is fiscal.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Integrated logistics: a functioning commissariat, credit network and
transport system let Company armies sustain campaigns far from their home bases (Wellesley's armies
fighting simultaneously in the Deccan and north India in 1803 is the clearest example), whereas
several opposing forces depended on more localised, less continuous supply arrangements.
```

# SESSION 4 - FOUNDATION - 4. WHY COMPANY ARMIES PREVAILED II: CREDIT AND SUPPLY, MARITIME REINFORCEMENT, DIPLOMACY, SERIAL ISOLATION, INDIAN ALLIES AND RECRUITS -- AND THE COMPANY'S OWN REVERSES

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Diplomacy that produced serial isolation of opponents: this is the single most consistently documented mechanism across all three fronts this topic covers.

**Technical definition:** ANALYSIS: this recruitment and alliance pattern means the "British versus Indians" framing that sometimes appears in popular retellings is imprecise -- a more accurate description, and the one the 2022 PYQ itself invites ("armies... mostly comprising of Indian soldiers"), is that Company campaigns were fought predominantly by Indian personnel under a British-organised fiscal-military and diplomatic system, against other Indian rulers who were rarely able to sustain a comparably durable coalition against it.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> Diplomacy that produced serial isolation of opponents: this is the single most consistently documented mechanism across all three fronts this topic covers.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **credit**
- **supply**
- **maritime reinforcement**
- **diplomacy**
- **4. Why Company armies prevailed II**

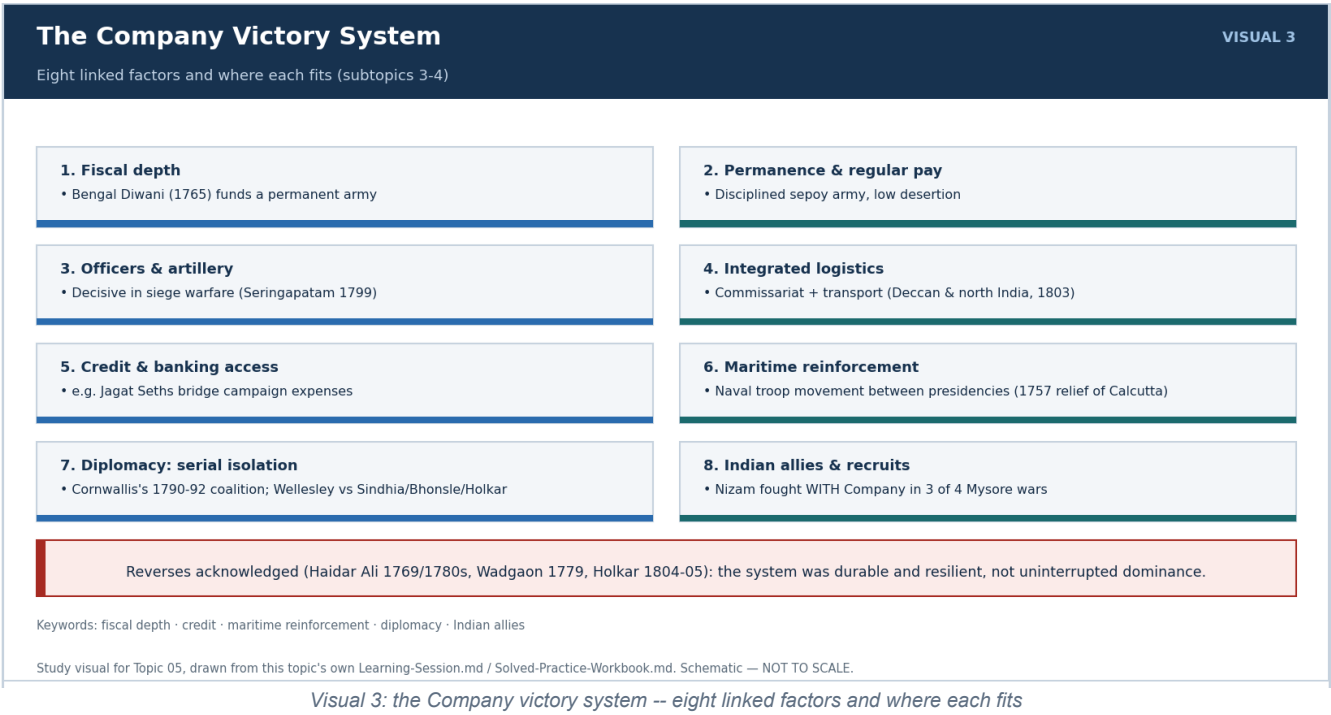
**How to use them:** Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define credit, connect supply with maritime reinforcement to explain the mechanism, and use diplomacy for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: beyond fiscal depth and standing military organisation, the Company drew on three further, well-evidenced advantages. **Credit and banking access**: Company forces could draw on organised credit markets (including, in

Bengal, banking houses such as the Jagat Seths in the Plassey era) to bridge campaign expenses ahead of revenue collection, a facility not every regional treasury could match on comparable terms. **Maritime reinforcement**: naval control of the Bengal, Bombay and Madras coastlines let the Company move troops, artillery and supplies by sea between presidencies faster than most opponents could redeploy overland -- Clive and Watson's relief of Calcutta by sea in January 1757, and the ability to reinforce Madras from Bengal during the Mysore wars, both illustrate this. **Diplomacy that produced serial isolation of opponents**: this is the single most consistently documented mechanism across all three fronts this topic covers. Cornwallis brought the Marathas, the Nizam and the rulers of Travancore and Coorg into alliance against Tipu in the Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92); the same Maratha-Nizam combination had fought alongside the Company against Haidar Ali in the First Anglo-Mysore War, then against the Company in the Second; and Wellesley methodically detached Hyderabad, the restored Mysore state, and then the Peshwa himself from any common front, before finally confronting Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar in sequence rather than together.

FACT: this diplomacy relied heavily on **Indian allies and recruits**, not on Company arms alone. The Nizam of Hyderabad fought alongside the Company against Mysore in three of the four Anglo-Mysore Wars; substantial numbers of Indian soldiers disbanded from defeated Mysorean and Maratha armies were absorbed, where the Company's own recruitment system could accommodate them, into its expanding sepoy ranks; and Company campaigns regularly depended on Indian intelligence networks, supply contractors and local guides. ANALYSIS: this recruitment and alliance pattern means the "British versus Indians" framing that sometimes appears in popular retellings is imprecise -- a more accurate description, and the one the 2022 PYQ itself invites ("armies... mostly comprising of Indian soldiers"), is that Company campaigns were fought predominantly by Indian personnel under a British-organised fiscal-military and diplomatic system, against other Indian rulers who were rarely able to sustain a comparably durable coalition against it.

FACT: this advantage was neither immediate nor unbroken, and any complete answer must include the Company's own limitations and reverses, both to avoid overclaiming and because these episodes are independently examinable. Haidar Ali twice defeated Company forces decisively enough to dictate peace terms (1769 and again through the early 1780s, when he "inflicted one defeat after another" on Company armies in the Carnatic); the Marathas defeated a Company force at Wadgaon in 1779, forcing a full renunciation of gains; and Yeshwant Rao Holkar's mobile Maratha tactics, combined with the Raja of Bharatpur's resistance, inflicted heavy losses on Lord Lake's forces in 1804-05 and contributed directly to Wellesley's recall. In the Anglo-Sikh Wars, the Company suffered severe losses at Ferozeshah (1845) and again at Chillianwala (1849) before recovering to win the decisive engagements that followed. ANALYSIS: including these reverses is not a concession that weakens the "why Company armies won" argument -- it strengthens it, by showing that Company success rested on a durable, resilient system (fiscal depth, replaceable manpower, alliance-building) that could absorb individual defeats, rather than on uninterrupted battlefield dominance.




*Visual 3: the Company victory system -- eight linked factors and where each fits*

*Visual 3: the Company victory system -- eight linked factors and where each fits. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### PART II - MYSORE: HAIDAR ALI AND TIPU SULTAN

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - 4. WHY COMPANY ARMIES PREVAILED II: CREDIT AND SUPPLY, MARITIME REINFORCEMENT, DIPLOMACY, SERIAL ISOLATION, INDIAN ALLIES AND RECRUITS -- AND THE COMPANY'S OWN REVERSES

```
START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - 4. Why Company armies prevailed II: credit and supply, maritime
reinforcement, diplomacy, serial isolation, Indian allies and recruits -- and the Company's own
reverses
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · credit · supply · maritime reinforcement · diplomacy · 4. Why Company
armies prevailed II
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Maritime reinforcement: naval control of the Bengal, Bombay and Madras
coastlines let the Company move troops, artillery and supplies by sea between presidencies faster
than most opponents could redeploy overland -- Clive and Watson's relief of Calcutta by sea in
January 1757, and the ability to reinforce Madras from Bengal during the Mysore wars, both
illustrate this.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The Nizam of Hyderabad fought alongside the Company against Mysore in three
of the four Anglo-Mysore Wars; substantial numbers of Indian soldiers disbanded from defeated
Mysorean and Maratha armies were absorbed, where the Company's own recruitment system could
accommodate them, into its expanding sepoy ranks; and Company campaigns regularly depended on
Indian intelligence networks, supply contractors and local guides.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: ANALYSIS: including these reverses is not a concession that weakens the
"why Company armies won" argument -- it strengthens it, by showing that Company success rested on a
durable, resilient system (fiscal depth, replaceable manpower, alliance-building) that could absorb
individual defeats, rather than on uninterrupted battlefield dominance.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Diplomacy that produced serial isolation of opponents: this is the
single most consistently documented mechanism across all three fronts this topic covers.
```

# SESSION 5 - CORE - 5. MYSORE'S STATE CAPACITY: HAIDAR ALI'S RISE, ARMY REFORM AND TIPU'S "MILITARY FISCALISM"

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** The historian Burton Stein has described Tipu's revenue system as a form of "military fiscalism": taxes collected from a wide base directly by state officials specifically to mobilise resources for a large standing army, part of a deliberate project to build centralised military hegemony in place of the older segmentary, intermediary-sharing structure inherited from Vijayanagara. ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the same underlying logic -- revenue depth converted into permanent military capacity -- that the Company itself was applying at greater scale from its Bengal base (subtopic 3); Mysore is best understood not as a "traditional" state overwhelmed by a "modern" one, but as a rival state pursuing a structurally similar fiscal-military strategy on a smaller territorial and resource base.

**Technical definition:** ANALYSIS: this combination -- genuine, source-attested reform ambition, alongside a resource base that could not fully sustain every ambition -- is the correct, qualified position for an exam answer; overstating Mysore's modernity (claiming it rivalled contemporary European industrial capacity) is as much an error as dismissing Tipu's reforms as mere myth.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> The historian Burton Stein has described Tipu's revenue system as a form of "military fiscalism": taxes collected from a wide base directly by state officials specifically to mobilise resources for a large standing army, part of a deliberate project to build centralised military hegemony in place of the older segmentary, intermediary-sharing structure inherited from Vijayanagara. ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the same underlying logic -- revenue depth converted into permanent military capacity -- that the Company itself was applying at greater scale from its Bengal base (subtopic 3); Mysore is best understood not as a "traditional" state overwhelmed by a "modern" one, but as a rival state pursuing a structurally similar fiscal-military strategy on a smaller territorial and resource base.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

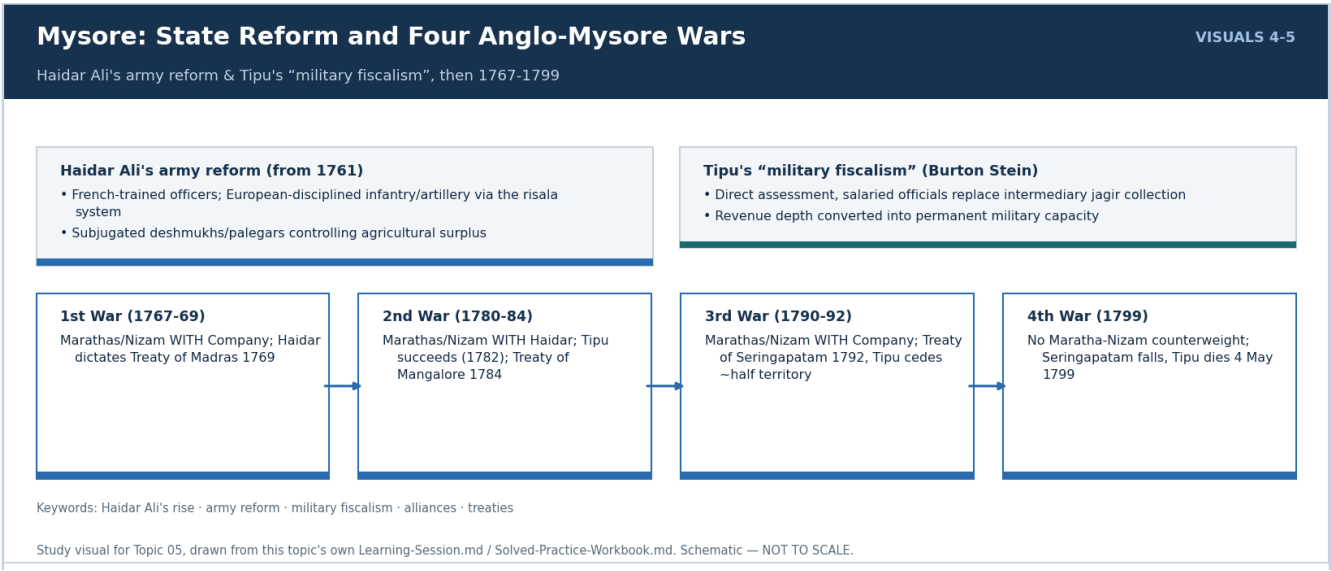
- **Haidar Ali's rise**
- **army reform**
- **Tipu's "military fiscalism"**
- **"military fiscalism"**
- **Haidar**
- **5. Mysore's state capacity**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Haidar Ali's rise; define army reform, connect Tipu's "military fiscalism" with "military fiscalism" to explain the mechanism, and use Haidar for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Mysore rose from a Vijayanagara-era vice-royalty into an assertive regional power across the eighteenth century, with its centralised military authority strengthening from the reign of Chikkadevaraja Wodeyar in the late seventeenth century. Haidar Ali, a man of comparatively humble origin who began as a junior Mysore army officer, rose through military talent and, by 1761, ousted the corrupt dalavai (chief minister) Nanjaraj and effectively took charge of the state, leaving the Wodeyar king as a titular figurehead. Haidar modernised his army with French-trained officers, building an efficient, European-disciplined infantry and artillery organised through the risala system -- fixed-strength units with clear chains of command reporting directly to the ruler -- and used this reformed force to subjugate local hereditary chiefs (deshmukhs and palegars) who had previously controlled the countryside's agricultural surplus.

FACT: Haidar, and after him Tipu Sultan, replaced indirect, intermediary-based land-revenue collection with direct assessment and cash collection by salaried state officials, sharply enlarging the state's own resource base while curbing the older Mughal-derived jagir system. The historian Burton Stein has described Tipu's revenue system as a form of **"military fiscalism"**: taxes collected from a wide base directly by state officials specifically to mobilise resources for a large standing army, part of a deliberate project to build centralised military hegemony in place of the older segmentary, intermediary-sharing structure inherited from Vijayanagara. ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the same underlying logic -- revenue depth converted into permanent military capacity -- that the Company itself was applying at greater scale from its Bengal base (subtopic 3); Mysore is best understood not as a "traditional" state overwhelmed by a "modern" one, but as a rival state pursuing a structurally similar fiscal-military strategy on a smaller territorial and resource base.

FACT: Tipu's ambitions extended beyond the army. His state encouraged agricultural expansion (tax remission for reclaiming wasteland), promoted irrigation repair and new construction, encouraged manufacturing and sericulture, sent missions toward Europe seeking technology, built a navy, and launched what one historian (Irfan Habib, as cited by Sekhar Bandyopadhyay) has been more cautious about, noting that Tipu's modernising ambitions ran well ahead of the state's actual resources, so that Mysore remained, in this reading, "far away from a real opening to modern civilization." Even hostile contemporaries reportedly conceded that Mysore's agriculture and population were among the most flourishing in India of the period. ANALYSIS: this combination -- genuine, source-attested reform ambition, alongside a resource base that could not fully sustain every ambition -- is the correct, qualified position for an exam answer; overstating Mysore's modernity (claiming it rivalled contemporary European industrial capacity) is as much an error as dismissing Tipu's reforms as mere myth.




*Visual 4: Mysore's military-fiscal reform under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan*

*Visual 4: Mysore's military-fiscal reform under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 5. MYSORE'S STATE CAPACITY: HAIDAR ALI'S RISE, ARMY REFORM AND TIPU'S "MILITARY FISCALISM"

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 5. Mysore's state capacity: Haidar Ali's rise, army reform and Tipu's
"military fiscalism"
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Haidar Ali's rise · army reform · Tipu's "military fiscalism" · "military fiscalism" ·
Haidar · 5. Mysore's state capacity
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Haidar, and after him Tipu Sultan, replaced indirect, intermediary-based land-
revenue collection with direct assessment and cash collection by salaried state officials, sharply
enlarging the state's own resource base while curbing the older Mughal-derived jagir system.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: this combination -- genuine, source-attested reform ambition,
alongside a resource base that could not fully sustain every ambition -- is the correct, qualified
position for an exam answer; overstating Mysore's modernity (claiming it rivalled contemporary
European industrial capacity) is as much an error as dismissing Tipu's reforms as mere myth.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: his state encouraged agricultural
expansion (tax remission for reclaiming wasteland), promoted irrigation repair and...
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The historian Burton Stein has described Tipu's revenue system as a
form of "military fiscalism": taxes collected from a wide base directly by state officials
specifically to mobilise resources for a large standing army, part of a deliberate project to build
centralised military hegemony in place of the older segmentary, intermediary-sharing structure
inherited from Vijayanagara. ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the same underlying logic -- revenue depth
converted into permanent military capacity -- that the Company itself was applying at greater scale
from its Bengal base (subtopic 3); Mysore is best understood not as a "traditional" state
overwhelmed by a "modern" one, but as a rival state pursuing a structurally similar fiscal-military
strategy on a smaller territorial and resource base.
```

# SESSION 6 - CORE - 6. FOUR ANGLO-MYSORE WARS: ALLIANCES, TREATIES, MADRAS/MANGALORE/SERINGAPATAM

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** there were four rounds of Company-Mysore warfare, and the alliance pattern across them is itself a classic exam point, because it shifted each time.

**Technical definition:** The resulting Treaty of Seringapatam (1792) required Tipu to cede roughly half his territory to the allies and pay a substantial war indemnity (a scholarly range is cited in different accounts; this package does not assert a single precise sum).

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> there were four rounds of Company-Mysore warfare, and the alliance pattern across them is itself a classic exam point, because it shifted each time.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

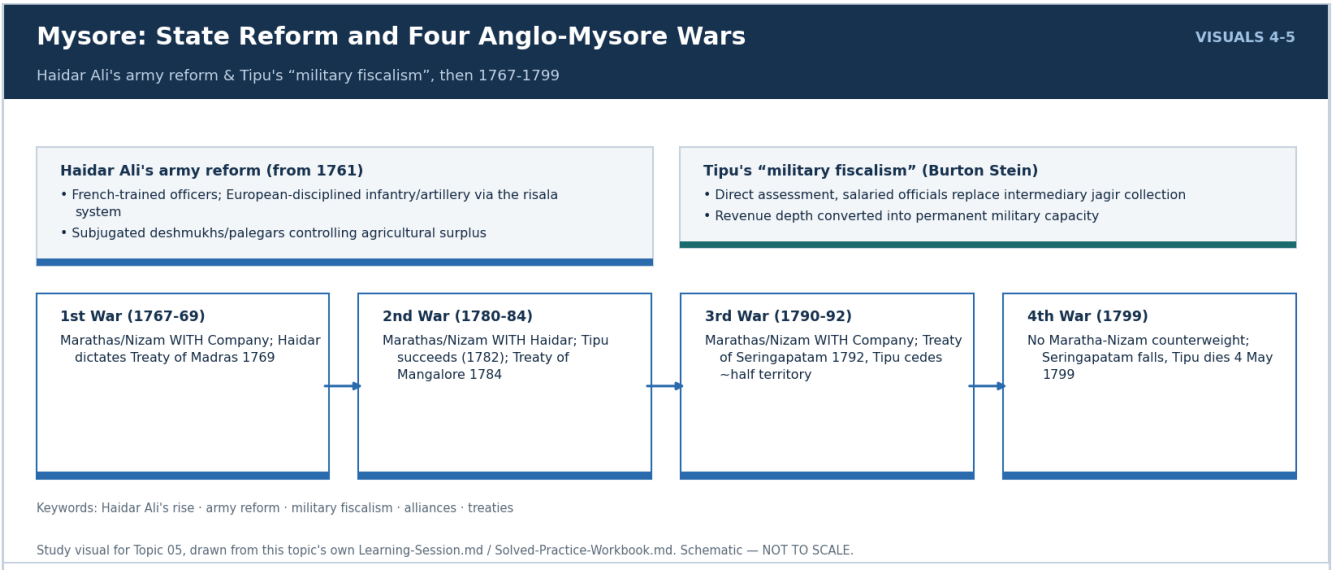
- **alliances**
- **treaties**
- **Madras/Mangalore/Seringapatam**
- **First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69)**
- **Treaty of Madras**
- **6. Four Anglo-Mysore Wars**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through alliances; define treaties, connect Madras/Mangalore/Seringapatam with First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69) to explain the mechanism, and use Treaty of Madras for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: there were four rounds of Company-Mysore warfare, and the alliance pattern across them is itself a classic exam point, because it shifted each time. In the **First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69)**, the Marathas and the Nizam initially stood with the Company against Haidar Ali; Haidar nonetheless defeated Company forces decisively enough to threaten Madras directly in 1769 and dictate peace on his own terms, concluded as the **Treaty of Madras** (1769), a mutual restoration of conquests with a promise of mutual defence that the Company did not honour when the Marathas attacked Haidar in 1771. In the **Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)**, the alliance inverted: the Marathas and the Nizam now joined Haidar against the Company, part of a wider anti-British combination that also drew in the Company's difficulties in the American colonies and against France. Haidar again inflicted repeated defeats on Company forces in the Carnatic; after his death in December 1782, his son Tipu Sultan continued the war, which ended inconclusively with the **Treaty of Mangalore (1784)**, restoring each side's conquests.

FACT: in the **Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92)**, the alliance reverted again: the Marathas and the Nizam sided with the Company, and Lord Cornwallis's forces, together with these allies, defeated Tipu after he attacked the Company's ally the Raja of Travancore. The resulting **Treaty of Seringapatam (1792)** required Tipu to cede roughly half his territory to the allies and pay a substantial war indemnity (a scholarly range is cited in different accounts; this package does not assert a single precise sum). ANALYSIS: the correct exam-ready generalisation is that Mysore's Maratha and Hyderabad neighbours fought *with* the Company in the First and Third wars but *against* it in the Second -- a pattern that shows regional alliance choices were driven by immediate calculations of relative threat, not by any settled "Indian versus British" camp, and that the Company's diplomacy (subtopic 4) worked specifically by keeping that calculation tilted in its favour more often than not.

FACT: the **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)** was fought without a comparable Maratha-Nizam counterweight problem, since Lord Wellesley had already secured Hyderabad's Subsidiary Alliance in 1798 (Part IV) and moved decisively against Tipu after learning of his renewed diplomatic contact with Revolutionary France. The war ended with the fall of Seringapatam and Tipu's death on 4 May 1799, examined in full in subtopic 8.




*Visual 5: four Anglo-Mysore Wars -- shifting alliances and treaties, 1767-1799*

*Visual 5: four Anglo-Mysore Wars -- shifting alliances and treaties, 1767-1799. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 6. FOUR ANGLO-MYSORE WARS: ALLIANCES, TREATIES, MADRAS/MANGALORE/SERINGAPATAM

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 6. Four Anglo-Mysore Wars: alliances, treaties, Madras/Mangalore/
Seringapatam
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: alliances · treaties · Madras/Mangalore/Seringapatam · First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-
69) · Treaty of Madras · 6. Four Anglo-Mysore Wars
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: ANALYSIS: the correct exam-ready generalisation is that Mysore's Maratha and
Hyderabad neighbours fought with the Company in the First and Third wars but against it in the
Second -- a pattern that shows regional alliance choices were driven by immediate calculations of
relative threat, not by any settled "Indian versus British" camp, and that the Company's diplomacy (
subtopic 4) worked specifically by keeping that calculation tilted in its favour more often than
not.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting Treaty of Seringapatam (1792) required Tipu to cede roughly
half his territory to the allies and pay a substantial war indemnity (a scholarly range is cited in
different accounts; this package does not assert a single precise sum).
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: haidar again inflicted repeated
defeats on Company forces in the Carnatic.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: there were four rounds of Company-Mysore warfare, and the alliance
pattern across them is itself a classic exam point, because it shifted each time.
```

# SESSION 7 - CORE - 7. MALABAR, TRAVANCORE AND TIPU'S DIPLOMACY: THE FRENCH CONNECTION WITHOUT MYTH

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** CORE - 7. Malabar, Travancore and Tipu's diplomacy: the French connection without myth comprises Travancore, Tipu's diplomacy and the French connection without myth as its core connected dimensions.

**Technical definition:** The historically correct, balanced position is therefore: Tipu's outreach to France was real and diplomatically significant, but the scale of "French threat" invoked by Wellesley to justify the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War substantially outran the actual military probability of French intervention, and functioned at least as much as a pretext for a war Wellesley had independent reasons to want.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> this is also the right place to state, without cultural caricature, why Mysore's resistance nonetheless ultimately failed despite genuine military and administrative reform: Tipu fought without a durable regional coalition (the Marathas and the Nizam were with the Company in three of the four wars), his territorial ambitions in Malabar and against Travancore created additional regional friction that the Company's diplomacy could exploit, and his single state's resource base -- however impressively mobilised -- could not indefinitely outlast a Company drawing on the combined and growing fiscal capacity of Bengal, Madras and an expanding alliance network.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Travancore**
- **Tipu's diplomacy**
- **the French connection without myth**
- **Haidar Ali**
- **7. Malabar**
- **1789-90**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Travancore; define Tipu's diplomacy, connect the French connection without myth with Haidar Ali to explain the mechanism, and use 7. Malabar for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Haidar Ali had invaded and annexed Malabar and Calicut in 1766, extending Mysore's reach to the Kerala coast and its lucrative pepper, sandalwood and cardamom trade; this expansion brought Mysore into recurring friction with both the Marathas (whose own reach extended along the Konkan-Malabar coast) and with the Raja of Travancore, whose territory bordered Mysore's southern Malabar holdings. Tipu's 1789-90 attack on Travancore -- a state under Company protection -- supplied Lord Cornwallis's direct pretext for the Third Anglo-Mysore War. Tipu had also, in the mid-1780s, imposed export embargoes on pepper, sandalwood and cardamom through his ports and restricted English traders' dealings, directly threatening Company and private-merchant commercial interests in the region -- a commercial friction that sat alongside, and reinforced, the wider strategic rivalry.

FACT: Tipu did pursue genuine diplomatic overtures toward Revolutionary France, including missions seeking European technological and military assistance, and separately sent missions toward Afghanistan, Arabia and Turkey seeking anti-British alliances; he was also reported to have invited Zaman Shah, the ruler of Kabul, to join a concerted effort against the Company in northern India. ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: contemporary British officials treated the French connection as an urgent existential threat, but this threat perception has been read by later historians (Edward Ingram's assessment of the period, as reported by Sekhar Bandyopadhyay) as substantially exaggerated relative to the real likelihood of an actual French invasion of British India by the late 1790s -- there was little realistic prospect of a French landing via Egypt or the Cape by that date. The historically correct, balanced position is therefore: Tipu's outreach to France was real and diplomatically significant, but the scale of "French threat" invoked by Wellesley to justify the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War substantially outran the actual military probability of French intervention, and functioned at least as much as a pretext for a war Wellesley had independent reasons to want.

ANALYSIS: this is also the right place to state, without cultural caricature, why Mysore's resistance nonetheless ultimately failed despite genuine military and administrative reform: Tipu fought without a durable regional coalition (the Marathas and the Nizam were with the Company in three of the four wars), his territorial ambitions in Malabar and against Travancore created additional regional friction that the Company's diplomacy could exploit, and his single state's resource base -- however impressively mobilised -- could not indefinitely outlast a Company drawing on the combined and growing fiscal capacity of Bengal, Madras and an expanding alliance network. Mysore's defeat is therefore a story of a genuinely capable, reforming state defeated by structural and diplomatic isolation, not a story of Indian military or administrative backwardness.

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 7. MALABAR, TRAVANCORE AND TIPU'S DIPLOMACY: THE FRENCH CONNECTION WITHOUT MYTH

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 7. Malabar, Travancore and Tipu's diplomacy: the French connection without
myth
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Travancore · Tipu's diplomacy · the French connection without myth · Haidar Ali · 7.
Malabar · 1789-90
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Tipu did pursue genuine diplomatic overtures toward Revolutionary France,
including missions seeking European technological and military assistance, and separately sent
missions toward Afghanistan, Arabia and Turkey seeking anti-British alliances; he was also reported
to have invited Zaman Shah, the ruler of Kabul, to join a concerted effort against the Company in
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an urgent existential threat, but this threat perception has been read by later historians (Edward
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exaggerated relative to the real likelihood of an actual French invasion of British India by the
late 1790s -- there was little realistic prospect of a French landing via Egypt or the Cape by that
date.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The historically correct, balanced position is therefore: Tipu's outreach
to France was real and diplomatically significant, but the scale of "French threat" invoked by
Wellesley to justify the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War substantially outran the actual military
probability of French intervention, and functioned at least as much as a pretext for a war
Wellesley had independent reasons to want.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mysore's defeat is therefore a story of a genuinely capable, reforming
state defeated by structural and diplomatic isolation, not a story of Indian military or
administrative backwardness.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: this is also the right place to state, without cultural caricature,
why Mysore's resistance nonetheless ultimately failed despite genuine military and administrative
reform: Tipu fought without a durable regional coalition (the Marathas and the Nizam were with the
Company in three of the four wars), his territorial ambitions in Malabar and against Travancore
created additional regional friction that the Company's diplomacy could exploit, and his single
state's resource base -- however impressively mobilised -- could not indefinitely outlast a Company
drawing on the combined and growing fiscal capacity of Bengal, Madras and an expanding alliance
network.
```

# SESSION 8 - CORE - 8. THE 1799 SETTLEMENT: SERINGAPATAM, WODEYAR RESTORATION, SUBSIDIARY CONTROL, AND WHY RESISTANCE FAILED

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: the sequence -- war, territorial partition, restoration of a pliable dynasty, and immediate subsidiary subordination -- is the template Wellesley then extended methodically across the rest of India (Part IV); Mysore in 1799 is best read as the opening, most militarily decisive case of a pattern that would recur, in less violent form, at Hyderabad, Awadh, Poona and elsewhere.

**Technical definition:** The reduced core of Mysore was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty -- the original royal line that Haidar Ali had displaced decades earlier -- but the restored Raja was immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance treaty (Part IV) that authorised the Governor-General to assume the administration of the state if judged necessary, making Mysore, in substance, a complete dependency of the Company from 1799 onward.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> The reduced core of Mysore was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty -- the original royal line that Haidar Ali had displaced decades earlier -- but the restored Raja was immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance treaty (Part IV) that authorised the Governor-General to assume the administration of the state if judged necessary, making Mysore, in substance, a complete dependency of the Company from 1799 onward.

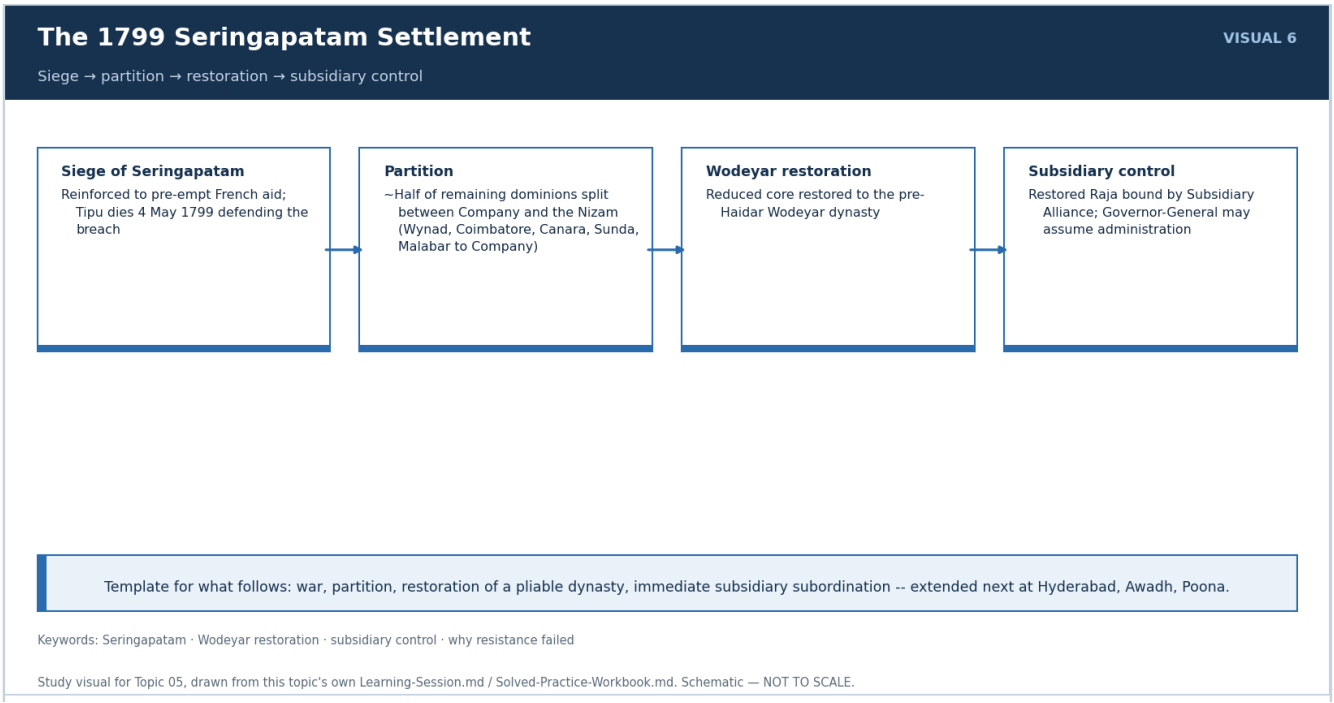
## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Seringapatam**
- **Wodeyar restoration**
- **subsidiary control**
- **why resistance failed**
- **Company's**
- **8. The 1799 settlement**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Seringapatam; define Wodeyar restoration, connect subsidiary control with why resistance failed to explain the mechanism, and use Company's for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: the Company's army, reinforced to prevent any French assistance from reaching Tipu in time, defeated Mysore's forces and stormed Seringapatam; Tipu died on 4 May 1799 defending his capital, and his army is recorded as having remained loyal to him through the city's fall. Nearly half of Tipu's remaining dominions were divided between the Company and its ally the Nizam, with some territory (including Wynad, Coimbatore, Canara and Sunda, and the Malabar coast) annexed directly by the Company and folded into an enlarged Madras Presidency together with the absorbed Carnatic. The reduced core of Mysore was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty -- the original royal line that Haidar Ali had displaced decades earlier -- but the restored Raja was immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance treaty (Part IV) that authorised the Governor-General to assume the administration of the state if judged necessary, making Mysore, in substance, a complete dependency of the Company from 1799 onward.

FACT: an important, separate result of the Fourth Anglo-Mysore War was the elimination of any realistic French foothold or influence in southern India, removing the strategic justification Wellesley himself had most emphasised for the campaign. ANALYSIS: the sequence -- war, territorial partition, restoration of a pliable dynasty, and immediate subsidiary subordination -- is the template Wellesley then extended methodically across the rest of India (Part IV); Mysore in 1799 is best read as the opening, most militarily decisive case of a pattern that would recur, in less violent form, at Hyderabad, Awadh, Poona and elsewhere.




*Visual 6: the 1799 Seringapatam settlement -- siege, partition, restoration, subsidiary control*

*Visual 6: the 1799 Seringapatam settlement -- siege, partition, restoration, subsidiary control. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## PART III - THE MARATHAS

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 8. THE 1799 SETTLEMENT: SERINGAPATAM, WODEYAR RESTORATION, SUBSIDIARY CONTROL, AND WHY RESISTANCE FAILED

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 8. The 1799 settlement: Seringapatam, Wodeyar restoration, subsidiary
control, and why resistance failed
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Seringapatam · Wodeyar restoration · subsidiary control · why resistance failed ·
Company's · 8. The 1799 settlement
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the Company's army, reinforced to prevent any French assistance from reaching
Tipu in time, defeated Mysore's forces and stormed Seringapatam; Tipu died on 4 May 1799 defending
his capital, and his army is recorded as having remained loyal to him through the city's fall.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: the sequence -- war, territorial partition, restoration of a
pliable dynasty, and immediate subsidiary subordination -- is the template Wellesley then extended
methodically across the rest of India (Part IV); Mysore in 1799 is best read as the opening, most
militarily decisive case of a pattern that would recur, in less violent form, at Hyderabad, Awadh,
Poona and elsewhere.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: an important, separate result of the
Fourth Anglo-Mysore War was the elimination of any...
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The reduced core of Mysore was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty -- the
original royal line that Haidar Ali had displaced decades earlier -- but the restored Raja was
immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance treaty (Part IV) that authorised the Governor-General to
assume the administration of the state if judged necessary, making Mysore, in substance, a complete
dependency of the Company from 1799 onward.
```

# SESSION 9 - CORE - 9. THE MARATHA CONFEDERACY: STRUCTURE, FIVE HOUSES, AND THE COST OF A HEADLESS POLITY

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** (Topic 02 owns the Marathas' eighteenth-century rise and internal state structure in full; this subtopic recaps only what is load-bearing for the Company wars that follow.).

**Technical definition:** Technically, CORE - 9. The Maratha confederacy: structure, five houses, and the cost of a headless polity is analysed by relating structure to five houses, then testing the relationship through the cost of a headless polity and Topic.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> (Topic 02 owns the Marathas' eighteenth-century rise and internal state structure in full; this subtopic recaps only what is load-bearing for the Company wars that follow.).

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

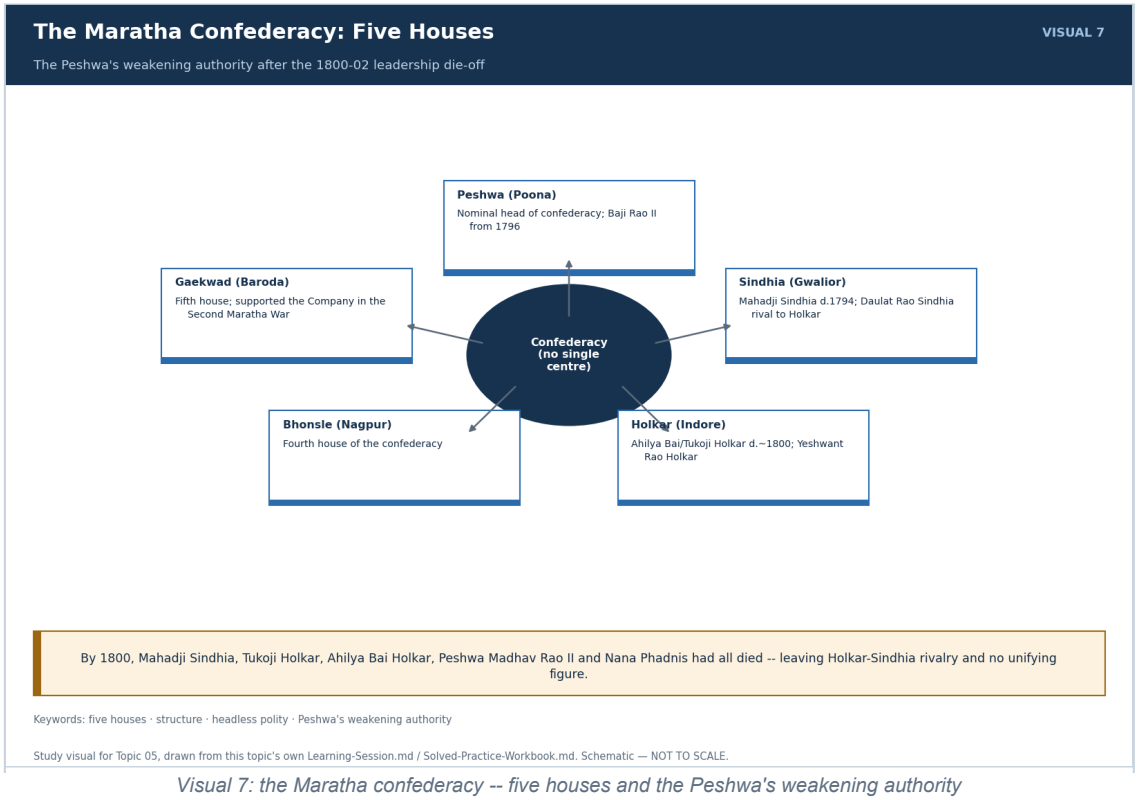
- **structure**
- **five houses**
- **the cost of a headless polity**
- **Topic**
- **Marathas**
- **9. The Maratha confederacy**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through structure; define five houses, connect the cost of a headless polity with Topic to explain the mechanism, and use Marathas for the decisive comparison or qualification.

*(Topic 02 owns the Marathas' eighteenth-century rise and internal state structure in full; this subtopic recaps only what is load-bearing for the Company wars that follow.)*

FACT: by the later eighteenth century, Maratha power was organised as a confederacy of five major houses -- the Peshwa at Poona (nominal head of the confederacy), the Sindhia (Scindia) of Gwalior, the Holkar of Indore, the Bhonsle of Nagpur, and the Gaekwad of Baroda -- rather than as a single centralised kingdom. This structure had given Maratha power its remarkable eighteenth-century territorial reach, but it also meant the confederacy's cohesion depended heavily on a small number of capable individual leaders and on the Peshwa's personal authority to arbitrate disputes among the houses. FACT: by 1800, a cluster of the confederacy's most experienced leaders -- Mahadji Sindhia, Tukoji Holkar, Ahilya Bai Holkar, Peshwa Madhav Rao II and the long-serving minister Nana Phadnis, who had held the confederacy together for roughly three decades -- had all died, leaving a younger, more fractious generation of chiefs, most visibly Yeshwant Rao Holkar and Daulat Rao Sindhia, locked in open rivalry with each other and with Peshwa Baji Rao II.

ANALYSIS: this matters for the whole of Part III because it explains, without denying Maratha agency or military capacity, why the Company could repeatedly apply its own "serial isolation" diplomacy (subtopic 4) against the Marathas specifically: a confederacy whose constituent houses did not trust one another, and periodically fought each other directly (Holkar's defeat of the combined Peshwa-Sindhia force at Poona in October 1802 is the clearest single example), gave the Company recurring openings to negotiate with, subordinate, or defeat one house without facing a unified Maratha response. The Marathas' military capacity was real and repeatedly demonstrated on the battlefield (subtopics 10-13); their vulnerability was structural and political, not a lack of fighting ability.




*Visual 7: the Maratha confederacy -- five houses and the Peshwa's weakening authority*

*Visual 7: the Maratha confederacy -- five houses and the Peshwa's weakening authority. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 9. THE MARATHA CONFEDERACY: STRUCTURE, FIVE HOUSES, AND THE COST OF A HEADLESS POLITY

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 9. The Maratha confederacy: structure, five houses, and the cost of a
headless polity
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: structure · five houses · the cost of a headless polity · Topic · Marathas · 9. The
Maratha confederacy
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: by the later eighteenth century, Maratha power was organised as a confederacy
of five major houses -- the Peshwa at Poona (nominal head of the confederacy), the Sindhia (
Scindia) of Gwalior, the Holkar of Indore, the Bhonsle of Nagpur, and the Gaekwad of Baroda --
rather than as a single centralised kingdom.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: this matters for the whole of Part III because it explains, without denying
Maratha agency or military capacity, why the Company could repeatedly apply its own "serial
isolation" diplomacy (subtopic 4) against the Marathas specifically: a confederacy whose
constituent houses did not trust one another, and periodically fought each other directly (Holkar's
defeat of the combined Peshwa-Sindhia force at Poona in October 1802 is the clearest single
example), gave the Company recurring openings to negotiate with, subordinate, or defeat one house
without facing a unified Maratha response.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: This structure had given Maratha power its remarkable eighteenth-century
territorial reach, but it also meant the confederacy's cohesion depended heavily on a small number
of capable individual leaders and on the Peshwa's personal authority to arbitrate disputes among
the houses.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: (Topic 02 owns the Marathas' eighteenth-century rise and internal
state structure in full; this subtopic recaps only what is load-bearing for the Company wars that
follow.).
```

# SESSION 10 - CORE - 10. FIRST ANGLO-MARATHA WAR: RAGHUNATH RAO, SURAT, PURANDAR, WADGAON, SALBAI

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** the First Anglo-Maratha War (1775-82) originated in a Maratha succession dispute: Raghunath Rao, implicated in the killing of his nephew Peshwa Narayan Rao, was opposed by the confederacy's other sardars under the young Peshwa Madhav Rao II and the minister Nana Phadnis, and turned to the Company's Bombay establishment for support.

**Technical definition:** the Calcutta government's own negotiators instead concluded the inconclusive Treaty of Purandar (1776), under which the Company withdrew support from Raghunath Rao in exchange for concessions, but this settlement was not honoured by all parties and fighting resumed in 1777-79.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> In 1775 the Bombay government agreed to back Raghunath Rao's claim, and after his forces were defeated in Gujarat, offered him direct support -- an intervention traditionally associated with an agreement (the Treaty of Surat) trading Company backing for territorial and revenue concessions from Raghunath Rao, though this early Bombay-led initiative was not ratified by the Company's Calcutta authorities.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

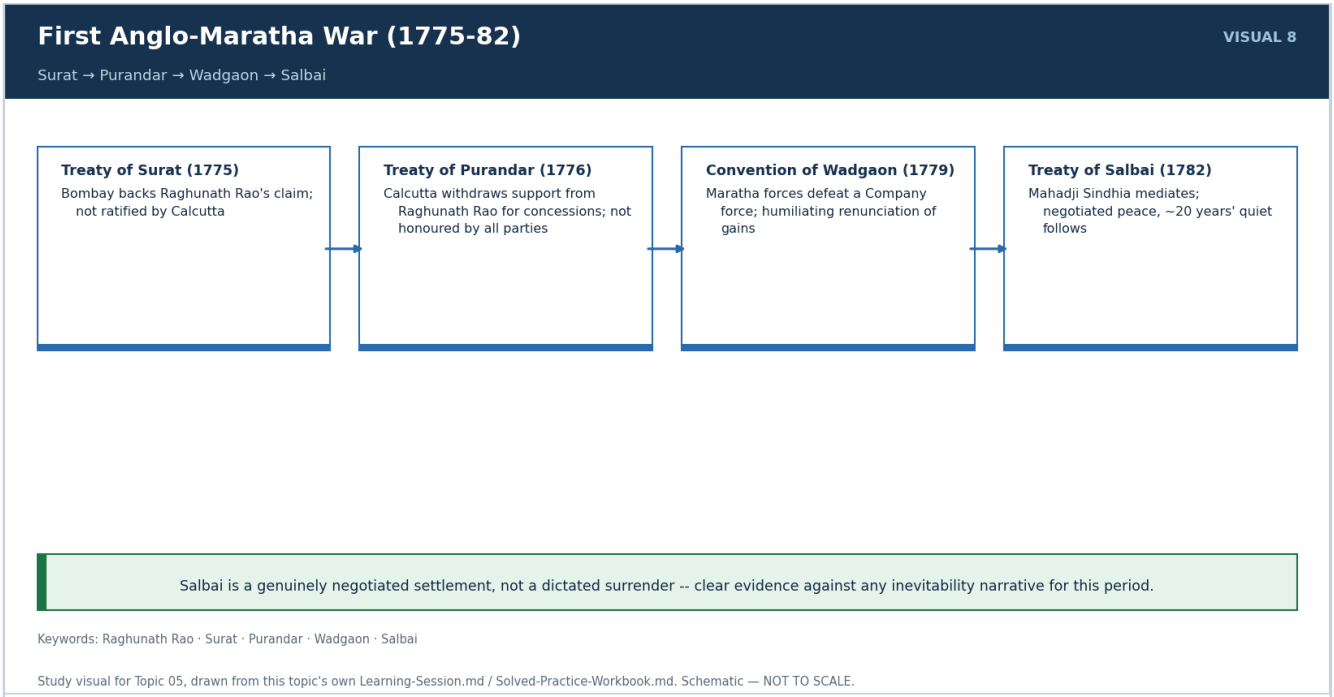
- **Raghunath Rao**
- **Surat**
- **Purandar**
- **Wadgaon**
- **Salbai**
- **10. First Anglo-Maratha War**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Raghunath Rao; define Surat, connect Purandar with Wadgaon to explain the mechanism, and use Salbai for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: the First Anglo-Maratha War (1775-82) originated in a Maratha succession dispute: Raghunath Rao, implicated in the killing of his nephew Peshwa Narayan Rao, was opposed by the confederacy's other sardars under the young Peshwa Madhav Rao II and the minister Nana Phadnis, and turned to the Company's Bombay establishment for support. In 1775 the Bombay government agreed to back Raghunath Rao's claim, and after his forces were defeated in Gujarat, offered him direct support -- an intervention traditionally associated with an agreement (the Treaty of Surat) trading Company backing for territorial and revenue concessions from Raghunath Rao, though this early Bombay-led initiative was not ratified by the Company's Calcutta authorities.

FACT: the Calcutta government's own negotiators instead concluded the inconclusive **Treaty of Purandar (1776)**, under which the Company withdrew support from Raghunath Rao in exchange for concessions, but this settlement was not honoured by all parties and fighting resumed in 1777-79. A Bombay force advancing toward Poona was defeated and encircled by regrouped Maratha forces under Nana Phadnis, Sindhia and Holkar, forcing the humiliating **Convention/Treaty of Wadgaon (1779)**, by which the English renounced all their conquests and abandoned Raghunath Rao's cause outright. Warren Hastings, then Governor-General at Calcutta, refused to accept this reverse as final: a Bengal force under Goddard marched across central India and captured Ahmedabad in 1780, demonstrating that the Company could sustain a war effort even after a serious battlefield defeat, while Mahadji Sindhia's continued military strength meant neither side could force a decisive result.

FACT: peace was concluded through Mahadji Sindhia's mediation in the **Treaty of Salbai (1782)**, which restored the pre-war status quo between the Company and the Marathas and secured roughly twenty years of peace between them -- a genuinely negotiated settlement, not a dictated surrender, and clear evidence against any inevitability narrative for this period. ANALYSIS: Salbai's importance runs beyond its own terms: it gave the Company two decades to consolidate Bengal governance largely undisturbed by Maratha pressure, while the Maratha chiefs spent much of the same period in internal rivalry rather than renewed external expansion -- and it further indirectly enabled the Company to press Mysore in the Third Anglo-Mysore War, since the Marathas had separately promised cooperation against Haidar Ali as part of the wider settlement climate of the early 1780s.




*Visual 8: First Anglo-Maratha War -- Surat to Purandar to Wadgaon to Salbai*

*Visual 8: First Anglo-Maratha War -- Surat to Purandar to Wadgaon to Salbai. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 10. FIRST ANGLO-MARATHA WAR: RAGHUNATH RAO, SURAT, PURANDAR, WADGAON, SALBAI

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 10. First Anglo-Maratha War: Raghunath Rao, Surat, Purandar, Wadgaon, Salbai
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Raghunath Rao · Surat · Purandar · Wadgaon · Salbai · 10. First Anglo-Maratha War
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the First Anglo-Maratha War (1775-82) originated in a Maratha succession
dispute: Raghunath Rao, implicated in the killing of his nephew Peshwa Narayan Rao, was opposed by
the confederacy's other sardars under the young Peshwa Madhav Rao II and the minister Nana Phadnis,
and turned to the Company's Bombay establishment for support.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: the Calcutta government's own negotiators instead concluded the
inconclusive Treaty of Purandar (1776), under which the Company withdrew support from Raghunath Rao
in exchange for concessions, but this settlement was not honoured by all parties and fighting
resumed in 1777-79.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: peace was concluded through Mahadji Sindhia's mediation in the Treaty of
Salbai (1782), which restored the pre-war status quo between the Company and the Marathas and
secured roughly twenty years of peace between them -- a genuinely negotiated settlement, not a
dictated surrender, and clear evidence against any inevitability narrative for this period.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: In 1775 the Bombay government agreed to back Raghunath Rao's claim,
and after his forces were defeated in Gujarat, offered him direct support -- an intervention
traditionally associated with an agreement (the Treaty of Surat) trading Company backing for
territorial and revenue concessions from Raghunath Rao, though this early Bombay-led initiative was
not ratified by the Company's Calcutta authorities.
```

# SESSION 11 - CORE - 11. TREATY OF BASSEIN, 1802: THE TURNING POINT

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** The Treaty of Bassein was the Peshwa's 1802 Subsidiary Alliance with the Company after his defeat and flight from Pune.

**Technical definition:** Bassein transferred the Peshwa's defence and external relations to Company control through a permanent subsidiary force, territorial support, a Resident and restrictions on independent diplomacy and European employment.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> The Treaty of Bassein converted a Maratha succession and confederate conflict into a constitutional subordination of the Peshwa and a wider Company-Maratha war.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

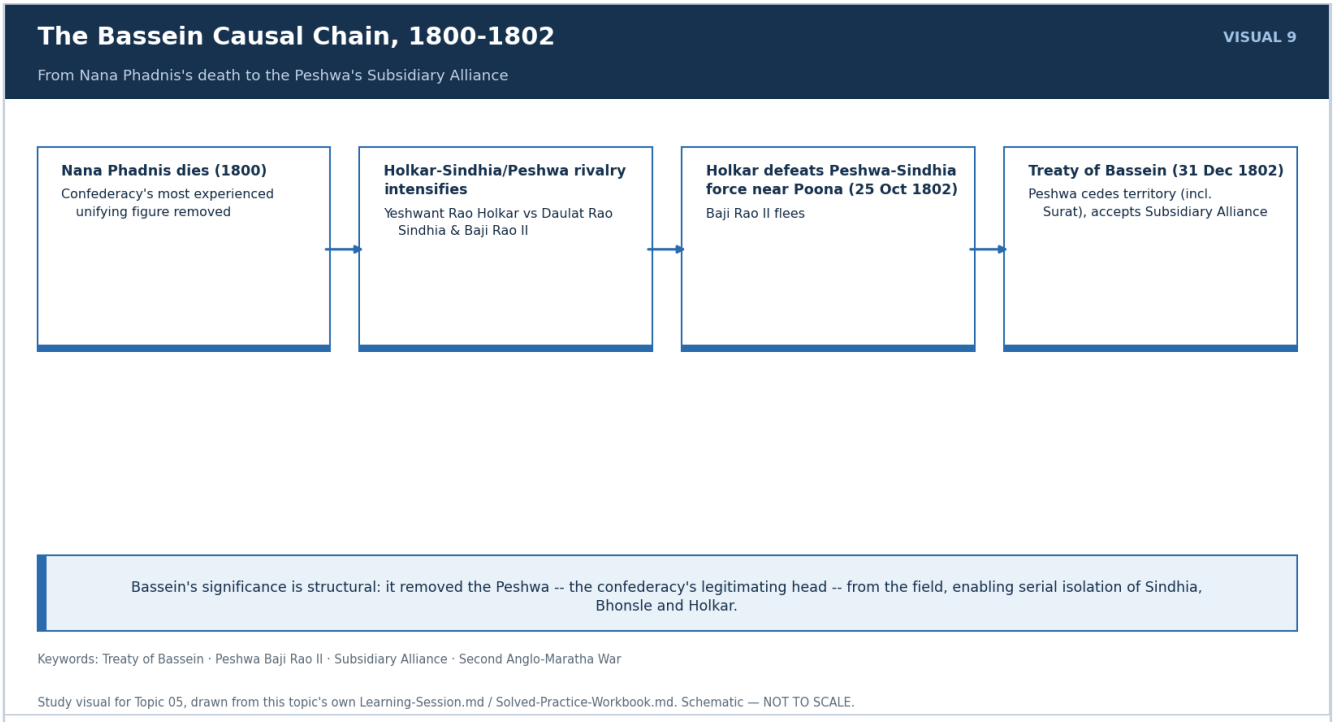
- **Treaty of Bassein**
- **Peshwa Baji Rao II**
- **Subsidiary Alliance**
- **Company control**
- **Maratha confederacy**
- **Second Anglo-Maratha War**

**How to use them:** Begin with Peshwa Baji Rao II's defeat by Holkar, define the Treaty of Bassein as a Subsidiary Alliance, trace the transfer to Company control and then connect Maratha confederacy opposition to the Second Anglo-Maratha War.

FACT: Lord Wellesley repeatedly offered a Subsidiary Alliance to the Peshwa and to Sindhia during the years around 1800, and the far-sighted Nana Phadnis had consistently refused. Nana Phadnis's death in 1800, however, removed the confederacy's most experienced check on internal rivalry, and the succession-era feuding examined in subtopic 9

intensified sharply between Yeshwant Rao Holkar on one side and Daulat Rao Sindhia and Peshwa Baji Rao II on the other. On 25 October 1802, Holkar decisively defeated the combined forces of the Peshwa and Sindhia near Poona; Baji Rao II fled and, before the year's end, signed the **Treaty of Bassein (31 December 1802)**, accepting a Subsidiary Alliance with the Company.

FACT: under this treaty, the Peshwa ceded territory (including Surat) to the Company, accepted a permanent British force at his own expense, admitted a Resident to his court, and agreed not to employ Europeans without British approval -- the exact clause structure examined in full in Part IV. Wellesley himself described the moment, in a letter dated 24 December 1802, as the most favourable opportunity yet for establishing British interests within the Maratha empire without risking war with the confederacy as a whole. ANALYSIS: Bassein is properly read as the single most consequential turning point in Company-Maratha relations, not because it ended Maratha military resistance (Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar all fought on, as subtopics 12-13 show), but because it removed the Peshwa -- the confederacy's nominal head and its most important legitimating figure -- from the field of potential opposition, converting what had been an external contest between the Company and a (nominally unified) Maratha power into a set of separate conflicts between the Company and individual Maratha houses, each of which the Company could now fight, one at a time, with the Peshwa's own formal authority no longer available to the opposing side.




*Visual 9: the Bassein causal chain, 1800-1802 -- from Nana Phadnis's death to the Peshwa's Subsidiary Alliance*

*Visual 9: the Bassein causal chain, 1800-1802 -- from Nana Phadnis's death to the Peshwa's Subsidiary Alliance. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 11. TREATY OF BASSEIN, 1802: THE TURNING POINT

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 11. Treaty of Bassein, 1802: the turning point
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Treaty of Bassein · Peshwa Baji Rao II · Subsidiary Alliance · Company control ·
Maratha confederacy · Second Anglo-Maratha War
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: By accepting a Company force, territorial support and diplomatic restrictions,
 the nominal confederate head lost the capacity to coordinate independent Maratha resistance while
giving the Company a treaty basis for intervention.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Scindia and Bhonsle rejected the new relationship and fought the Company,
while Holkar's later resistance showed that Bassein transformed rather than immediately ended the
contest.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not say Bassein ended all Maratha resistance in 1802 or confuse it with
the settlement that ended the Third Anglo-Maratha War.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The Treaty of Bassein converted a Maratha succession and confederate
conflict into a constitutional subordination of the Peshwa and a wider Company-Maratha war.
```

# SESSION 12 - CORE - 12. SECOND ANGLO-MARATHA WAR: ASSAYE, DELHI, LASWARI, AND HOLKAR'S RESISTANCE

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: the correct comparative point for an answer on this war is that the Company achieved decisive victories over Sindhia and Bhonsle specifically because it could concentrate superior artillery and disciplined infantry against forces it fought one at a time, while Holkar's continued resistance shows the limits of this advantage against a still-mobile, still-undefeated Maratha force -- reinforcing, rather than contradicting, the contingency argument of subtopic 2.

**Technical definition:** Bassein directly triggered the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), as Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination and took up arms, while Holkar initially stood aside and the Gaekwad of Baroda supported the Company -- again illustrating the confederacy's persistent disunity in action (Sindhia and Bhonsle fought while Holkar watched; when Holkar later took up arms, Sindhia and Bhonsle had already been checked).

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> Bassein directly triggered the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), as Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination and took up arms, while Holkar initially stood aside and the Gaekwad of Baroda supported the Company -- again illustrating the confederacy's persistent disunity in action (Sindhia and Bhonsle fought while Holkar watched; when Holkar later took up arms, Sindhia and Bhonsle had already been checked).

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

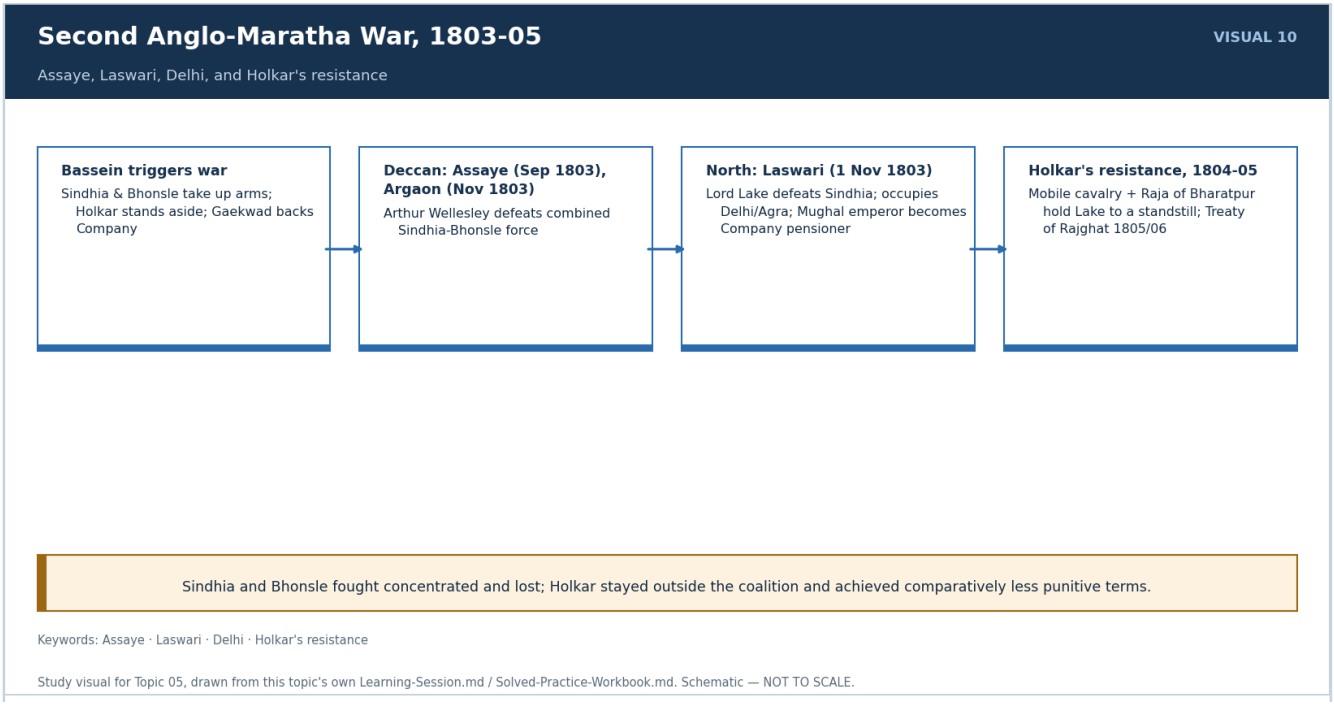
- **Assaye**
- **Delhi**
- **Laswari**
- **Holkar's resistance**
- **Assaye (September 1803)**
- **12. Second Anglo-Maratha War**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Assaye; define Delhi, connect Laswari with Holkar's resistance to explain the mechanism, and use Assaye (September 1803) for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Bassein directly triggered the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), as Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination and took up arms, while Holkar initially stood aside and the Gaekwad of Baroda supported the Company -- again illustrating the confederacy's persistent disunity in action (Sindhia and Bhonsle fought while Holkar

watched; when Holkar later took up arms, Sindhia and Bhonsle had already been checked). In the Deccan theatre, Arthur Wellesley (the future Duke of Wellington) defeated the combined Sindhia-Bhonsle forces at **Assaye (September 1803)** and again at **Argaon (November 1803)**. In the northern theatre, Lord Lake defeated Sindhia's forces at **Laswari (1 November 1803)** and occupied Delhi and Agra, bringing the nominally reigning Mughal emperor under Company protection as a pensioner. Sindhia and Bhonsle were each compelled to sue for peace, ceding territory, admitting British Residents and agreeing not to employ Europeans without British approval -- becoming subsidiary allies in the same structural sense as the Peshwa after Bassein.

FACT: Wellesley then turned to Holkar, but Yeshwant Rao Holkar, using mobile Maratha cavalry tactics and allied with the Raja of Bharatpur, fought Company forces to a standstill through 1804-05 and inflicted heavy losses on Lord Lake, including a failed attempt to storm Bharatpur's fort. Company financial strain from sustained warfare (Company debt reportedly nearly doubled between 1797 and 1806) and renewed concern over Napoleon in Europe led the Court of Directors to recall Wellesley; peace with Holkar was concluded by the **Treaty of Rajghat (1805/06)**, restoring much of his territory. ANALYSIS: the correct comparative point for an answer on this war is that the Company achieved decisive victories over Sindhia and Bhonsle specifically because it could concentrate superior artillery and disciplined infantry against forces it fought one at a time, while Holkar's continued resistance shows the limits of this advantage against a still-mobile, still-undefeated Maratha force -- reinforcing, rather than contradicting, the contingency argument of subtopic 2.




*Visual 10: Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803-05 -- Assaye, Laswari, Delhi, and Holkar's resistance*

*Visual 10: Second Anglo-Maratha War, 1803-05 -- Assaye, Laswari, Delhi, and Holkar's resistance. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 12. SECOND ANGLO-MARATHA WAR: ASSAYE, DELHI, LASWARI, AND HOLKAR'S RESISTANCE

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 12. Second Anglo-Maratha War: Assaye, Delhi, Laswari, and Holkar's
resistance
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Assaye · Delhi · Laswari · Holkar's resistance · Assaye (September 1803) · 12. Second
Anglo-Maratha War
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: ANALYSIS: the correct comparative point for an answer on this war is that the
Company achieved decisive victories over Sindhia and Bhonsle specifically because it could
concentrate superior artillery and disciplined infantry against forces it fought one at a time,
while Holkar's continued resistance shows the limits of this advantage against a still-mobile,
still-undefeated Maratha force -- reinforcing, rather than contradicting, the contingency argument
of subtopic 2.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Sindhia and Bhonsle were each compelled to sue for peace, ceding territory,
admitting British Residents and agreeing not to employ Europeans without British approval --
becoming subsidiary allies in the same structural sense as the Peshwa after Bassein.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: company financial strain from
sustained warfare (Company debt reportedly nearly doubled between 1797 and...
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Bassein directly triggered the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), as
Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination and took up arms, while Holkar initially
stood aside and the Gaekwad of Baroda supported the Company -- again illustrating the confederacy's
persistent disunity in action (Sindhia and Bhonsle fought while Holkar watched; when Holkar later
took up arms, Sindhia and Bhonsle had already been checked).
```

# SESSION 13 - CORE - 13. THIRD ANGLO-MARATHA WAR: PINDARIS, 1817-18, BAJI RAO II, AND THE END OF THE PESHWASHIP

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** the Third Anglo-Maratha War completes the fragmentation trajectory begun at Bassein: the First War (1775-82) produced a genuinely negotiated peace between roughly comparable powers; by the Second War (1803-05) the Company could isolate and defeat individual Maratha houses in sequence; by the Third War (1817-18) there was no unified Maratha command left to face at all, only a set of separately defeated chiefs and an abolished Peshwaship.

**Technical definition:** Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur, near Kanpur -- the Peshwaship was abolished outright, never to be restored.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> the Third Anglo-Maratha War completes the fragmentation trajectory begun at Bassein: the First War (1775-82) produced a genuinely negotiated peace between roughly comparable powers; by the Second War (1803-05) the Company could isolate and defeat individual Maratha houses in sequence; by the Third War (1817-18) there was no unified Maratha command left to face at all, only a set of separately defeated chiefs and an abolished Peshwaship.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

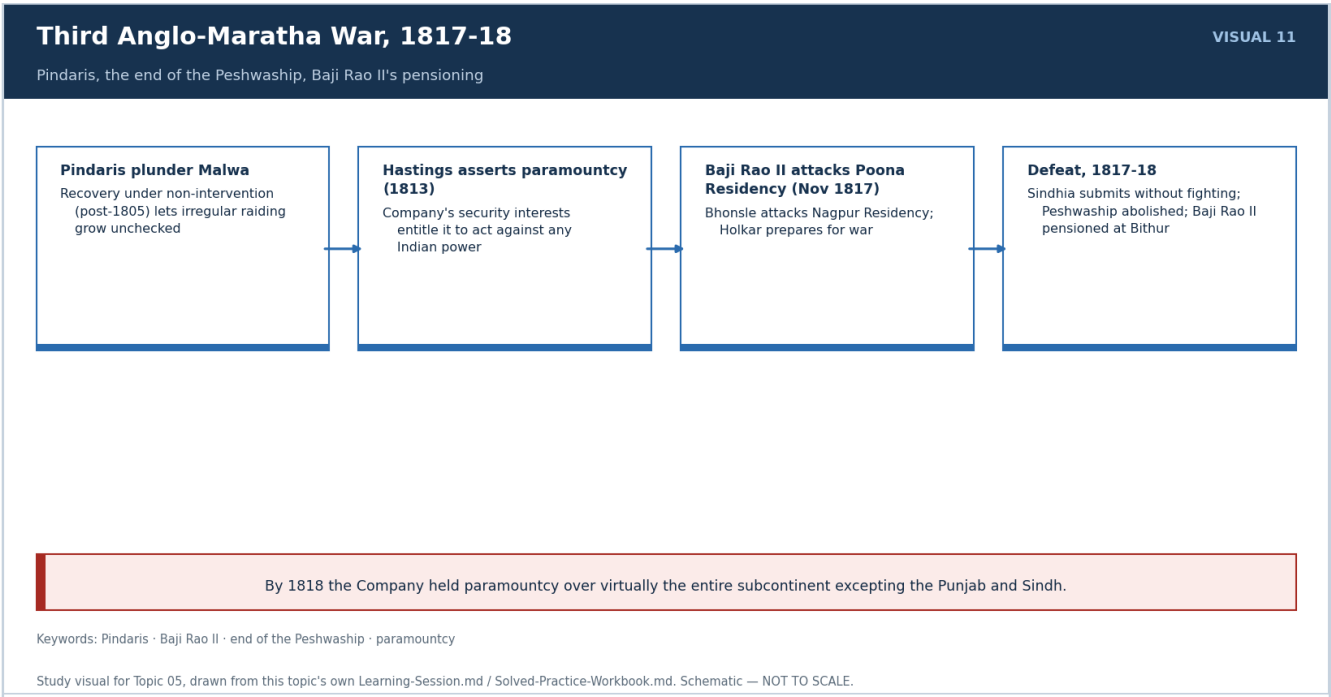
- **Pindaris**
- **Baji Rao II**
- **the end of the Peshwaship**
- **paramountcy**
- **13. Third Anglo-Maratha War**
- **1817-18**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Pindaris; define Baji Rao II, connect the end of the Peshwaship with paramountcy to explain the mechanism, and use 13. Third Anglo-Maratha War for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Cornwallis's recall of Wellesley in 1805 brought a non-intervention policy that allowed Holkar and Sindhia to recover some strength, while their irregular light cavalry auxiliaries, the **Pindaris**, increasingly plundered Malwa and neighbouring territories largely outside any state's direct control -- a growing law-and-order and revenue problem that the Company itself later cited as a justification for renewed intervention. Lord Hastings, arriving as Governor-General in 1813, articulated the explicit doctrine of **paramountcy** (subtopic 1): that the Company's own security interests entitled it to act against any Indian power, allied or not, that it judged a threat. Peshwa Baji Rao II, chafing under the rigid supervision of the British Resident at Poona since Bassein, made a final attempt to rally the Maratha chiefs and attacked the British Residency at Poona in November 1817; Appa Sahib of Nagpur (Bhonsle) attacked the Nagpur Residency, and Holkar's forces also prepared for war.

FACT: Hastings responded decisively: he compelled Sindhia to accept British suzerainty without fighting, and defeated the Peshwa's, Bhonsle's and Holkar's forces in a campaign fought through 1817-18, with mopping-up operations against scattered Pindari and Maratha remnants continuing into 1819. Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur, near Kanpur -- the **Peshwaship was abolished outright**, never to be restored. His territories were annexed, forming the basis of an enlarged Bombay Presidency; a small titular kingdom of Satara was carved out and given to a descendant of Chhatrapati Shivaji as a symbolic gesture, ruled as a complete Company dependent (Satara later became a Doctrine of Lapse case in 1848, examined in Part VII). Holkar and Bhonsle accepted subsidiary terms and ceded further territory.

ANALYSIS: the Third Anglo-Maratha War completes the fragmentation trajectory begun at Bassein: the First War (1775-82) produced a genuinely negotiated peace between roughly comparable powers; by the Second War (1803-05) the Company could isolate and defeat individual Maratha houses in sequence; by the Third War (1817-18) there was no unified Maratha command left to face at all, only a set of separately defeated chiefs and an abolished Peshwaship. By 1818 the Company held paramountcy over virtually the entire subcontinent excepting the Punjab and Sindh -- the two fronts examined in Parts V and VI.




*Visual 11: Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817-18 -- Pindaris, the end of the Peshwaship, and Baji Rao II's pensioning*

*Visual 11: Third Anglo-Maratha War, 1817-18 -- Pindaris, the end of the Peshwaship, and Baji Rao II's pensioning. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## PART IV - THE SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE SYSTEM

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 13. THIRD ANGLO-MARATHA WAR: PINDARIS, 1817-18, BAJI RAO II, AND THE END OF THE PESHWASHIP

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 13. Third Anglo-Maratha War: Pindaris, 1817-18, Baji Rao II, and the end of
the Peshwaship
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Pindaris · Baji Rao II · the end of the Peshwaship · paramountcy · 13. Third Anglo-
Maratha War · 1817-18
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur, near Kanpur -- the
Peshwaship was abolished outright, never to be restored.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: His territories were annexed, forming the basis of an enlarged Bombay
Presidency; a small titular kingdom of Satara was carved out and given to a descendant of
Chhatrapati Shivaji as a symbolic gesture, ruled as a complete Company dependent (Satara later
became a Doctrine of Lapse case in 1848, examined in Part VII).
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the Third Anglo-Maratha War
completes the fragmentation trajectory begun at Bassein.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: the Third Anglo-Maratha War completes the fragmentation trajectory
begun at Bassein: the First War (1775-82) produced a genuinely negotiated peace between roughly
comparable powers; by the Second War (1803-05) the Company could isolate and defeat individual
Maratha houses in sequence; by the Third War (1817-18) there was no unified Maratha command left to
face at all, only a set of separately defeated chiefs and an abolished Peshwaship.
```

# SESSION 14 - CORE - 14. PRECEDENTS AND WELLESLEY'S SYSTEMATISATION: THE EXACT CORE CLAUSES

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** reading these six clauses together shows precisely why contemporaries and later historians alike judged the system so corrosive of genuine sovereignty: clauses (1)-(2) removed financial and military self-sufficiency; clauses (3)-(5) removed diplomatic and administrative independence; and clause (6)'s protection promise, rather than compensating for these losses, is what made the loss politically survivable for the ruler in the short term while entrenching Company control in the long term.

**Technical definition:** the Subsidiary Alliance's core clauses, consistent across every case examined in subtopic 15, were: (1) the allied ruler accepted the permanent stationing of a British force within his own territory; (2) the ruler paid for this force's maintenance, either through a cash subsidy or by ceding revenue-yielding territory in lieu of cash; (3) the ruler accepted a British Resident at his court; (4) the ruler could not employ any European in his service without British approval; (5) the ruler could not negotiate, make war, or maintain independent diplomatic relations with any other Indian state without consulting the Governor-General; and (6) in return, the Company undertook to defend the ruler from external and internal enemies and promised, at least formally, non-interference in the state's internal administration -- a promise the historical record shows was seldom honoured in practice.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> the practice of stationing a Company-paid force alongside an allied Indian ruler was not itself Wellesley's invention -- the technique had precedents in earlier Company arrangements and in comparable French subsidiary practice on the Indian subcontinent earlier in the eighteenth century.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **Wellesley's systematisation**
- **the exact core clauses**
- **systematic, aggressive and near-universal application**
- **Company-paid**

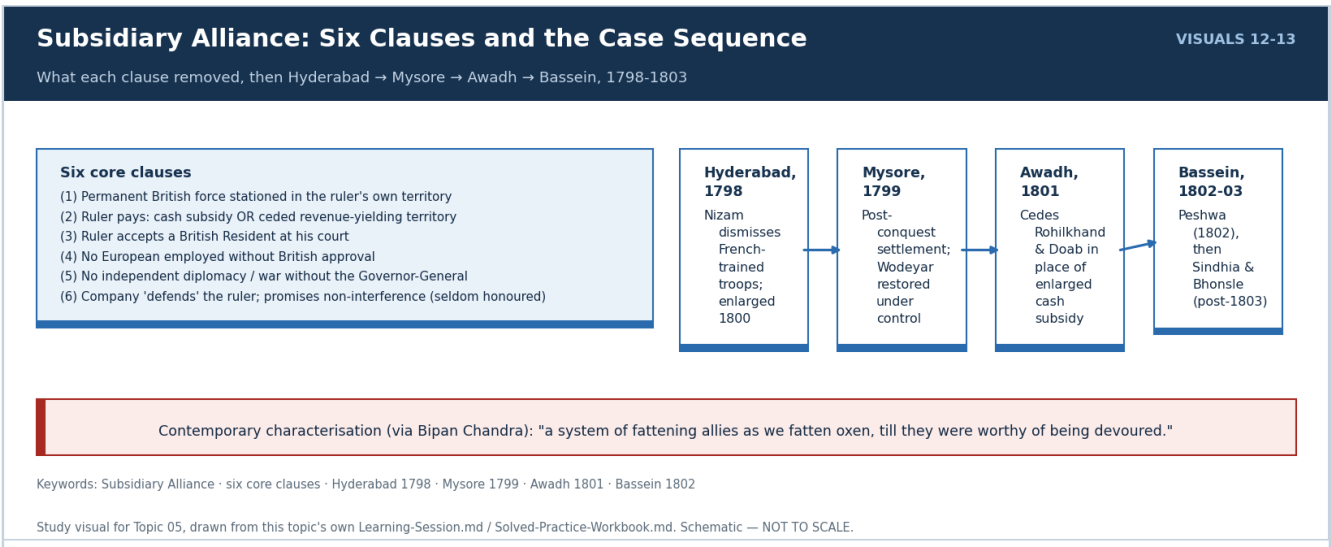
- **Indian**
- **14. Precedents**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Wellesley's systematisation; define the exact core clauses, connect systematic, aggressive and near-universal application with Company-paid to explain the mechanism, and use Indian for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: the practice of stationing a Company-paid force alongside an allied Indian ruler was not itself Wellesley's invention -- the technique had precedents in earlier Company arrangements and in comparable French subsidiary practice on the Indian subcontinent earlier in the eighteenth century. What Wellesley did, from his arrival as Governor-General in 1798, was give this older practice a **systematic, aggressive and near-universal application**, using it explicitly as his primary instrument (alongside outright war and the assumption of previously subordinated territories) for subordinating Indian states to Company paramountcy.

FACT: the Subsidiary Alliance's core clauses, consistent across every case examined in subtopic 15, were: (1) the allied ruler accepted the permanent stationing of a British force within his own territory; (2) the ruler paid for this force's maintenance, either through a cash subsidy or by ceding revenue-yielding territory in lieu of cash; (3) the ruler accepted a British Resident at his court; (4) the ruler could not employ any European in his service without British approval; (5) the ruler could not negotiate, make war, or maintain independent diplomatic relations with any other Indian state without consulting the Governor-General; and (6) in return, the Company undertook to defend the ruler from external and internal enemies and promised, at least formally, non-interference in the state's internal administration -- a promise the historical record shows was seldom honoured in practice.

ANALYSIS: reading these six clauses together shows precisely why contemporaries and later historians alike judged the system so corrosive of genuine sovereignty: clauses (1)-(2) removed financial and military self-sufficiency; clauses (3)-(5) removed diplomatic and administrative independence; and clause (6)'s protection promise, rather than compensating for these losses, is what made the loss politically survivable for the ruler in the short term while entrenching Company control in the long term. A single British commentator of the period is recorded (via Bipan Chandra) as describing the system memorably as "a system of fattening allies as we fatten oxen, till they were worthy of being devoured" -- a vivid contemporary characterisation of the dependency-to-annexation trajectory, quoted here as a period reflection rather than as this package's own analytical claim.




*Visual 12: Subsidiary Alliance -- the six core clauses and what each removed*

*Visual 12: Subsidiary Alliance -- the six core clauses and what each removed. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 14. PRECEDENTS AND WELLESLEY'S SYSTEMATISATION: THE EXACT CORE CLAUSES

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 14. Precedents and Wellesley's systematisation: the exact core clauses
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Wellesley's systematisation · the exact core clauses · systematic, aggressive and near-
universal application · Company-paid · Indian · 14. Precedents
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the Subsidiary Alliance's core clauses, consistent across every case examined
in subtopic 15, were: (1) the allied ruler accepted the permanent stationing of a British force
within his own territory; (2) the ruler paid for this force's maintenance, either through a cash
subsidy or by ceding revenue-yielding territory in lieu of cash; (3) the ruler accepted a British
Resident at his court; (4) the ruler could not employ any European in his service without British
approval; (5) the ruler could not negotiate, make war, or maintain independent diplomatic relations
with any other Indian state without consulting the Governor-General; and (6) in return, the Company
undertook to defend the ruler from external and internal enemies and promised, at least formally,
non-interference in the state's internal administration -- a promise the historical record shows
was seldom honoured in practice.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: reading these six clauses together shows precisely why contemporaries and
later historians alike judged the system so corrosive of genuine sovereignty: clauses (1)-(2)
removed financial and military self-sufficiency; clauses (3)-(5) removed diplomatic and
administrative independence; and clause (6)'s protection promise, rather than compensating for
these losses, is what made the loss politically survivable for the ruler in the short term while
entrenching Company control in the long term.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: what Wellesley did, from his arrival
as Governor-General in 1798, was give this older...
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: the practice of stationing a Company-paid force alongside an allied
Indian ruler was not itself Wellesley's invention -- the technique had precedents in earlier
Company arrangements and in comparable French subsidiary practice on the Indian subcontinent
earlier in the eighteenth century.
```

# SESSION 15 - CORE - 15. THE CASE SEQUENCE: HYDERABAD 1798, MYSORE 1799, AWADH 1801, BASSEIN 1802 AND AFTER

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: the correct sequencing to hold in memory for Prelims-style questions is: Hyderabad first, 1798; Mysore, 1799, immediately after conquest; Awadh, 1801; the Peshwa via Bassein, 1802, followed by Sindhia and Bhonsle after 1803 -- a chronological spread across barely five years that converted every major regional power except the still-independent Marathas' remaining resistance (ended only by 1818) and the still-unconquered Sikh and Sindh fronts (Parts V-VI) into Company dependents.

**Technical definition:** Peshwa Baji Rao II accepted the Treaty of Bassein in 1802 (subtopic 11), followed by Sindhia's and Bhonsle's own subsidiary submissions after the Second Anglo-Maratha War (subtopic 12).

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> ANALYSIS: the correct sequencing to hold in memory for Prelims-style questions is: Hyderabad first, 1798; Mysore, 1799, immediately after conquest; Awadh, 1801; the Peshwa via Bassein, 1802, followed by Sindhia and Bhonsle after 1803 -- a chronological spread across barely five years that converted every major regional power except the still-independent Marathas' remaining resistance (ended only by 1818) and the still-unconquered Sikh and Sindh fronts (Parts V-VI) into Company dependents.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

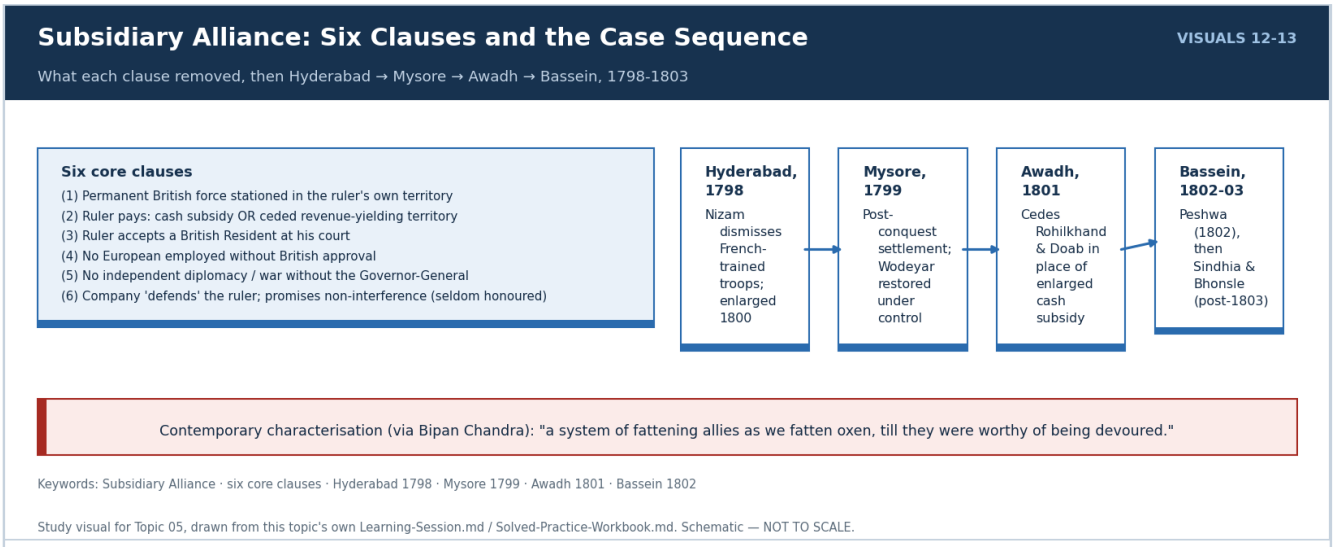
- **Hyderabad 1798**
- **Mysore 1799**
- **Awadh 1801**
- **Bassein 1802**

- **after**
- **15. The case sequence**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Hyderabad 1798; define Mysore 1799, connect Awadh 1801 with Bassein 1802 to explain the mechanism, and use after for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Wellesley signed his first Subsidiary Treaty with the **Nizam of Hyderabad in 1798**, requiring the Nizam to dismiss his French-trained troops and maintain a subsidiary force at his own cost, in return for Company protection against Maratha encroachment; a further 1800 treaty enlarged this subsidiary force and converted part of the payment from cash to a territorial cession. **Mysore's restored Wodeyar ruler accepted subsidiary terms in 1799** immediately after Seringapatam's fall (subtopic 8), with the added clause that the Governor-General could assume the state's administration outright if judged necessary. The **Nawab of Awadh was forced to accept a Subsidiary Treaty in 1801**, surrendering roughly half his kingdom (including Rohilkhand and the Doab territory between the Ganga and the Yamuna) in place of an enlarged cash subsidy, alongside acceptance of British "advice" on internal administration and reorganisation of his own police and army under British direction; this 1801 settlement built on an existing subsidiary arrangement already in place at Awadh since 1801's predecessor arrangements under Warren Hastings and Wellesley's own brother Henry, and left the Nawab's authority hollow even within the reduced territory he retained. **Peshwa Baji Rao II accepted the Treaty of Bassein in 1802** (subtopic 11), followed by Sindhia's and Bhonsle's own subsidiary submissions after the Second Anglo-Maratha War (subtopic 12).

FACT: Wellesley dealt still more directly with several smaller states: the Nawab of the Carnatic was compelled in 1801 to cede his kingdom outright to the Company in exchange for a pension (rather than accepting a subsidiary arrangement), and the rulers of Tanjore and Surat were similarly pensioned off and their territories absorbed -- together with Mysore's ceded Malabar territory, these annexed areas formed the enlarged Madras Presidency that lasted until 1947. ANALYSIS: the correct sequencing to hold in memory for Prelims-style questions is: **Hyderabad first, 1798**; **Mysore, 1799**, immediately after conquest; **Awadh, 1801**; **the Peshwa via Bassein, 1802**, followed by Sindhia and Bhonsle after 1803 -- a chronological spread across barely five years that converted every major regional power except the still-independent Marathas' remaining resistance (ended only by 1818) and the still-unconquered Sikh and Sindh fronts (Parts V-VI) into Company dependents.




*Visual 13: the Subsidiary Alliance case sequence, 1798-1803 -- Hyderabad, Mysore, Awadh, Bassein*

*Visual 13: the Subsidiary Alliance case sequence, 1798-1803 -- Hyderabad, Mysore, Awadh, Bassein. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 15. THE CASE SEQUENCE: HYDERABAD 1798, MYSORE 1799, AWADH 1801, BASSEIN 1802 AND AFTER

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 15. The case sequence: Hyderabad 1798, Mysore 1799, Awadh 1801, Bassein
1802 and after
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: Hyderabad 1798 · Mysore 1799 · Awadh 1801 · Bassein 1802 · after · 15. The case
sequence
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Peshwa Baji Rao II accepted the Treaty of Bassein in 1802 (subtopic 11),
followed by Sindhia's and Bhonsle's own subsidiary submissions after the Second Anglo-Maratha War (
subtopic 12).
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mysore's restored Wodeyar ruler accepted subsidiary terms in 1799
immediately after Seringapatam's fall (subtopic 8), with the added clause that the Governor-General
could assume the state's administration outright if judged necessary.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the Nawab of Awadh was forced to
accept a Subsidiary Treaty in 1801, surrendering...
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: ANALYSIS: the correct sequencing to hold in memory for Prelims-style
questions is: Hyderabad first, 1798; Mysore, 1799, immediately after conquest; Awadh, 1801; the
Peshwa via Bassein, 1802, followed by Sindhia and Bhonsle after 1803 -- a chronological spread
across barely five years that converted every major regional power except the still-independent
Marathas' remaining resistance (ended only by 1818) and the still-unconquered Sikh and Sindh fronts
(Parts V-VI) into Company dependents.
```

# SESSION 16 - CORE - 16. SOVEREIGNTY ERODED: DEPENDENCY, THE RESIDENT, AND THE RESPONSIBILITY PARADOX

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the point at which the task's "indirect rule and responsibility paradox" must be named explicitly and precisely.

**Technical definition:** The paradox therefore runs precisely as follows: the Company created the conditions for administrative drift or decline (through fiscal strain, disbanded armies and Resident encroachment on real authority) and then, in case after case examined across this package (most starkly Awadh in 1856, Part VII), used the resulting misgovernance as its own justification for further intervention or outright annexation -- responsibility without power, followed by annexation for the failure of power the ruler was never permitted to exercise.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> The paradox therefore runs precisely as follows: the Company created the conditions for administrative drift or decline (through fiscal strain, disbanded armies and Resident encroachment on real authority) and then, in case after case examined across this package (most starkly Awadh in 1856, Part VII), used the resulting misgovernance as its own justification for further intervention or outright annexation -- responsibility without power, followed by annexation for the failure of power the ruler was never permitted to exercise.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

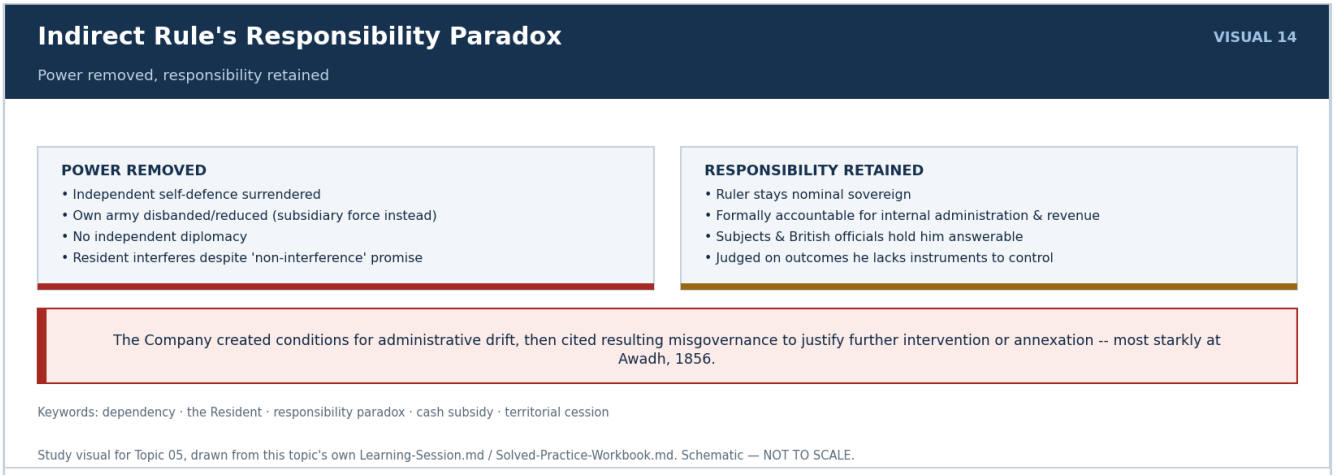
- **dependency**
- **the Resident**
- **the responsibility paradox**
- **cash subsidy**
- **territorial cession**
- **16. Sovereignty eroded**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through dependency; define the Resident, connect the responsibility paradox with cash subsidy to explain the mechanism, and use territorial cession for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: in practical effect, a state that signed a Subsidiary Alliance lost the right of independent self-defence, of conducting its own diplomacy, of freely employing foreign experts, and of settling disputes with neighbouring states on its own authority -- it retained nominal sovereignty and internal administrative form, while external sovereignty passed, in substance, to the Company. The British Resident at each subsidiary court increasingly interfered in day-to-day internal administration despite the formal non-interference promise, and the cost of maintaining the subsidiary force -- arbitrarily fixed and, by several contemporary and later accounts, disproportionate to the state's real paying capacity -- routinely strained the host state's finances and, in the process, impoverished its subjects through additional taxation. FACT: the system also caused the disbandment of the protected states' own armies, since a fully staffed subsidiary force made an independent army both unaffordable and, from the Company's perspective, undesirable; this released large numbers of unemployed soldiers and officers into the countryside, a portion of whom are recorded as having joined the roving Pindari bands examined in subtopic 13.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this is the point at which the task's "indirect rule and responsibility paradox" must be named explicitly and precisely. The Subsidiary Alliance left the ruler formally responsible for his state's governance and reputation -- he remained the nominal sovereign whom subjects, and later British officials themselves, held answerable for administrative outcomes -- while removing from him the actual instruments (army, treasury, foreign relations, and increasingly, effective control over his own court) needed to govern well or resist Resident interference. The paradox therefore runs precisely as follows: the Company created the conditions for administrative drift or decline (through fiscal strain, disbanded armies and Resident encroachment on real authority) and then, in case after case examined across this package (most starkly Awadh in 1856, Part VII), used the resulting misgovernance as its own justification for further intervention or outright annexation -- responsibility without power, followed by annexation for the failure of power the ruler was never permitted to exercise.

FACT: a clear conceptual distinction must be held here: a **cash subsidy** was a direct annual cash payment for the maintenance of the stationed force, while a **territorial cession** transferred revenue-yielding land to the Company in lieu of, or in partial substitution for, that cash payment (as happened with the Nizam's second 1800 treaty and with Awadh's 1801 settlement) -- both routes achieved the same underlying dependency, but a territorial cession additionally and permanently reduced the state's own resource base, making future recovery of any independent capacity progressively less possible. ANALYSIS: this distinction is one of the most commonly tested precision points in Subsidiary Alliance questions (including, potentially, the 2018 Prelims item examined in Part IX), and a careful answer should identify, for any named case, whether the Company was paid in cash or in land.




*Visual 14: indirect rule's responsibility paradox -- power removed, responsibility retained*

*Visual 14: indirect rule's responsibility paradox -- power removed, responsibility retained. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## PART V - SINDH: A BOUNDED FRONTIER CASE

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 16. SOVEREIGNTY ERODED: DEPENDENCY, THE RESIDENT, AND THE RESPONSIBILITY PARADOX

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 16. Sovereignty eroded: dependency, the Resident, and the responsibility
paradox
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: dependency · the Resident · the responsibility paradox · cash subsidy · territorial
cession · 16. Sovereignty eroded
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The British Resident at each subsidiary court increasingly interfered in day-
to-day internal administration despite the formal non-interference promise, and the cost of
maintaining the subsidiary force -- arbitrarily fixed and, by several contemporary and later
accounts, disproportionate to the state's real paying capacity -- routinely strained the host
state's finances and, in the process, impoverished its subjects through additional taxation.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: a clear conceptual distinction must be held here: a cash subsidy was a
direct annual cash payment for the maintenance of the stationed force, while a territorial cession
transferred revenue-yielding land to the Company in lieu of, or in partial substitution for, that
cash payment (as happened with the Nizam's second 1800 treaty and with Awadh's 1801 settlement) --
both routes achieved the same underlying dependency, but a territorial cession additionally and
permanently reduced the state's own resource base, making future recovery of any independent
capacity progressively less possible.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: in practical effect, a state that signed a Subsidiary Alliance lost the
right of independent self-defence, of conducting its own diplomacy, of freely employing foreign
experts, and of settling disputes with neighbouring states on its own authority -- it retained
nominal sovereignty and internal administrative form, while external sovereignty passed, in
substance, to the Company.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The paradox therefore runs precisely as follows: the Company created
the conditions for administrative drift or decline (through fiscal strain, disbanded armies and
Resident encroachment on real authority) and then, in case after case examined across this package (
most starkly Awadh in 1856, Part VII), used the resulting misgovernance as its own justification
for further intervention or outright annexation -- responsibility without power, followed by
annexation for the failure of power the ruler was never permitted to exercise.
```

# SESSION 17 - CORE - 17. SINDH: COMMERCIAL AND STRATEGIC CONTEXT, AND NAPIER'S 1843 ANNEXATION

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** The exam-ready reading of Sindh is that it was annexed principally for strategic and commercial control of the Indus frontier approaching Afghanistan, using a manufactured treaty grievance as proximate pretext -- a pattern of outright annexation distinct from both the Subsidiary Alliance route (Part IV) and Dalhousie's later Doctrine of Lapse (Part VII), since Sindh involved neither a subsidiary treaty's gradual dependency nor a disputed adoption, but direct conquest of a frontier territory judged strategically indispensable.

**Technical definition:** ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: Napier's own private diary is recorded (via Bipan Chandra) as candidly admitting the annexation's dubious legal and moral basis: "We have no right to seize Sind, yet we shall do so, and a very advantageous, useful humane piece of rascality it will be." This package uses only this attested diary entry; the popular story that Napier telegraphed the single Latin word "Peccavi" ("I have sinned" -- a pun on "I have Sindh") is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote and is deliberately excluded here as unconfirmed.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> The exam-ready reading of Sindh is that it was annexed principally for strategic and commercial control of the Indus frontier approaching Afghanistan, using a manufactured treaty grievance as proximate pretext -- a pattern of outright annexation distinct from both the Subsidiary Alliance route (Part IV) and Dalhousie's later Doctrine of Lapse (Part VII), since Sindh involved neither a subsidiary treaty's gradual dependency nor a disputed adoption, but direct conquest of a frontier territory judged strategically indispensable.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

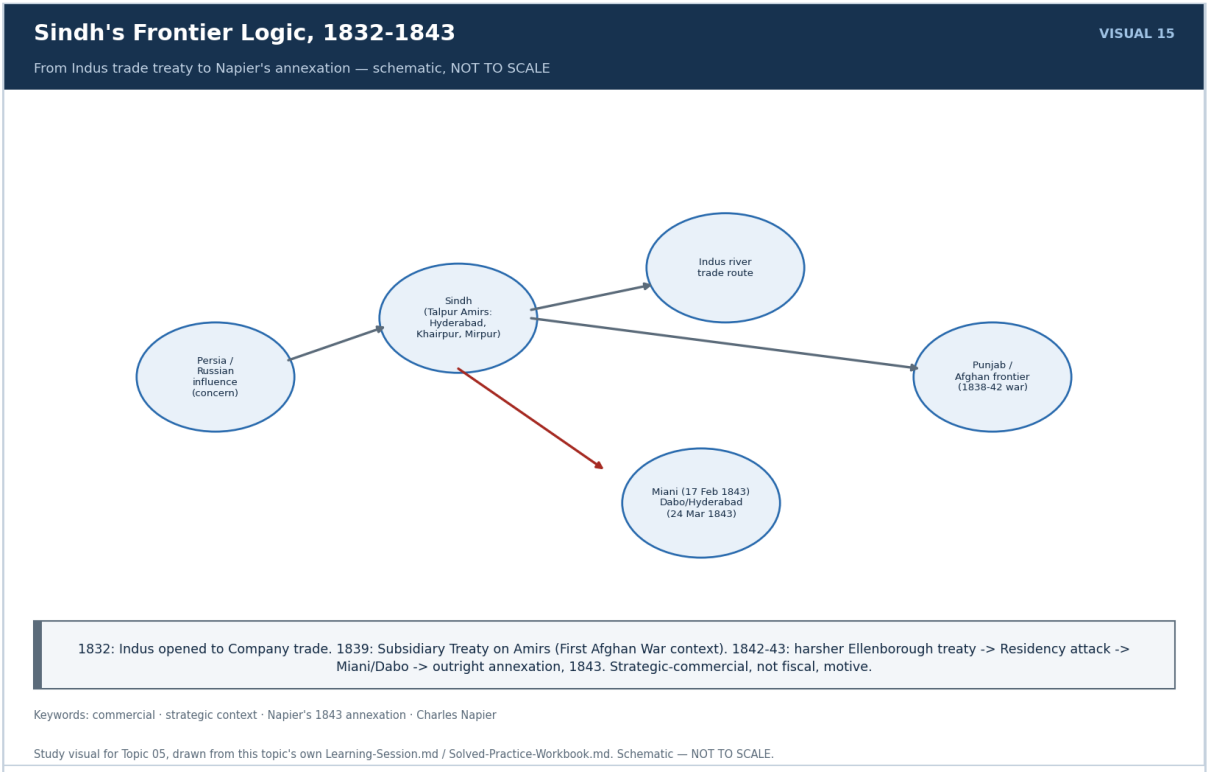
- **commercial**
- **strategic context**
- **Napier's 1843 annexation**
- **commercial and strategic**
- **Charles Napier**
- **17. Sindh**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through commercial; define strategic context, connect Napier's 1843 annexation with commercial and strategic to explain the mechanism, and use Charles Napier for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Sindh, ruled by a confederation of Talpur Amirs (at Hyderabad, Khairpur and Mirpur), first drew sustained Company attention for **commercial and strategic**, rather than revenue, reasons: the Indus river offered a potential trade artery into central Asia and the Punjab, and growing British anxiety over Russian and Persian influence approaching Afghanistan (the wider "Great Game" context) made control of the Indus route and the north-western approaches to India a strategic priority from the 1830s. An 1832 commercial treaty opened the Indus and Sindh's roads to Company trade; further arrangements tied to the First Afghan War (1838-42) brought British troops into Sindh and, in 1839, imposed a Subsidiary Treaty on the Amirs, including a subsidiary force stationed at their expense -- placing Sindh, structurally, within the same dependency logic examined in Part IV even before its outright annexation.

FACT: after the Company's costly and difficult First Afghan War, the Governor-General Lord Ellenborough sought a fresh, harsher treaty from the Amirs (1842-43) that would have further curtailed their authority and ceded additional territory; the immediate pretext for war came when an attack on the British Residency at Hyderabad (Sindh) by forces of some Amirs followed the tension surrounding this new treaty's imposition. Major-General **Charles Napier** defeated the Amirs' forces at the **Battle of Miani (17 February 1843)** and again at the **Battle of Dabo/Hyderabad (24 March 1843)**, after which Sindh was **annexed outright in 1843**.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: Napier's own private diary is recorded (via Bipan Chandra) as candidly admitting the annexation's dubious legal and moral basis: "We have no right to seize Sind, yet we shall do so, and a very advantageous, useful humane piece of rascality it will be." This package uses only this attested diary entry; the popular story that Napier telegraphed the single Latin word "Peccavi" ("I have sinned" -- a pun on "I have Sindh") is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote and is deliberately **excluded** here as unconfirmed. The exam-ready reading of Sindh is that it was annexed principally for **strategic and commercial control of the Indus frontier** approaching Afghanistan, using a manufactured treaty grievance as proximate pretext -- a pattern of outright annexation distinct from both the Subsidiary Alliance route (Part IV) and Dalhousie's later Doctrine of Lapse (Part VII), since Sindh involved neither a subsidiary treaty's gradual dependency nor a disputed adoption, but direct conquest of a frontier territory judged strategically indispensable.




*Visual 15: Sindh's frontier logic, 1832-1843 -- from Indus trade treaty to Napier's annexation*

*Visual 15: Sindh's frontier logic, 1832-1843 -- from Indus trade treaty to Napier's annexation. This is a schematic route diagram and is explicitly NOT TO SCALE.*

## PART VI - THE SIKH EMPIRE AND THE ANGLO-SIKH WARS

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 17. SINDH: COMMERCIAL AND STRATEGIC CONTEXT, AND NAPIER'S 1843 ANNEXATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 17. Sindh: commercial and strategic context, and Napier's 1843 annexation
|
v
EXACT TERMS: commercial · strategic context · Napier's 1843 annexation · commercial and strategic · Charles Napier · 17. Sindh
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: after the Company's costly and difficult First Afghan War, the Governor-General Lord Ellenborough sought a fresh, harsher treaty from the Amirs (1842-43) that would have further curtailed their authority and ceded additional territory; the immediate pretext for war came when an attack on the British Residency at Hyderabad (Sindh) by forces of some Amirs followed the tension surrounding this new treaty's imposition.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: Napier's own private diary is recorded (via Bipan Chandra) as candidly admitting the annexation's dubious legal and moral basis: "We have no right to seize Sind, yet we shall do so, and a very advantageous, useful humane piece of rascality it will be." This package uses only this attested diary entry; the popular story that Napier telegraphed the single Latin word "Peccavi" ("I have sinned" -- a pun on "I have Sindh") is a widely repeated but historically unverified anecdote and is deliberately excluded here as unconfirmed.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: major-General Charles Napier defeated the Amirs' forces at the Battle of Miani (17 February...
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The exam-ready reading of Sindh is that it was annexed principally for strategic and commercial control of the Indus frontier approaching Afghanistan, using a manufactured treaty grievance as proximate pretext -- a pattern of outright annexation distinct from both the Subsidiary Alliance route (Part IV) and Dalhousie's later Doctrine of Lapse (Part VII), since Sindh involved neither a subsidiary treaty's gradual dependency nor a disputed adoption, but direct conquest of a frontier territory judged strategically indispensable.

# SESSION 18 - CORE - 18. RANJIT SINGH'S STATE, THE KHALSA ARMY, AND THE TREATY OF AMRITSAR, 1809

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** CORE - 18. Ranjit Singh's state, the Khalsa army, and the Treaty of Amritsar, 1809 comprises the Khalsa army, the Treaty of Amritsar and Khalsa army as its core connected dimensions.

**Technical definition:** His Khalsa army was distinctive for its scale and its systematic modernisation: infantry and artillery were reorganised and drilled on European lines with the help of French, Italian and other European officers he recruited (including Jean-François Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura), giving Punjab, by Ranjit Singh's death, one of the most professionally organised and best-equipped standing armies among contemporary Indian states, with a large artillery park cast in state-controlled foundries.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> His Khalsa army was distinctive for its scale and its systematic modernisation: infantry and artillery were reorganised and drilled on European lines with the help of French, Italian and other European officers he recruited (including Jean-François Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura), giving Punjab, by Ranjit Singh's death, one of the most professionally organised and best-equipped standing armies among contemporary Indian states, with a large artillery park cast in state-controlled foundries.

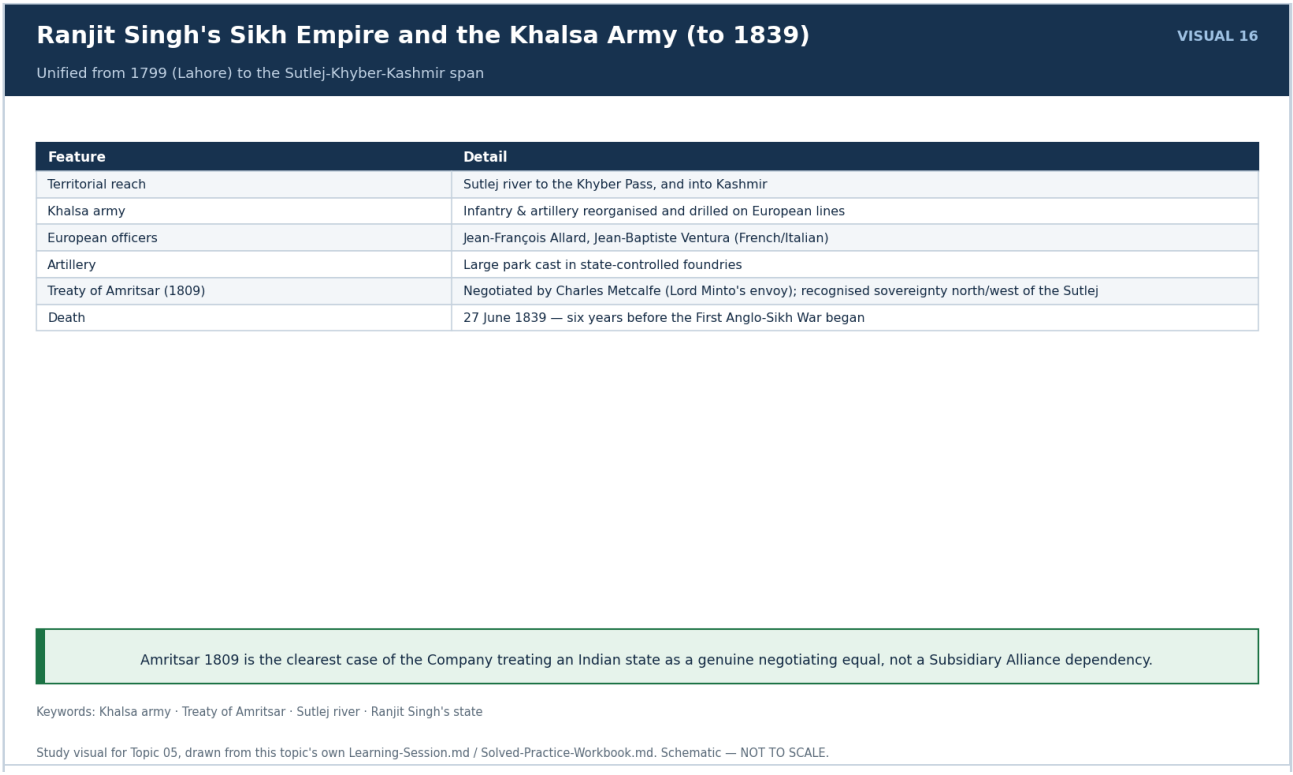
## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **the Khalsa army**
- **the Treaty of Amritsar**
- **Khalsa army**
- **Treaty of Amritsar (1809)**
- **Sutlej river**
- **18. Ranjit Singh's state**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through the Khalsa army; define the Treaty of Amritsar, connect Khalsa army with Treaty of Amritsar (1809) to explain the mechanism, and use Sutlej river for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Ranjit Singh unified the fractious Sikh misls (confederate bands) of the Punjab from 1799 (when he took Lahore) into a single, centralised kingdom, eventually extending his authority from the Sutlej to the Khyber Pass and into Kashmir. His **Khalsa army** was distinctive for its scale and its systematic modernisation: infantry and artillery were reorganised and drilled on European lines with the help of French, Italian and other European officers he recruited (including Jean-François Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura), giving Punjab, by Ranjit Singh's death, one of the most professionally organised and best-equipped standing armies among contemporary Indian states, with a large artillery park cast in state-controlled foundries.

FACT: the Company's relationship with Ranjit Singh was fixed by the **Treaty of Amritsar (1809)**, concluded after Lord Minto's envoy Charles Metcalfe negotiated with Ranjit Singh amid British anxiety over a possible Napoleonic threat approaching India via Persia and Afghanistan. The treaty recognised Ranjit Singh's sovereignty over his territories north and west of the **Sutlej river**, while the Sikh cis-Sutlej chiefs to the south and east of that river came under Company protection; Ranjit Singh, in return, abandoned any further expansion south of the Sutlej. ANALYSIS: Amritsar 1809 is the clearest example in this entire package of the Company treating a strong, well-organised Indian state as a genuine equal, negotiated boundary partner rather than as a Subsidiary Alliance dependency -- a direct illustration of the contingency argument (subtopic 2): the Company adapted its approach to the real correlation of forces on each frontier, choosing negotiated coexistence with a militarily formidable Ranjit Singh in 1809 while choosing conquest, alliance-dependency or annexation elsewhere depending on relative strength and opportunity. **Ranjit Singh himself never fought the Company** -- he died on 27 June 1839, a full six years before the first Anglo-Sikh war began, and this distinction is a frequently tested precision point.




*Visual 16: Ranjit Singh's Sikh Empire and the Khalsa army, to 1839*

*Visual 16: Ranjit Singh's Sikh Empire and the Khalsa army, to 1839. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 18. RANJIT SINGH'S STATE, THE KHALSA ARMY, AND THE TREATY OF AMRITSAR, 1809

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 18. Ranjit Singh's state, the Khalsa army, and the Treaty of Amritsar, 1809
|
v
EXACT TERMS: the Khalsa army · the Treaty of Amritsar · Khalsa army · Treaty of Amritsar (1809) · Sutlej river · 18. Ranjit Singh's state
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the Company's relationship with Ranjit Singh was fixed by the Treaty of Amritsar (1809), concluded after Lord Minto's envoy Charles Metcalfe negotiated with Ranjit Singh amid British anxiety over a possible Napoleonic threat approaching India via Persia and Afghanistan.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: Amritsar 1809 is the clearest example in this entire package of the Company treating a strong, well-organised Indian state as a genuine equal, negotiated boundary partner rather than as a Subsidiary Alliance dependency -- a direct illustration of the contingency argument (subtopic 2): the Company adapted its approach to the real correlation of forces on each frontier, choosing negotiated coexistence with a militarily formidable Ranjit Singh in 1809 while choosing conquest, alliance-dependency or annexation elsewhere depending on relative strength and opportunity.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Ranjit Singh himself never fought the Company -- he died on 27 June 1839, a full six years before the first Anglo-Sikh war began, and this distinction is a frequently tested precision point.
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: His Khalsa army was distinctive for its scale and its systematic modernisation: infantry and artillery were reorganised and drilled on European lines with the help of French, Italian and other European officers he recruited (including Jean-François Allard and Jean-Baptiste Ventura), giving Punjab, by Ranjit Singh's death, one of the most professionally organised and best-equipped standing armies among contemporary Indian states, with a large artillery park cast in state-controlled foundries.

# SESSION 19 - CORE - 19. POST-1839 SUCCESSION CRISIS: FACTIONAL INSTABILITY AFTER RANJIT SINGH

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this rapid factional collapse -- five rulers in scarcely six years, following one long, stable reign -- is the essential precondition for the First Anglo-Sikh War, in the same structural sense that Nana Phadnis's 1800 death and the subsequent succession feuding preconditioned the Marathas' fragmentation before Bassein (subtopic 11): a previously formidable, unified state lost its unifying leadership and fell into internal rivalry precisely at the moment the Company's frontier interest in the Punjab was intensifying (partly driven by the Company's own difficult First Afghan War experience, 1838-42, which had already brought British forces close to Punjab's borders).

**Technical definition:** Ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his son Kharak Singh (died 1840), grandson Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840), and a succession of further short reigns amid intense factional rivalry among Sikh sardars (notably the Sandhawalia and Dogra factions) and increasingly assertive intervention by the Khalsa army's own regimental councils (panchayats), which had begun acting as an independent political force in the court's absence of settled authority.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> Ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his son Kharak Singh (died 1840), grandson Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840), and a succession of further short reigns amid intense factional rivalry among Sikh sardars (notably the Sandhawalia and Dogra factions) and increasingly assertive intervention by the Khalsa army's own regimental councils (panchayats), which had begun acting as an independent political force in the court's absence of settled authority.

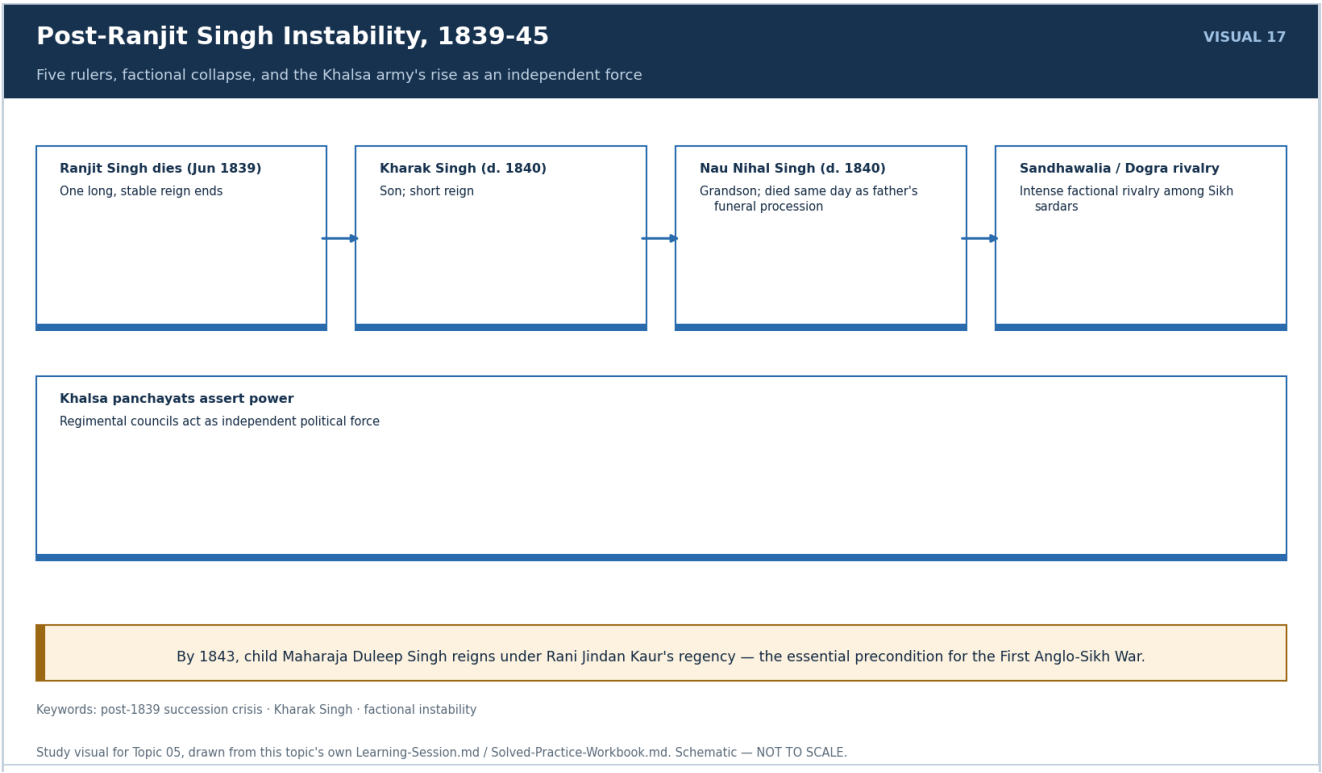
## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **ional instability after Ranjit Singh**
- **Ranjit Singh's**
- **Kharak Singh**
- **19. Post-1839 succession crisis**
- **1838-42**
- **1839-45**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through ional instability after Ranjit Singh; define Ranjit Singh's, connect Kharak Singh with 19. Post-1839 succession crisis to explain the mechanism, and use 1838-42 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his son Kharak Singh (died 1840), grandson Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840), and a succession of further short reigns amid intense factional rivalry among Sikh sardars (notably the Sandhawalia and Dogra factions) and increasingly assertive intervention by the Khalsa army's own regimental councils (panchayats), which had begun acting as an independent political force in the court's absence of settled authority. By 1843 the child Maharaja Duleep Singh (Ranjit Singh's youngest son) occupied the throne under his mother Rani Jindan Kaur's regency, with real power contested between the durbar's court factions and the increasingly assertive, semi-autonomous Khalsa army.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this rapid factional collapse -- five rulers in scarcely six years, following one long, stable reign -- is the essential precondition for the First Anglo-Sikh War, in the same structural sense that Nana Phadnis's 1800 death and the subsequent succession feuding preconditioned the Marathas' fragmentation before Bassein (subtopic 11): a previously formidable, unified state lost its unifying leadership and fell into internal rivalry precisely at the moment the Company's frontier interest in the Punjab was intensifying (partly driven by the Company's own difficult First Afghan War experience, 1838-42, which had already brought British forces close to Punjab's borders).




*Visual 17: post-Ranjit Singh instability, 1839-45 -- five rulers, factional collapse, and the Khalsa army's rise as an independent force*

*Visual 17: post-Ranjit Singh instability, 1839-45 -- five rulers, factional collapse, and the Khalsa army's rise as an independent force. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 19. POST-1839 SUCCESSION CRISIS: FACTIONAL INSTABILITY AFTER RANJIT SINGH

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 19. Post-1839 succession crisis: factional instability after Ranjit Singh
|
v
EXACT TERMS: ional instability after Ranjit Singh · Ranjit Singh's · Kharak Singh · 19. Post-1839 succession crisis · 1838-42 · 1839-45
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this rapid factional collapse -- five rulers in scarcely six years, following one long, stable reign -- is the essential precondition for the First Anglo-Sikh War, in the same structural sense that Nana Phadnis's 1800 death and the subsequent succession feuding preconditioned the Marathas' fragmentation before Bassein (subtopic 11): a previously formidable, unified state lost its unifying leadership and fell into internal rivalry precisely at the moment the Company's frontier interest in the Punjab was intensifying (partly driven by the Company's own difficult First Afghan War experience, 1838-42, which had already brought British forces close to Punjab's borders).
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his...
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his...
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Ranjit Singh's death in June 1839 was followed by rapid, destabilising successions -- his son Kharak Singh (died 1840), grandson Nau Nihal Singh (died the same day as his father's funeral procession, 1840), and a succession of further short reigns amid intense factional rivalry among Sikh sardars (notably the Sandhawalia and Dogra factions) and increasingly assertive intervention by the Khalsa army's own regimental councils (panchayats), which had begun acting as an independent political force in the court's absence of settled authority.

# SESSION 20 - CORE - 20. FIRST ANGLO-SIKH WAR: MUDKI TO SOBRAON, LAHORE, AND BHYROWAL

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** rising mutual suspicion -- the Company's build-up of forces on the Sutlej frontier following the Afghan war, and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore -- led the Khalsa army to cross the Sutlej in December 1845, precipitating the First Anglo-Sikh War.

**Technical definition:** Four major battles followed at supported precision: Mudki (18 December 1845), Ferozeshah (21-22 December 1845), Aliwal (28 January 1846) and Sobraon (10 February 1846) -- each a hard-fought Company victory, with Sobraon effectively deciding the war by breaking the last organised Khalsa resistance on the Sutlej's southern bank.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> rising mutual suspicion -- the Company's build-up of forces on the Sutlej frontier following the Afghan war, and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore -- led the Khalsa army to cross the Sutlej in December 1845, precipitating the First Anglo-Sikh War.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

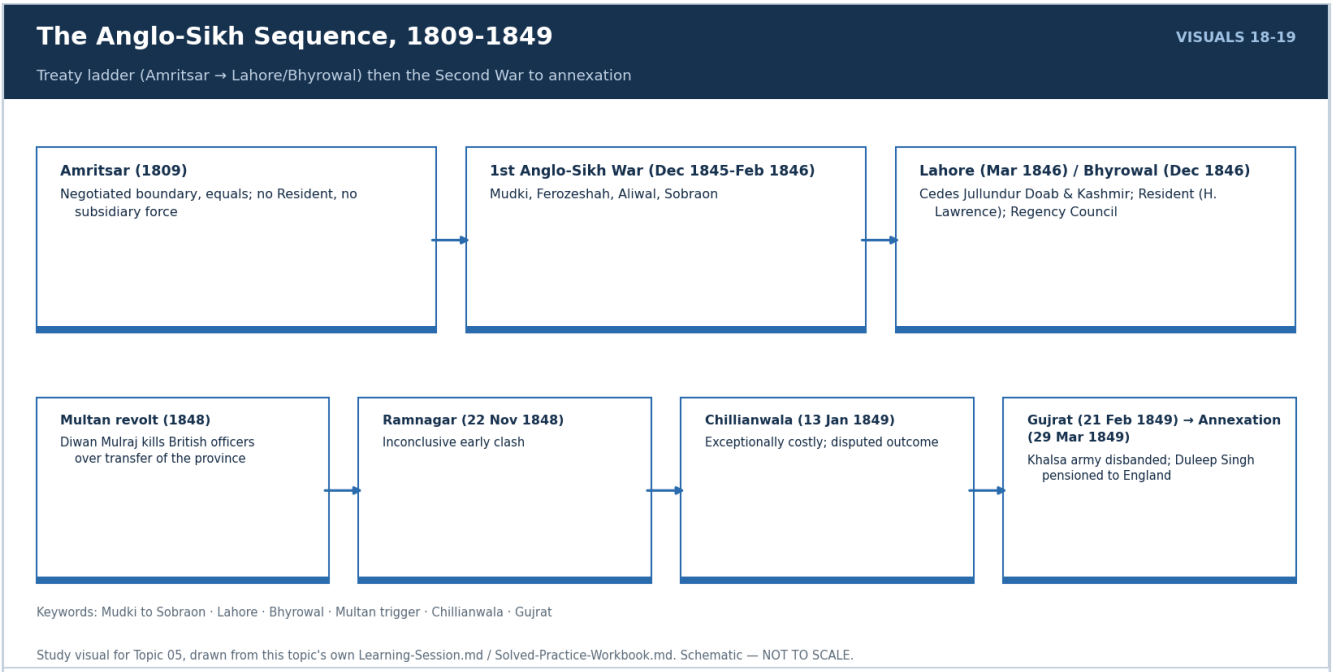
- **Mudki to Sobraon**
- **Lahore**
- **Bhyrowal**
- **First Anglo-Sikh War**
- **Mudki (18 December 1845)**
- **20. First Anglo-Sikh War**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through Mudki to Sobraon; define Lahore, connect Bhyrowal with First Anglo-Sikh War to explain the mechanism, and use Mudki (18 December 1845) for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: rising mutual suspicion -- the Company's build-up of forces on the Sutlej frontier following the Afghan war, and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore -- led the Khalsa army to cross the Sutlej in December 1845, precipitating the **First Anglo-Sikh War**. Four major battles followed at supported precision: **Mudki (18 December 1845)**, **Ferozeshah (21-22 December 1845)**, **Aliwal (28 January 1846)** and **Sobraon (10 February 1846)** -- each a hard-fought Company victory, with Sobraon effectively deciding the war by breaking the last organised Khalsa resistance on the Sutlej's southern bank.

FACT: the **Treaty of Lahore (8-9 March 1846)** followed: the Sikh state ceded the Jullundur Doab (territory between the Sutlej and Beas rivers) and Kashmir (the latter separately sold soon after to Gulab Singh of Jammu for a fixed sum, creating the princely state of Jammu and Kashmir under British paramountcy), paid a war indemnity, agreed to reduce the Khalsa army's size, and accepted a British Resident at Lahore together with a British force stationed there temporarily. Continuing instability at the Lahore durbar led to a further settlement, the **Treaty of Bhyrowal (16 December 1846)**, under which a Council of Regency was established at Lahore under British supervision, with **Henry Lawrence** as Resident holding effectively decisive authority during Duleep Singh's minority, and a British garrison stationed at Lahore at the durbar's expense -- placing the Sikh state, in substance, under a Subsidiary-Alliance-like dependency without the Company yet annexing it outright.

ANALYSIS: the Lahore-to-Bhyrowal sequence shows the Company applying, on the Sikh frontier in 1846, essentially the same dependency logic examined in Part IV (Resident control, a maintained British force, loss of independent military capacity) rather than immediate annexation -- a further illustration that the Company's choice of instrument (negotiated boundary treaty in 1809, dependency-Residency in 1846, outright annexation in 1849) tracked the relative military and political balance at each specific moment, not a fixed British programme applied identically everywhere.




*Visual 18: the Anglo-Sikh treaty ladder -- Amritsar 1809 to Lahore/Bhyrowal 1846 to annexation 1849*

*Visual 18: the Anglo-Sikh treaty ladder -- Amritsar 1809 to Lahore/Bhyrowal 1846 to annexation 1849. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 20. FIRST ANGLO-SIKH WAR: MUDKI TO SOBRAON, LAHORE, AND BHYROWAL

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 20. First Anglo-Sikh War: Mudki to Sobraon, Lahore, and Bhyrowal
|
v
EXACT TERMS: Mudki to Sobraon · Lahore · Bhyrowal · First Anglo-Sikh War · Mudki (18 December 1845) · 20. First Anglo-Sikh War
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Four major battles followed at supported precision: Mudki (18 December 1845), Ferozeshah (21-22 December 1845), Aliwal (28 January 1846) and Sobraon (10 February 1846) -- each a hard-fought Company victory, with Sobraon effectively deciding the war by breaking the last organised Khalsa resistance on the Sutlej's southern bank.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: the Lahore-to-Bhyrowal sequence shows the Company applying, on the Sikh frontier in 1846, essentially the same dependency logic examined in Part IV (Resident control, a maintained British force, loss of independent military capacity) rather than immediate annexation -- a further illustration that the Company's choice of instrument (negotiated boundary treaty in 1809, dependency-Residency in 1846, outright annexation in 1849) tracked the relative military and political balance at each specific moment, not a fixed British programme applied identically everywhere.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: continuing instability at the Lahore durbar led to a further settlement, the Treaty of...
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: rising mutual suspicion -- the Company's build-up of forces on the Sutlej frontier following the Afghan war, and the Khalsa army's own increasingly independent political assertiveness at Lahore -- led the Khalsa army to cross the Sutlej in December 1845, precipitating the First Anglo-Sikh War.

# SESSION 21 - CORE - 21. SECOND ANGLO-SIKH WAR: THE MULTAN TRIGGER, CHILLIANWALA, GUJRAT, AND 1849 ANNEXATION

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** Company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main Khalsa forces: the Battle of Ramnagar (22 November 1848) was an inconclusive early clash; the Battle of Chillianwala (13 January 1849) was exceptionally hard-fought and costly for the Company, with the outcome disputed enough at the time that it was not treated as a clear British victory; the decisive engagement came at the Battle of Gujrat (21 February 1849), where superior Company artillery broke the Khalsa army's remaining organised resistance.

**Technical definition:** Technically, CORE - 21. Second Anglo-Sikh War: the Multan trigger, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and 1849 annexation is analysed by relating the Multan trigger to Chillianwala, then testing the relationship through Gujrat and Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49).

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> Company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main Khalsa forces: the Battle of Ramnagar (22 November 1848) was an inconclusive early clash; the Battle of Chillianwala (13 January 1849) was exceptionally hard-fought and costly for the Company, with the outcome disputed enough at the time that it was not treated as a clear British victory; the decisive engagement came at the Battle of Gujrat (21 February 1849), where superior Company artillery broke the Khalsa army's remaining organised resistance.

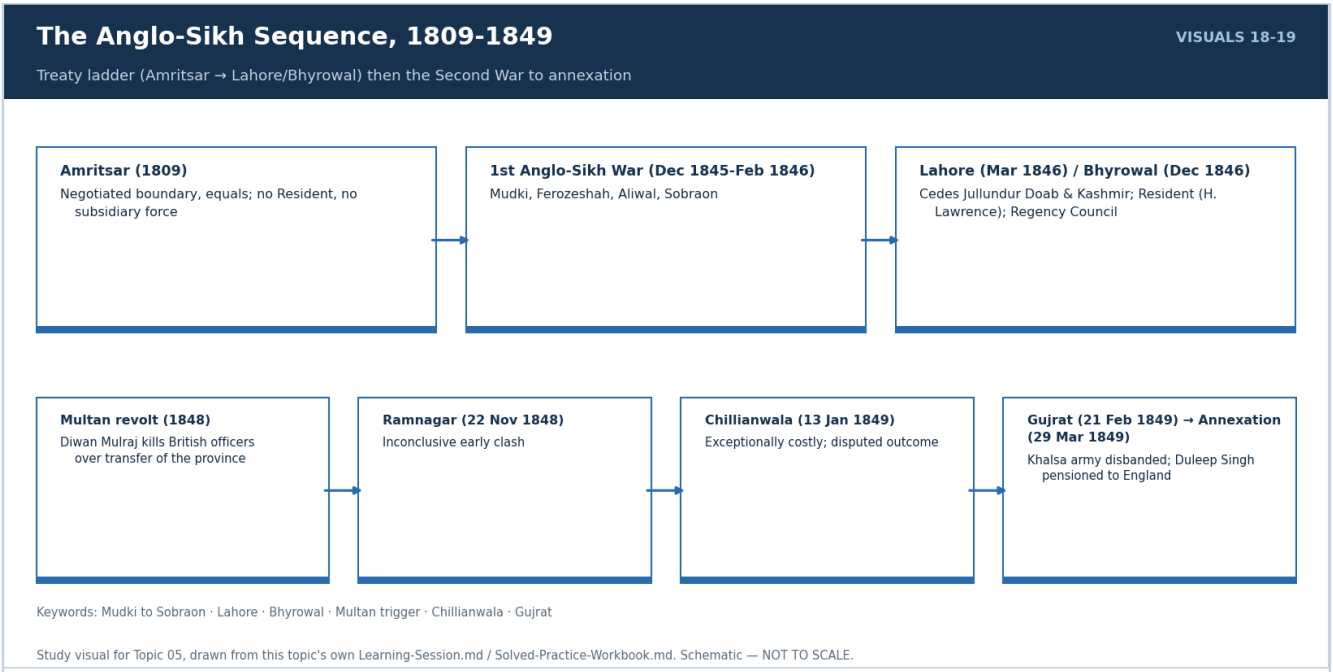
## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **the Multan trigger**
- **Chillianwala**
- **Gujrat**
- **Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49)**
- **21. Second Anglo-Sikh War**
- **1849 annexation**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through the Multan trigger; define Chillianwala, connect Gujrat with Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49) to explain the mechanism, and use 21. Second Anglo-Sikh War for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: the **Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49)** began with a rebellion at **Multan**, where the local governor **Diwan Mulraj**, resisting Company revenue and administrative demands, killed two British officers sent to oversee the province's transfer, sparking a wider rising that drew in Sikh sardars disaffected with the Bhyrowal settlement's constraints. Company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main Khalsa forces: the **Battle of Ramnagar (22 November 1848)** was an inconclusive early clash; the **Battle of Chillianwala (13 January 1849)** was exceptionally hard-fought and costly for the Company, with the outcome disputed enough at the time that it was not treated as a clear British victory; the decisive engagement came at the **Battle of Gujrat (21 February 1849)**, where superior Company artillery broke the Khalsa army's remaining organised resistance.

FACT: the Punjab was **formally annexed on 29 March 1849**; the young Maharaja Duleep Singh was pensioned and sent to England, and the Khalsa army was disbanded outright. ANALYSIS: the Second Anglo-Sikh War's proximate trigger (a provincial governor's revolt at Multan against encroaching Company administrative control) reads, in miniature, as a preview of exactly the kind of dispossession and resentment examined at wider scale in Part VIII's bridge to 1857: a local authority stripped of real administrative discretion by encroaching British control chose armed resistance once negotiation and accommodation seemed to offer no further protection -- reinforcing this package's central point that Company expansion proceeded through a repeated interplay of dependency, encroachment, resistance and annexation, not through any single mechanism applied uniformly across every frontier.




*Visual 19: Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1848-49 -- Multan, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and the annexation of Punjab*

*Visual 19: Second Anglo-Sikh War, 1848-49 -- Multan, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and the annexation of Punjab. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## PART VII - DALHOUSIE, THE DOCTRINE OF LAPSE, AND AWADH

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 21. SECOND ANGLO-SIKH WAR: THE MULTAN TRIGGER, CHILLIANWALA, GUJRAT, AND 1849 ANNEXATION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - 21. Second Anglo-Sikh War: the Multan trigger, Chillianwala, Gujrat, and 1849 annexation
|
v
EXACT TERMS: the Multan trigger · Chillianwala · Gujrat · Second Anglo-Sikh War (1848-49) · 21. Second Anglo-Sikh War · 1849 annexation
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the Punjab was formally annexed on 29 March 1849; the young Maharaja Duleep Singh was pensioned and sent to England, and the Khalsa army was disbanded outright.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main...
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main...
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Company and allied forces besieged Multan while a separate field campaign confronted the main Khalsa forces: the Battle of Ramnagar (22 November 1848) was an inconclusive early clash; the Battle of Chillianwala (13 January 1849) was exceptionally hard-fought and costly for the Company, with the outcome disputed enough at the time that it was not treated as a clear British victory; the decisive engagement came at the Battle of Gujrat (21 February 1849), where superior Company artillery broke the Khalsa army's remaining organised resistance.

# SESSION 22 - CORE - 22. THE DOCTRINE OF LAPSE: PRINCIPLES, PARAMOUNTCY, AND THE VERIFIED CASES

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: keeping the territorial-Lapse cases (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi and the smaller states) analytically separate from title/pension denials (Nana Sahib) is essential precision: both fed resentment toward Company paramountcy, but only the former involved the Doctrine of Lapse as a territorial-annexation instrument in the strict sense.

**Technical definition:** Lord Dalhousie, Governor-General from 1848 to 1856, articulated the Doctrine of Lapse as an extension of the paramountcy principle already asserted by Lord Hastings (subtopic 13): where a dependent or protected Indian state's ruler died without a natural (biological) male heir, Dalhousie held that the Company, as paramount power, could refuse to recognise an adopted heir and instead annex the state outright, on the reasoning that such states existed only by British sufferance and had no independent right to perpetuate themselves through adoption without British sanction.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> ANALYSIS: keeping the territorial-Lapse cases (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi and the smaller states) analytically separate from title/pension denials (Nana Sahib) is essential precision: both fed resentment toward Company paramountcy, but only the former involved the Doctrine of Lapse as a territorial-annexation instrument in the strict sense.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **principles**
- **paramountcy**
- **the verified cases**
- **Doctrine of Lapse**
- **natural (biological) male heir**
- **22. The Doctrine of Lapse**

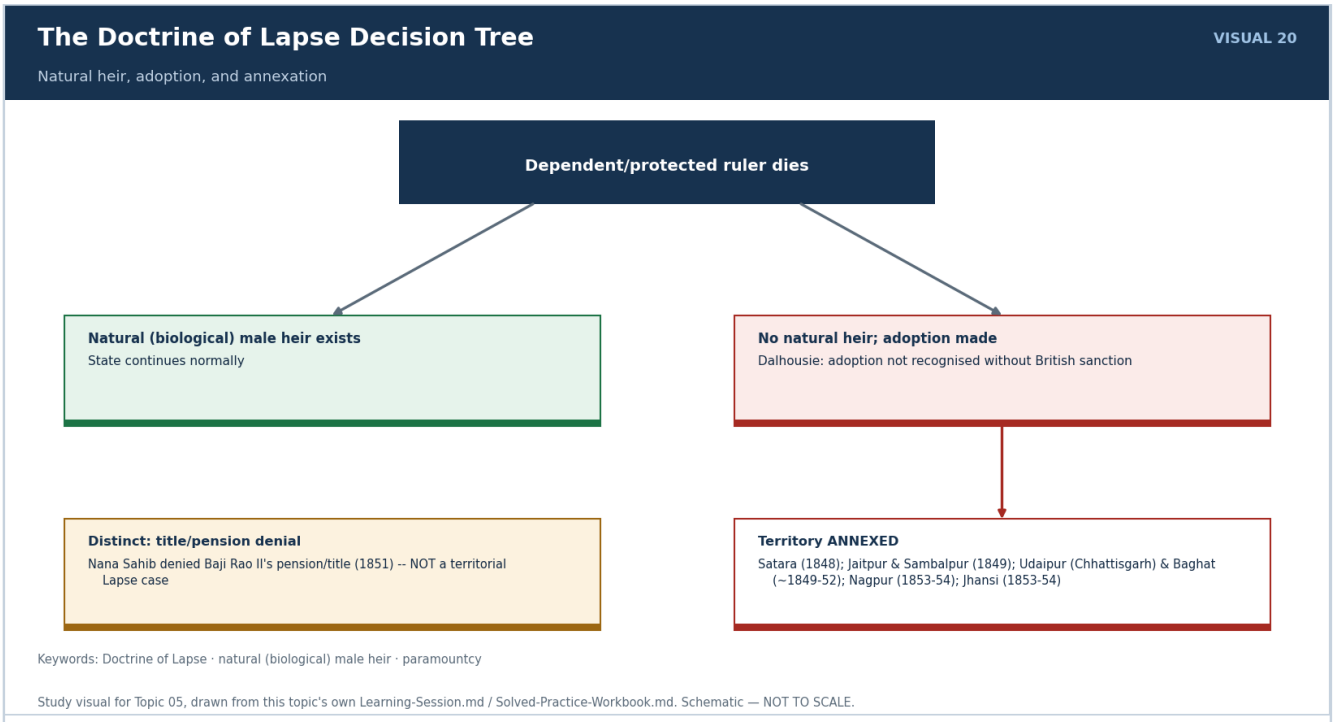
**How to use them:** Frame the answer through principles; define paramountcy, connect the verified cases with Doctrine of Lapse to explain the mechanism, and use natural (biological) male heir for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: Lord Dalhousie, Governor-General from 1848 to 1856, articulated the **Doctrine of Lapse** as an extension of the paramountcy principle already asserted by Lord Hastings (subtopic 13): where a dependent or protected Indian state's ruler died without a **natural (biological) male heir**, Dalhousie held that the Company, as paramount power, could refuse to recognise an adopted heir and instead annex the state outright, on the reasoning that such states existed only by British sufferance and had no independent right to perpetuate themselves through adoption without British sanction. This was a marked hardening of the earlier, more permissive Company practice (under Hastings and others) of generally recognising adoptions in subordinate states unless a specific treaty clause forbade it.

FACT: the clearest, best-attested cases of Lapse annexation under Dalhousie are: **Satara (1848)**, the first case, where the Raja's adopted heir was not recognised; **Jaitpur and Sambalpur (1849)**; further minor Central Indian and hill states including **Udaipur (Chhattisgarh, distinct from the Rajputana Udaipur) and Baghat** in the years around 1849-52; **Nagpur (1853-54)**, where Raghuji III's death without a recognised adopted heir led to annexation and the state's considerable treasury and jewels being appropriated; and **Jhansi (1853-54)**, where Raja Gangadhar Rao's adoption of Damodar Rao shortly before his own death in November 1853 was refused recognition, and the state was annexed -- a decision Rani Lakshmibai contested and that fed directly into her role in the 1857 rising (Part VIII). ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package deliberately does **not** extend the Lapse list further into contested or poorly attested "universal" enumerations found in some popular accounts; only the above, well-corroborated cases are asserted here, consistent with the no-fabrication constraint.

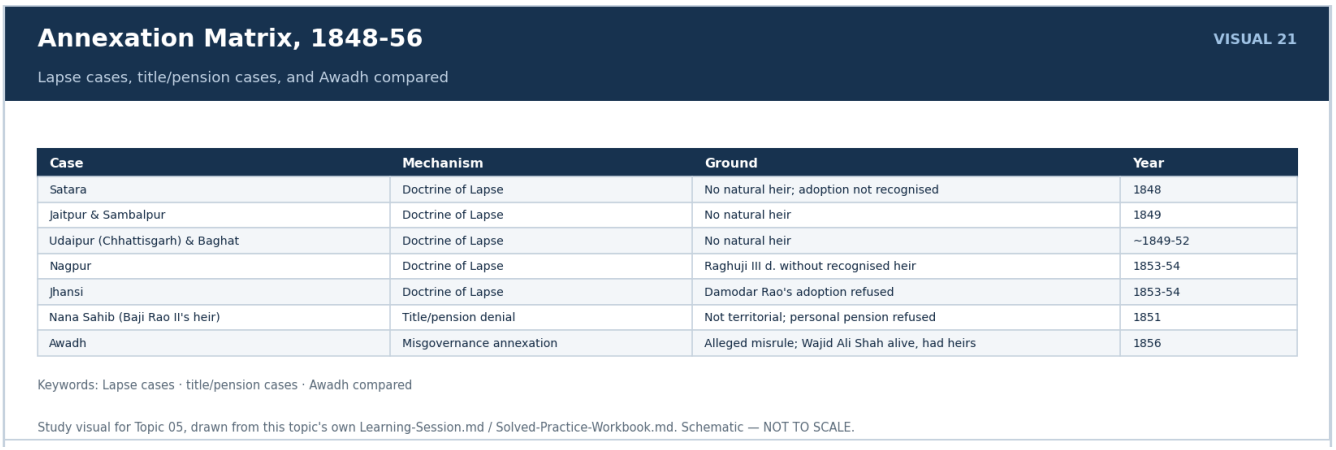
FACT: Dalhousie separately distinguished, in a related but conceptually distinct family of decisions, **title and pension questions** from territorial Lapse proper: when former Peshwa Baji Rao II died at Bithur in 1851, Dalhousie refused to continue his personal pension and title to his adopted son, **Nana Sahib** (Dhondu Pant) -- this was a denial of a

personal pension/title succession, not a territorial annexation (Baji Rao II's Peshwaship had already been abolished in 1818, subtopic 13), and Nana Sahib's resulting grievance is examined as a bounded link in Part VIII. ANALYSIS: keeping the territorial-Lapse cases (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi and the smaller states) analytically separate from title/pension denials (Nana Sahib) is essential precision: both fed resentment toward Company paramountcy, but only the former involved the Doctrine of Lapse as a territorial-annexation instrument in the strict sense.




*Visual 20: the Doctrine of Lapse decision tree -- natural heir, adoption, and annexation*

*Visual 20: the Doctrine of Lapse decision tree -- natural heir, adoption, and annexation. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*




| Case | Mechanism | Ground | Year |
|---|---|---|---|
| Satara | Doctrine of Lapse | No natural heir; adoption not recognised | 1848 |
| Jaitpur & Sambalpur | Doctrine of Lapse | No natural heir | 1849 |
| Udaipur (Chhattisgarh) & Baghat | Doctrine of Lapse | No natural heir | ~1849-52 |
| Nagpur | Doctrine of Lapse | Raghuji III d. without recognised heir | 1853-54 |
| Jhansi | Doctrine of Lapse | Damodar Rao's adoption refused | 1853-54 |
| Nana Sahib (Baji Rao II's heir) | Title/pension denial | Not territorial; personal pension refused | 1851 |
| Awadh | Misgovernance annexation | Alleged misrule; Wajid Ali Shah alive, had heirs | 1856 |

*Visual 21: annexation matrix, 1848-56 -- Lapse cases, title/pension cases, and Awadh compared*

*Visual 21: annexation matrix, 1848-56 -- Lapse cases, title/pension cases, and Awadh compared. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 22. THE DOCTRINE OF LAPSE: PRINCIPLES, PARAMOUNTCY, AND THE VERIFIED CASES

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 22. The Doctrine of Lapse: principles, paramountcy, and the verified cases
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: principles · paramountcy · the verified cases · Doctrine of Lapse · natural (
biological) male heir · 22. The Doctrine of Lapse
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Lord Dalhousie, Governor-General from 1848 to 1856, articulated the Doctrine
of Lapse as an extension of the paramountcy principle already asserted by Lord Hastings (subtopic
13): where a dependent or protected Indian state's ruler died without a natural (biological) male
heir, Dalhousie held that the Company, as paramount power, could refuse to recognise an adopted
heir and instead annex the state outright, on the reasoning that such states existed only by
British sufferance and had no independent right to perpetuate themselves through adoption without
British sanction.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: the clearest, best-attested cases of Lapse annexation under Dalhousie are:
Satara (1848), the first case, where the Raja's adopted heir was not recognised; Jaitpur and
Sambalpur (1849); further minor Central Indian and hill states including Udaipur (Chhattisgarh,
distinct from the Rajputana Udaipur) and Baghat in the years around 1849-52; Nagpur (1853-54),
where Raghuji III's death without a recognised adopted heir led to annexation and the state's
considerable treasury and jewels being appropriated; and Jhansi (1853-54), where Raja Gangadhar
Rao's adoption of Damodar Rao shortly before his own death in November 1853 was refused recognition,
 and the state was annexed -- a decision Rani Lakshmibai contested and that fed directly into her
role in the 1857 rising (Part VIII). ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package deliberately does not extend
the Lapse list further into contested or poorly attested "universal" enumerations found in some
popular accounts; only the above, well-corroborated cases are asserted here, consistent with the no-
fabrication constraint.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Dalhousie separately distinguished, in a related but conceptually distinct
family of decisions, title and pension questions from territorial Lapse proper: when former Peshwa
Baji Rao II died at Bithur in 1851, Dalhousie refused to continue his personal pension and title to
his adopted son, Nana Sahib (Dhondu Pant) -- this was a denial of a personal pension/title
succession, not a territorial annexation (Baji Rao II's Peshwaship had already been abolished in
1818, subtopic 13), and Nana Sahib's resulting grievance is examined as a bounded link in Part VIII.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: ANALYSIS: keeping the territorial-Lapse cases (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi
and the smaller states) analytically separate from title/pension denials (Nana Sahib) is essential
precision: both fed resentment toward Company paramountcy, but only the former involved the
Doctrine of Lapse as a territorial-annexation instrument in the strict sense.
```

# SESSION 23 - CORE - 23. AWADH, 1856: MISGOVERNANCE, EXPLICITLY NOT LAPSE

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** the annexation of Awadh in February 1856 is a distinct case that this package deliberately separates from the Doctrine of Lapse.

**Technical definition:** Awadh's annexation, coming barely a year before 1857 and affecting a large, densely populated and militarily significant recruiting ground for the Company's own Bengal Army sepoys, is widely treated by historians as one of the most immediately inflammatory single acts feeding directly into the events of 1857 (bounded bridge, Part VIII) -- but it must be labelled correctly on its own terms as a misgovernance annexation, structurally and legally separate from the Doctrine of Lapse cases of subtopic 22.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> the annexation of Awadh in February 1856 is a distinct case that this package deliberately separates from the Doctrine of Lapse.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

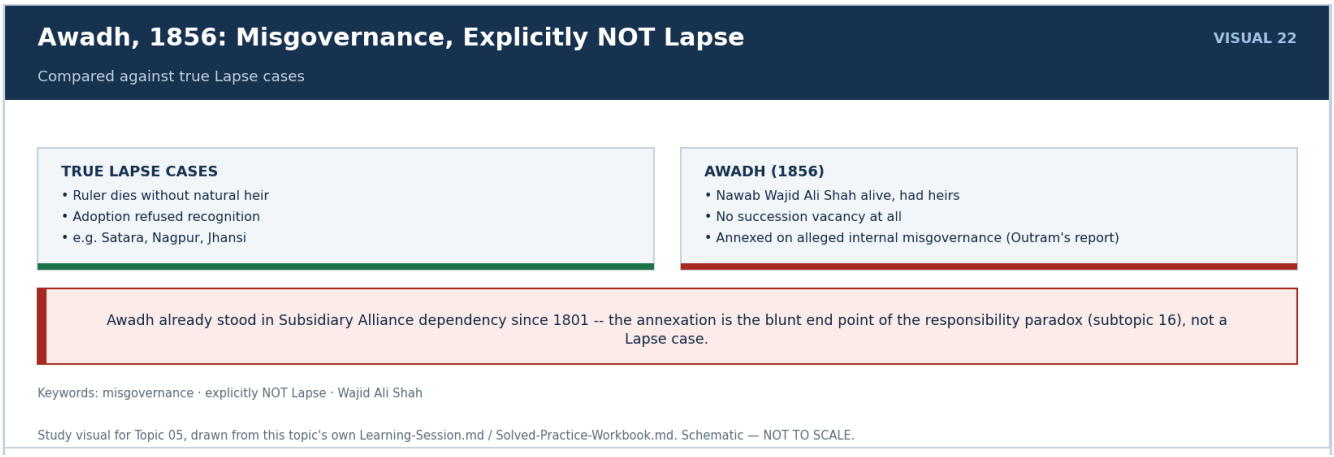
- **misgovernance**
- **explicitly NOT Lapse**

- **annexation of Awadh in February 1856**
- **Wajid Ali Shah**
- **alleged internal misgovernance**
- **23. Awadh**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through misgovernance; define explicitly NOT Lapse, connect annexation of Awadh in February 1856 with Wajid Ali Shah to explain the mechanism, and use alleged internal misgovernance for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: the **annexation of Awadh in February 1856** is a distinct case that this package deliberately separates from the Doctrine of Lapse. Awadh's Nawab, **Wajid Ali Shah**, was alive and had heirs; there was no succession dispute or adoption question at all. Dalhousie's own officer, Governor-General's agent James Outram, prepared a report alleging chronic administrative misrule, judicial corruption and fiscal disorder at Lucknow, and on this basis of **alleged internal misgovernance** -- not any lapse of succession -- the Company annexed Awadh outright, deposing Wajid Ali Shah and pensioning him.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this distinction is one of the most important precision points in the entire package and must not be blurred: Awadh already stood in a Subsidiary Alliance relationship since 1801 (Part IV, subtopic 15), so its annexation is best read as the logical, if unusually blunt, end point of the **indirect-rule responsibility paradox** examined in subtopic 16 -- a state whose ruler had long been stripped of his own army, independent finances and diplomatic capacity by the very Subsidiary Alliance the Company had imposed, was then judged and annexed for misgoverning within the residual authority he had been left. Awadh's annexation, coming barely a year before 1857 and affecting a large, densely populated and militarily significant recruiting ground for the Company's own Bengal Army sepoys, is widely treated by historians as one of the most immediately inflammatory single acts feeding directly into the events of 1857 (bounded bridge, Part VIII) -- but it must be labelled correctly on its own terms as a **misgovernance annexation**, structurally and legally separate from the Doctrine of Lapse cases of subtopic 22.




*Visual 22: Awadh 1856 -- misgovernance annexation compared against true Lapse cases*

*Visual 22: Awadh 1856 -- misgovernance annexation compared against true Lapse cases. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## PART VIII - BRIDGE TO 1857, HISTORIOGRAPHY, AND COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - 23. AWADH, 1856: MISGOVERNANCE, EXPLICITLY NOT LAPSE

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE - 23. Awadh, 1856: misgovernance, explicitly NOT Lapse
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: misgovernance · explicitly NOT Lapse · annexation of Awadh in February 1856 · Wajid
Ali Shah · alleged internal misgovernance · 23. Awadh
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Awadh's annexation, coming barely a year before 1857 and affecting a large,
densely populated and militarily significant recruiting ground for the Company's own Bengal Army
sepoys, is widely treated by historians as one of the most immediately inflammatory single acts
feeding directly into the events of 1857 (bounded bridge, Part VIII) -- but it must be labelled
correctly on its own terms as a misgovernance annexation, structurally and legally separate from
the Doctrine of Lapse cases of subtopic 22.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this distinction is one of the most important precision
points in the entire package and must not be blurred: Awadh already stood in a Subsidiary Alliance
relationship since 1801 (Part IV, subtopic 15), so its annexation is best read as the logical, if
unusually blunt, end point of the indirect-rule responsibility paradox examined in subtopic 16 -- a
state whose ruler had long been stripped of his own army, independent finances and diplomatic
capacity by the very Subsidiary Alliance the Company had imposed, was then judged and annexed for
misgoverning within the residual authority he had been left.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: awadh's Nawab, Wajid Ali Shah, was
alive and had heirs.
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: the annexation of Awadh in February 1856 is a distinct case that this
package deliberately separates from the Doctrine of Lapse.
```

# SESSION 24 - CORE SYNTHESIS - 24. DISPOSSESSION AND THE ROAD TO 1857: A BOUNDED BRIDGE, NOT A MONOCAUSAL CLAIM

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package states only a bounded, non-monocausal linkage: these named grievances -- Nana Sahib's, the Rani of Jhansi's, the Awadh taluqdars', and disbanded soldiers' -- are well-attested antecedents that fed into the wider crisis of 1857, and figures such as Nana Sahib and the Rani of Jhansi did become prominent rebel leaders in 1857.

**Technical definition:** Technically, CORE SYNTHESIS - 24. Dispossession and the road to 1857: a bounded bridge, not a monocausal claim is analysed by relating CORE SYNTHESIS to the road to 1857, then testing the relationship through a bounded bridge and not a monocausal claim.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package states only a bounded, non-monocausal linkage: these named grievances -- Nana Sahib's, the Rani of Jhansi's, the Awadh taluqdars', and disbanded soldiers' -- are well-attested antecedents that fed into the wider crisis of 1857, and figures such as Nana Sahib and the Rani of Jhansi did become prominent rebel leaders in 1857.

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

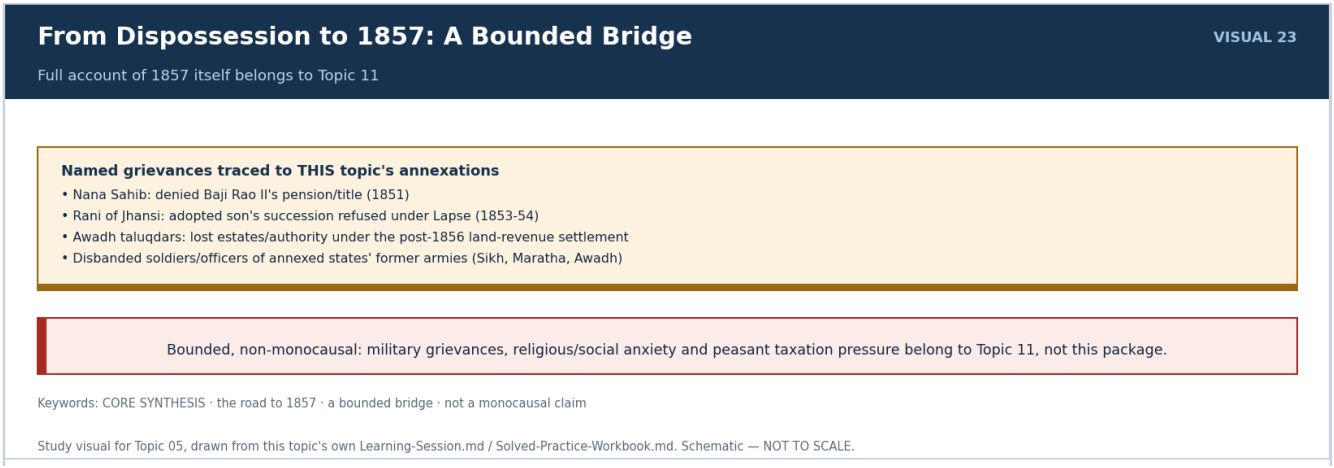
- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **the road to 1857**
- **a bounded bridge**
- **not a monocausal claim**
- **Nana Sahib**
- **24. Dispossession**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define the road to 1857, connect a bounded bridge with not a monocausal claim to explain the mechanism, and use Nana Sahib for the decisive comparison or qualification.

*(Topic 11 owns the 1857 rising itself -- causes, spread, suppression and consequences -- in full; this subtopic states only the narrow, bounded linkage between this package's expansion story and that later event.)*

FACT: by 1856, the territorial expansion traced across Parts II-VII had produced several distinct categories of dispossessed or aggrieved actors whose specific grievances are directly traceable to named episodes within this package: **Nana Sahib**, denied his adoptive father Baji Rao II's pension and title in 1851 (subtopic 22); the **Rani of Jhansi**, whose adopted son's succession was refused under Lapse in 1853-54 (subtopic 22); the **taluqdars (large landholders) of Awadh**, many of whom lost long-held estates and local authority under the land-revenue settlement the Company imposed after the 1856 annexation (subtopic 23); and substantial numbers of disbanded soldiers and unemployed officers from annexed states' former armies (subtopics 16, 21) who lost both livelihood and social standing. Awadh additionally supplied a very large proportion of the Company's own Bengal Army sepoy recruits, so its 1856 annexation directly touched the loyalties and family connections of soldiers serving within the Company's own ranks.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package states only a **bounded, non-monocausal** linkage: these named grievances -- Nana Sahib's, the Rani of Jhansi's, the Awadh taluqdars', and disbanded soldiers' -- are well-attested antecedents that fed into the wider crisis of 1857, and figures such as Nana Sahib and the Rani of Jhansi did become prominent rebel leaders in 1857. It is incorrect, however, to claim that territorial expansion and annexation alone "caused" 1857; the rising's fuller causal picture -- military grievances (the greased cartridges controversy), religious and social anxieties, land-revenue and taxation pressures on peasants, and the specific sequence of the sepoy mutiny's spread -- belongs entirely to **Topic 11**, which this package explicitly defers to for the event itself. What this package owns and asserts is only the **supply of dispossessed actors and grievances** that expansion (as traced in Parts II-VII) fed into that wider crisis.




*Visual 23: from dispossession to 1857 -- a bounded bridge (full account at Topic 11)*

*Visual 23: from dispossession to 1857 -- a bounded bridge (full account at Topic 11). Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - 24. DISPOSSESSION AND THE ROAD TO 1857: A BOUNDED BRIDGE, NOT A MONOCAUSAL CLAIM

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - 24. Dispossession and the road to 1857: a bounded bridge, not a
monocausal claim
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · the road to 1857 · a bounded bridge · not a monocausal claim · Nana
Sahib · 24. Dispossession
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: by 1856, the territorial expansion traced across Parts II-VII had produced
several distinct categories of dispossessed or aggrieved actors whose specific grievances are
directly traceable to named episodes within this package: Nana Sahib, denied his adoptive father
Baji Rao II's pension and title in 1851 (subtopic 22); the Rani of Jhansi, whose adopted son's
succession was refused under Lapse in 1853-54 (subtopic 22); the taluqdars (large landholders) of
Awadh, many of whom lost long-held estates and local authority under the land-revenue settlement
the Company imposed after the 1856 annexation (subtopic 23); and substantial numbers of disbanded
soldiers and unemployed officers from annexed states' former armies (subtopics 16, 21) who lost
both livelihood and social standing.
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: It is incorrect, however, to claim that territorial expansion and
annexation alone "caused" 1857; the rising's fuller causal picture -- military grievances (the
greased cartridges controversy), religious and social anxieties, land-revenue and taxation
pressures on peasants, and the specific sequence of the sepoy mutiny's spread -- belongs entirely
to Topic 11, which this package explicitly defers to for the event itself.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: what this package owns and asserts
is only the supply of dispossessed actors and...
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: this package states only a bounded, non-monocausal
linkage: these named grievances -- Nana Sahib's, the Rani of Jhansi's, the Awadh taluqdars', and
disbanded soldiers' -- are well-attested antecedents that fed into the wider crisis of 1857, and
figures such as Nana Sahib and the Rani of Jhansi did become prominent rebel leaders in 1857.
```

# SESSION 25 - CORE SYNTHESIS - 25. HISTORIOGRAPHY: FOUR LENSES ON BRITISH TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

### DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: an examiner-grade answer should be able to name at least two of these four lenses, attribute them to the correct historiographical tradition, and use them to organise evidence rather than treating "the British won because they were superior" as a sufficient explanation in itself; the strongest analytical move is combining the fiscal-military lens (explaining capacity) with the collaboration/agency lens (explaining why that capacity found local partners and exploitable divisions).

**Technical definition:** the collaboration and Indian-agency lens (drawing on the broader "collaboration" historiographical tradition and Seema Alavi's specific work on sepoy recruitment) emphasises that the Company's military and administrative machine was staffed overwhelmingly by Indian soldiers, bankers, revenue officials and regional allies (subtopics 3-4, 9, 12), and that regional rulers' own alliance calculations (the Nizam and Marathas alternating sides across the Mysore wars, subtopic 6; the Gaekwad's support in the Second Maratha War, subtopic 12) were autonomous, self-interested decisions by Indian actors, not simple British manipulation of passive subjects.

### ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: an examiner-grade answer should be able to name at least two of these four lenses, attribute them to the correct historiographical tradition, and use them to organise evidence rather than treating "the British won because they were superior" as a sufficient explanation in itself; the strongest analytical move is combining the fiscal-military lens (explaining capacity) with the collaboration/agency lens (explaining why that capacity found local partners and exploitable divisions).

### MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**

- **four lenses on British territorial expansion**
- **the nationalist conquest-critique lens**
- **the fiscal-military or corporate-state lens**
- **rival fiscal-military state projects**
- **25. Historiography**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define four lenses on British territorial expansion, connect the nationalist conquest-critique lens with the fiscal-military or corporate-state lens to explain the mechanism, and use rival fiscal-military state projects for the decisive comparison or qualification.

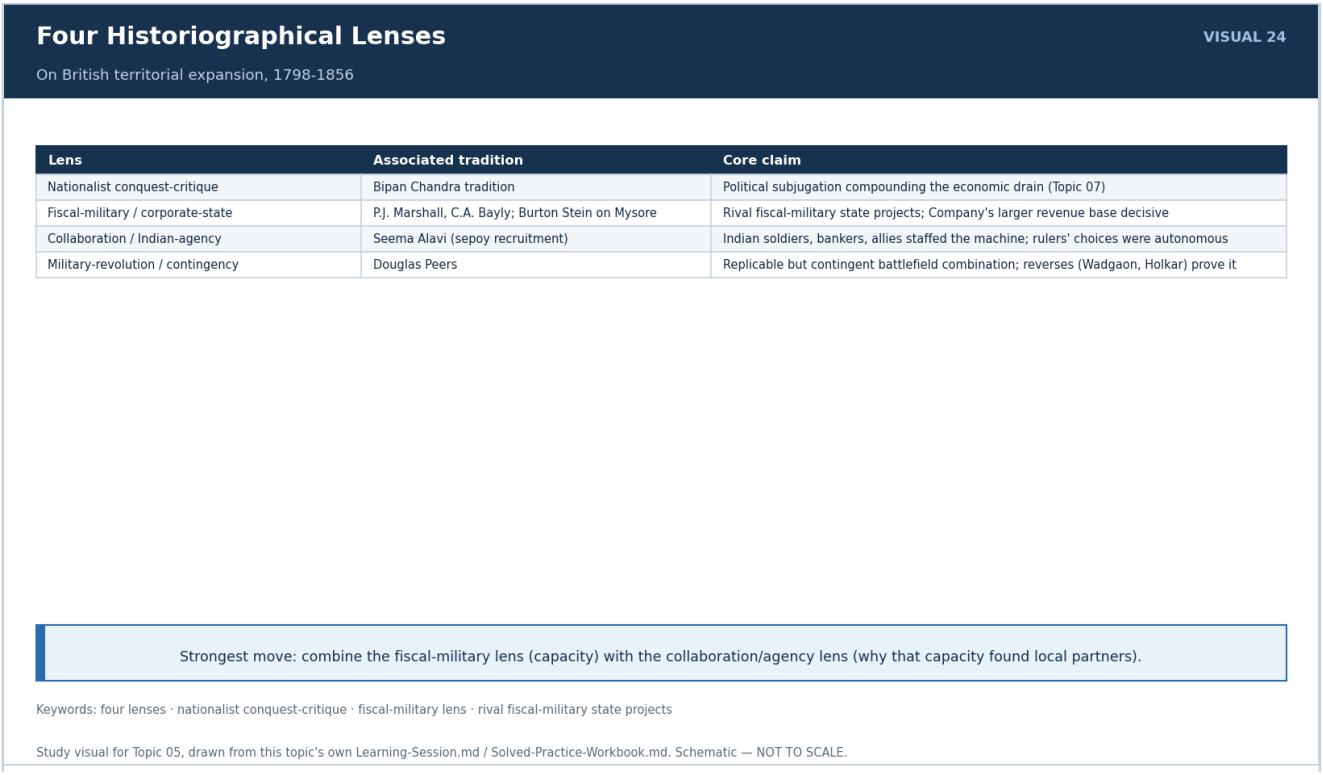
FACT: **the nationalist conquest-critique lens** (associated with writers in the Bipan Chandra tradition among others) reads Company expansion as a sustained project of political subjugation compounding the economic drain examined at Topic 07, emphasising broken treaty promises (Wadgaon's terms overturned, Bassein's coercive origin, Awadh's residual sovereignty stripped before its 1856 annexation), and Company contemporaries' own candid admissions of dubious legality (Napier's Sindh diary entry, subtopic 17; the "fattening allies" characterisation of the Subsidiary Alliance, subtopic 14) as direct evidence of conquest dressed in treaty language.

FACT: **the fiscal-military or corporate-state lens** (associated with scholarship in the tradition of P.J. Marshall and C.A. Bayly, and applied to Mysore specifically by Burton Stein's "military fiscalism" framing, subtopic 5) reads the entire contest less as a clash of "British" versus "Indian" civilisations and more as a competition between **rival fiscal-military state projects** -- Company Bengal, Tipu's Mysore, and to a lesser degree the Maratha houses and Ranjit Singh's Punjab -- each attempting to convert agrarian revenue into standing military capacity, with the Company's structurally larger and more diversified revenue base (Part I, subtopics 3-4) proving decisive over time rather than any inherent civilisational or technological gap.

FACT: **the collaboration and Indian-agency lens** (drawing on the broader "collaboration" historiographical tradition and Seema Alavi's specific work on sepoy recruitment) emphasises that the Company's military and administrative machine was staffed overwhelmingly by Indian soldiers, bankers, revenue officials and regional allies (subtopics 3-4, 9, 12), and that regional rulers' own alliance calculations (the Nizam and Marathas alternating sides across the Mysore wars, subtopic 6; the Gaekwad's support in the Second Maratha War, subtopic 12) were autonomous, self-interested decisions by Indian actors, not simple British manipulation of passive subjects.

FACT: **the military-revolution and contingency lens** (drawing on Douglas Peers's "Anglo-Indian militarism" framing and this package's own contingency argument, subtopic 2) stresses that the Company's repeated battlefield successes rested on a specific, replicable combination of disciplined infantry drill, standardised artillery, reliable logistics and credit (subtopics 3-4) that was itself contingent and reversible -- as the Company's own reverses at Wadgaon (1779), against Tipu in the Second Mysore War, and against Holkar (1804-05) demonstrate -- rather than an inevitable or predetermined outcome.

ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: an examiner-grade answer should be able to name at least two of these four lenses, attribute them to the correct historiographical tradition, and use them to organise evidence rather than treating "the British won because they were superior" as a sufficient explanation in itself; the strongest analytical move is combining the fiscal-military lens (explaining *capacity*) with the collaboration/agency lens (explaining *why that capacity found local partners and exploitable divisions*).




*Visual 24: four historiographical lenses on British territorial expansion*

*Visual 24: four historiographical lenses on British territorial expansion. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - 25. HISTORIOGRAPHY: FOUR LENSES ON BRITISH TERRITORIAL EXPANSION

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - 25. Historiography: four lenses on British territorial expansion
|
v
EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · four lenses on British territorial expansion · the nationalist conquest-critique lens · the fiscal-military or corporate-state lens · rival fiscal-military state projects · 25. Historiography
|
v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: the collaboration and Indian-agency lens (drawing on the broader "collaboration" historiographical tradition and Seema Alavi's specific work on sepoy recruitment) emphasises that the Company's military and administrative machine was staffed overwhelmingly by Indian soldiers, bankers, revenue officials and regional allies (subtopics 3-4, 9, 12), and that regional rulers' own alliance calculations (the Nizam and Marathas alternating sides across the Mysore wars, subtopic 6; the Gaekwad's support in the Second Maratha War, subtopic 12) were autonomous, self-interested decisions by Indian actors, not simple British manipulation of passive subjects.
|
v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: the military-revolution and contingency lens (drawing on Douglas Peers's "Anglo-Indian militarism" framing and this package's own contingency argument, subtopic 2) stresses that the Company's repeated battlefield successes rested on a specific, replicable combination of disciplined infantry drill, standardised artillery, reliable logistics and credit (subtopics 3-4) that was itself contingent and reversible -- as the Company's own reverses at Wadgaon (1779), against Tipu in the Second Mysore War, and against Holkar (1804-05) demonstrate -- rather than an inevitable or predetermined outcome.
|
v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the collaboration and Indian-agency lens (drawing on the broader "collaboration" historiographical tradition and Seema...
|
v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: ANALYSIS: ANALYSIS: an examiner-grade answer should be able to name at least two of these four lenses, attribute them to the correct historiographical tradition, and use them to organise evidence rather than treating "the British won because they were superior" as a sufficient explanation in itself; the strongest analytical move is combining the fiscal-military lens (explaining capacity) with the collaboration/agency lens (explaining why that capacity found local partners and exploitable divisions).

# SESSION 26 - CORE SYNTHESIS - 26. COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS: MYSORE VS MARATHA VS SIKH; WAR VS ALLIANCE VS LAPSE VS MISGOVERNANCE

## DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

**Plain-language definition:** ANALYSIS: the single most important synthesis point for a Mains answer is that the Company selected its instrument case by case according to the specific balance of local military strength, alliance opportunity, and existing dependency status -- a genuinely contingent, adaptive process (subtopic 2), not a single fixed formula mechanically applied to every state encountered between 1767 and 1856.

**Technical definition:** the instruments of subordination employed were correspondingly distinct and must not be conflated: outright war followed by partition and a subsidiary settlement (Mysore 1799; Punjab's path via 1846 dependency to 1849 annexation); war followed by systematic Subsidiary Alliance dependency without immediate annexation (the Peshwa after Bassein 1802; the Nizam from 1798; Awadh from 1801); the Doctrine of Lapse, applied specifically to succession-without-natural-heir cases in already-dependent or protected minor and princely states (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi); misgovernance annexation, applied uniquely to Awadh in 1856 on grounds of alleged internal misrule rather than succession; and direct frontier conquest, applied to Sindh in 1843 on primarily strategic-commercial grounds.

## ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

> the instruments of subordination employed were correspondingly distinct and must not be conflated: outright war followed by partition and a subsidiary settlement (Mysore 1799; Punjab's path via 1846 dependency to 1849 annexation); war followed by systematic Subsidiary Alliance dependency without immediate annexation (the Peshwa after Bassein 1802; the Nizam from 1798; Awadh from 1801); the Doctrine of Lapse, applied specifically to succession-without-natural-heir cases in already-dependent or protected minor and princely states (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi); misgovernance annexation, applied uniquely to Awadh in 1856 on grounds of alleged internal misrule rather than succession; and direct frontier conquest, applied to Sindh in 1843 on primarily strategic-commercial grounds.

## MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **CORE SYNTHESIS**
- **Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh**
- **war vs alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance**
- **Mysore**
- **The Marathas**
- **26. Comparative synthesis**

**How to use them:** Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh, connect war vs alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance with Mysore to explain the mechanism, and use The Marathas for the decisive comparison or qualification.

FACT: placing the three major fronts side by side sharpens the comparative point examiners repeatedly test. **Mysore** (Part II) was defeated in a sequence of four wars fought against a single, reform-capable centralised state whose resistance ultimately failed for want of a durable regional coalition (the Marathas and Hyderabad sided with the Company in three of four wars) rather than for want of administrative or military capacity. **The Marathas** (Part III) were a structurally decentralised five-house confederacy whose resistance was progressively hollowed out less by any single battlefield defeat than by internal succession crises (1800-02) that the Company's diplomacy (Bassein) converted into sequential, separable conflicts -- ending not in a negotiated peace of equals (as in 1782) but in the outright abolition of the Peshwaship itself (1818). **The Sikh Empire** (Part VI) was, under Ranjit Singh, the one major power the Company treated as a genuine negotiating equal (Amritsar, 1809) precisely because of its demonstrated military strength; only after his death produced the same kind of succession-driven internal fragmentation seen among the Marathas did the Company move to war (1845-46) and, after a second rising, outright annexation (1849).

FACT: the instruments of subordination employed were correspondingly distinct and must not be conflated: **outright war followed by partition and a subsidiary settlement** (Mysore 1799; Punjab's path via 1846 dependency to 1849

annexation); **war followed by systematic Subsidiary Alliance dependency without immediate annexation** (the Peshwa after Bassein 1802; the Nizam from 1798; Awadh from 1801); **the Doctrine of Lapse**, applied specifically to succession-without-natural-heir cases in already-dependent or protected minor and princely states (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi); **misgovernance annexation**, applied uniquely to Awadh in 1856 on grounds of alleged internal misrule rather than succession; and **direct frontier conquest**, applied to Sindh in 1843 on primarily strategic-commercial grounds. ANALYSIS: the single most important synthesis point for a Mains answer is that **the Company selected its instrument case by case according to the specific balance of local military strength, alliance opportunity, and existing dependency status** -- a genuinely contingent, adaptive process (subtopic 2), not a single fixed formula mechanically applied to every state encountered between 1767 and 1856.

## Comparative Resistance: Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh

VISUAL 25

Four distinct instruments of subordination

| Front | Structure | Why resistance ended |
|---|---|---|
| Mysore | Single reform-capable centralised state | No durable regional coalition (Marathas/Nizam WITH Company in 3 of 4 wars) |
| Marathas | Decentralised five-house confederacy | Succession crises (1800-02) -> serial defeat, not one battle; Peshwaship abolished 1818 |
| Sikh Empire | Unified under Ranjit Singh (treated as equal, 1809) | Post-1839 succession fragmentation -> war (1845-46) -> annexation (1849) |

Instruments: war+partition+subsidiary (Mysore, Punjab) · war then Subsidiary Alliance (Peshwa, Nizam, Awadh) · Doctrine of Lapse (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi) · misgovernance (Awadh) · frontier conquest (Sindh)

Keywords: Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh · war vs alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance

Study visual for Topic 05, drawn from this topic's own Learning-Session.md / Solved-Practice-Workbook.md. Schematic — NOT TO SCALE.

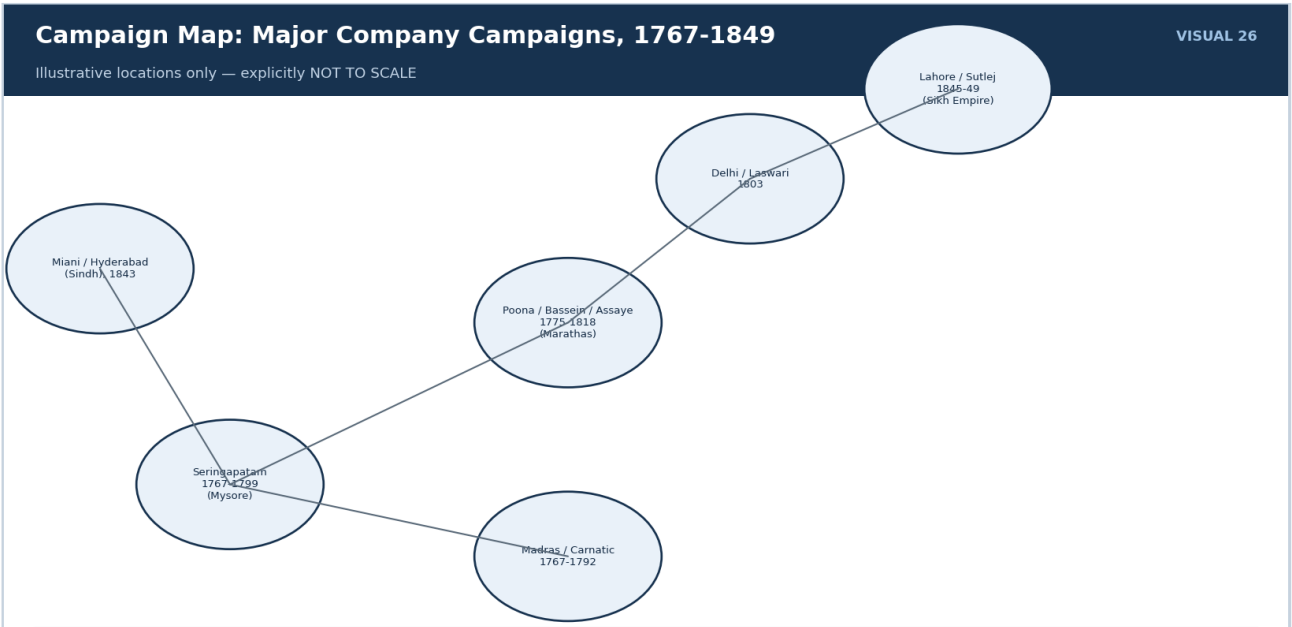
*Visual 25: comparative resistance -- Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh, and the four distinct instruments of subordination*

*Visual 25: comparative resistance -- Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh, and the four distinct instruments of subordination. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

## Campaign Map: Major Company Campaigns, 1767-1849

VISUAL 26

Illustrative locations only — explicitly NOT TO SCALE




Locations are schematic markers for teaching sequence only; no geographic precision is claimed or required.

Keywords: campaign map · not to scale

Study visual for Topic 05, drawn from this topic's own Learning-Session.md / Solved-Practice-Workbook.md. Schematic — NOT TO SCALE.

*Visual 26: campaign map of major Company campaigns, 1767-1849 (illustrative locations only)*

*Visual 26: campaign map of major Company campaigns, 1767-1849. This is a schematic, illustrative location map and is explicitly NOT TO SCALE.*

## PART IX - SOURCES, PYQ AUDIT AND PRACTICE

### CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - 26. COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS: MYSORE VS MARATHA VS SIKH; WAR VS ALLIANCE VS LAPSE VS MISGOVERNANCE

```
START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - 26. Comparative synthesis: Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh; war vs
alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance
        |
        v
EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Mysore vs Maratha vs Sikh · war vs alliance vs lapse vs misgovernance
· Mysore · The Marathas · 26. Comparative synthesis
        |
        v
MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Sikh Empire (Part VI) was, under Ranjit Singh, the one major power the
Company treated as a genuine negotiating equal (Amritsar, 1809) precisely because of its
demonstrated military strength; only after his death produced the same kind of succession-driven
internal fragmentation seen among the Marathas did the Company move to war (1845-46) and, after a
second rising, outright annexation (1849).
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: ANALYSIS: the single most important synthesis point for a Mains answer is
that the Company selected its instrument case by case according to the specific balance of local
military strength, alliance opportunity, and existing dependency status -- a genuinely contingent,
adaptive process (subtopic 2), not a single fixed formula mechanically applied to every state
encountered between 1767 and 1856.
        |
        v
UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The Marathas (Part III) were a structurally decentralised five-house
confederacy whose resistance was progressively hollowed out less by any single battlefield defeat
than by internal succession crises (1800-02) that the Company's diplomacy (Bassein) converted into
sequential, separable conflicts -- ending not in a negotiated peace of equals (as in 1782) but in
the outright abolition of the Peshwaship itself (1818).
        |
        v
ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: the instruments of subordination employed were correspondingly
distinct and must not be conflated: outright war followed by partition and a subsidiary settlement (
Mysore 1799; Punjab's path via 1846 dependency to 1849 annexation); war followed by systematic
Subsidiary Alliance dependency without immediate annexation (the Peshwa after Bassein 1802; the
Nizam from 1798; Awadh from 1801); the Doctrine of Lapse, applied specifically to succession-
without-natural-heir cases in already-dependent or protected minor and princely states (Satara,
Nagpur, Jhansi); misgovernance annexation, applied uniquely to Awadh in 1856 on grounds of alleged
internal misrule rather than succession; and direct frontier conquest, applied to Sindh in 1843 on
primarily strategic-commercial grounds.
```

### MODERN HISTORY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Keep the Anglo-Mysore, Anglo-Maratha and Anglo-Sikh wars in their distinct sequences, and separate Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance from Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse.
- **Close distinction:** Awadh was annexed in 1856 on the stated ground of misgovernment, not under the Doctrine of Lapse; treaty, subsidiary control, conquest and annexation are not synonyms.
- **Evidence / interpretation limit:** Campaign maps, treaty clauses, succession disputes and Indian alliance choices qualify any account of uniform British military superiority or passive regional defeat.

### TOPIC 05 CLOSING TERRITORIAL-EXPANSION LEDGER

Topic 05 owns Company expansion beyond Bengal through Mysore, Maratha and Sikh war sequences, Sindh, Indian sepoy/ally/credit participation and the distinct instruments of ring-fence, Subsidiary Alliance, paramountcy, conquest, lapse and alleged misgovernment. Topic 04 retains Bengal conquest; Topic 06 owns constitutional structure; Topic 11 owns the full 1857 explanation.

Bengal Diwani fed a fiscal-military flywheel: revenue and credit paid sepoys, officers, artillery and supply; alliances isolated opponents; victories yielded indemnity or territory and enlarged the resource base. This was contingent: Haidar reached Madras, Mangalore was negotiated, Wadgaon checked the Company and Holkar resisted.

Keep four Mysore wars, three Maratha wars and two Sikh wars in their own chronologies. Bassein (1802) weakened the confederate centre but did not end Maratha resistance. Ranjit Singh died in 1839 and fought no Anglo-Sikh war;

Amritsar (1809) was not a Subsidiary Alliance.

Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance stationed Company troops and transferred diplomatic/military autonomy through cash subsidy or territorial cession. Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse concerned disputed adoption/succession in dependent states. Awadh (1856) was annexed for alleged misgovernment; Nana Sahib's issue was pension/title; Sindh (1843) was frontier conquest.

Exactly two direct routes are verified: 2018 Prelims Q75 on Subsidiary Alliance (key inferred because unavailable locally) and 2022 GS-I Q2 on why Company armies prevailed (Mains has no objective key).

**Answer: fiscal-military base -> campaign chronology -> diplomacy and Indian agency -> instrument-by-instrument sovereignty loss -> reverses/contingency -> bounded 1857 bridge -> adaptive, not inevitable, expansion verdict.**

## BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

### Q1. Which sequence correctly orders the "rungs" of Company territorial expansion introduced in this topic's analytical frame?

A. Ring-fence a friendly buffer state, impose subsidiary dependency, assert paramountcy, then annex B. Assert paramountcy first, then create buffers, then negotiate subsidiary status C. Impose subsidiary dependency before any buffer state exists, then annex without paramountcy D. Annex first, then impose a buffer, then negotiate paramountcy

**Answer: A. Explanation: Subtopic 1 establishes this as the recurring, though not universally rigid, escalation logic -- buffer/ring-fence first, then subsidiary dependency, then the broader paramountcy claim (Hastings, 1813), with annexation as a possible final step, not a fixed first move.**

### Q2. Which of the following is the clearest direct evidence against a purely "inevitable Company victory" reading of this period?

A. The Subsidiary Alliance's six core clauses B. The Company's own reverses at Wadgaon (1779) and against Holkar (1804-05) C. The Treaty of Amritsar's negotiated boundary D. The size of the Bengal Army by 1856

**Answer: B. Explanation: Subtopic 2's contingency argument is best supported by named Company defeats or stalemates, showing outcomes were not predetermined; the other options describe Company strength or negotiated settlements, not reverses.**

### Q3. Historian Burton Stein's term "military fiscalism," as applied to Tipu Sultan's Mysore, refers specifically to which practice?

A. Reliance solely on plunder from neighbouring states for army funding B. A policy of refusing all taxation in favour of voluntary contributions C. Direct, broad-based state revenue collection deliberately mobilised to sustain a large standing army D. A system copied wholesale from contemporary British parliamentary taxation

**Answer: C. Explanation: Subtopic 5 defines Stein's "military fiscalism" precisely this way -- direct assessment replacing intermediary-based collection, specifically to fund centralised military capacity, structurally comparable to the Company's own Bengal-based strategy.**

### Q4. In which Anglo-Mysore War did the Marathas and the Nizam of Hyderabad fight ALONGSIDE Haidar Ali/Tipu Sultan, AGAINST the Company?

A. The Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799) B. The Third Anglo-Mysore War (1790-92) C. The First Anglo-Mysore War (1767-69) D. The Second Anglo-Mysore War (1780-84)

**Answer: D. Explanation: Subtopic 6 states this precisely: the Marathas and the Nizam sided with the Company in the First and Third wars, but joined Haidar Ali against the Company in the Second War -- a frequently tested alliance-sequencing point.**

### Q5. After the fall of Seringapatam in 1799, what happened to Mysore's core territory and its ruling dynasty?

A. It was restored to the Wodeyar dynasty, but immediately bound by a Subsidiary Alliance authorising British assumption of administration if judged necessary B. It was given independently to the Nizam of Hyderabad as a reward C. It was annexed outright and never restored to any Indian ruling family D. It was declared a fully sovereign, unrestricted kingdom under Tipu's own surviving family

**Answer: A. Explanation: Subtopic 8 confirms the Wodeyar restoration alongside immediate subsidiary subordination -- nominal restoration combined with substantive dependency, not full annexation and not unrestricted sovereignty.**

### Q6. Which five houses together made up the Maratha confederacy discussed in this topic?

A. The Peshwa, the Nizam, the Wodeyar, the Sikh Khalsa, and the Amirs of Sindh B. The Peshwa (Poona), Sindhia (Gwalior), Holkar (Indore), Bhonsle (Nagpur), and Gaekwad (Baroda) C. Sindhia, Holkar, Bhonsle, Gaekwad, and the Mughal emperor D. The Peshwa, Sindhia, Holkar, the Rani of Jhansi, and Nana Sahib

**Answer: B. Explanation: Subtopic 9 names exactly these five houses; the other options mix in unrelated states or actors from entirely different fronts (Sikh, Sindh) or later periods (Jhansi, Nana Sahib).**

### Q7. Why is the Treaty of Bassein (1802) described in this topic as the single most consequential turning point in Company-Maratha relations?

A. It ended all Maratha military resistance permanently and immediately B. It restored Baji Rao II's full, unrestricted sovereignty C. It removed the Peshwa, the confederacy's nominal head, from the field of opposition, converting an external contest into separable conflicts with individual houses D. It formally annexed the entire Maratha confederacy to the Company

**Answer: C. Explanation: Subtopic 11 explains that Bassein's significance lies in enabling serial isolation of Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar individually, not in ending resistance outright (which continued through 1818) or in formal annexation (which came only in 1818 for the Peshwaship).**

### Q8. What was the ultimate outcome for the Peshwaship at the end of the Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817-18)?

A. It passed to Yeshwant Rao Holkar as the new Peshwa B. It was restored with expanded powers under British protection C. It was merged permanently with the Nizam's Hyderabad state D. It was abolished outright; Baji Rao II was deposed and pensioned at Bithur

**Answer: D. Explanation: Subtopic 13 confirms the Peshwaship's outright abolition, never restored -- a sharper outcome than the dependency (not abolition) imposed on Hyderabad, Awadh or Mysore.**

### Q9. Which of the following was NOT one of the Subsidiary Alliance's six core clauses as set out in this topic?

A. Permanent stationing of a British force at the ruler's own expense, with no promise of Company protection in return B. A ban on employing Europeans without British approval C. Acceptance of a British Resident at the ruler's court D. A restriction on independent diplomacy or war-making without consulting the Governor-General

**Answer: A. Explanation: Subtopic 14 states the Company DID undertake, at least formally, to defend the ruler in return -- a promise seldom honoured in practice, but nominally present; describing the arrangement as offering no reciprocal promise at all misstates the sixth clause.**

### Q10. In which order did Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance system spread across major states, per the verified case sequence in this topic?

A. Bassein (1802), then Mysore (1799), then Hyderabad (1798), then Awadh (1801) B. Hyderabad (1798), then Mysore (1799), then Awadh (1801), then the Peshwa via Bassein (1802) C. Mysore (1799), then Awadh (1801), then Bassein (1802), then Hyderabad (1798) D. Awadh (1801), then Hyderabad (1798), then Mysore (1799), then Bassein (1802)

**Answer: B. Explanation: Subtopic 15 fixes this exact chronological sequence -- Hyderabad first, Mysore immediately after conquest, then Awadh, then the Peshwa -- a frequently tested ordering point.**

### Q11. What was the primary strategic-commercial context that drew Company attention to Sindh before its 1843 annexation?

A. A succession dispute among the Talpur Amirs requiring British arbitration B. A religious dispute requiring British intervention C. A desire to control the Indus river trade route and secure the north-western frontier approaches amid wider concern over Russian and Persian influence D. A request from the Amirs themselves for British administrative merger

**Answer: C. Explanation: Subtopic 17 identifies this commercial-strategic frontier logic as Sindh's defining context, not a succession dispute (that mechanism belongs to Lapse cases), a request for merger, or a religious dispute.**

### Q12. The Treaty of Amritsar (1809) between the Company and Ranjit Singh established which boundary and relationship?

A. A boundary at the Indus river, with Ranjit Singh accepting British paramountcy B. Outright Company annexation of Lahore C. Full Subsidiary Alliance status for Ranjit Singh's kingdom D. The Sutlej river as boundary, recognising Ranjit Singh's sovereignty north and west of it, with cis-Sutlej chiefs under Company protection

**Answer: D. Explanation: Subtopic 18 confirms Amritsar as a negotiated boundary treaty between comparative equals, not a Subsidiary Alliance or annexation -- the Sutlej, not the Indus, was the fixed boundary.**

### Q13. Which four battles, in correct chronological order, decided the First Anglo-Sikh War (1845-46)?

A. Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon B. Chillianwala, Gujrat, Ramnagar, Multan C. Plassey, Buxar, Assaye, Laswari D. Seringapatam, Mangalore, Madras, Wadgaon

**Answer: A. Explanation: Subtopic 20 fixes this exact sequence (18 Dec 1845 to 10 Feb 1846); the other options list battles from entirely different wars (Bengal, Mysore, Maratha) or wrongly include Second Anglo-Sikh War battles (Chillianwala, Gujrat, Ramnagar, Multan).**

### Q14. On what date was the Punjab formally annexed, ending the Sikh Empire, and what happened to Maharaja Duleep Singh?

A. 1858; he was made a British peer immediately B. 29 March 1849; he was pensioned and sent to England, and the Khalsa army was disbanded C. 10 February 1846; he was restored to full sovereignty D. 1856; he was declared Governor-General's agent

**Answer: B. Explanation: Subtopic 21 fixes this precise annexation date and outcome, distinct from the 1846 date (First War settlement, not annexation) and unrelated later dates offered as distractors.**

### Q15. The Doctrine of Lapse, as articulated by Dalhousie, permitted the Company to annex a dependent state under which specific condition?

A. Whenever the ruler's territory was strategically valuable, regardless of succession B. Whenever a ruler was accused of misgovernance, regardless of succession status C. Where the ruler died without a natural (biological) male heir and Dalhousie refused to recognise an adopted heir D. Only where the ruler voluntarily requested annexation

**Answer: C. Explanation: Subtopic 22 defines the Doctrine of Lapse precisely by this natural-heir/adoption-refusal condition, distinguishing it sharply from misgovernance annexation (Awadh, subtopic 23) or purely strategic conquest (Sindh, subtopic 17).**

### Q16. Why does this topic explicitly classify the 1856 annexation of Awadh as separate from the Doctrine of Lapse?

A. Because Awadh had never signed a Subsidiary Alliance B. Because Awadh was annexed by Napier, not Dalhousie C. Because Awadh's annexation predated Dalhousie's tenure D. Because Awadh's Nawab, Wajid Ali Shah, was alive with heirs and no succession dispute existed; the annexation rested instead on alleged internal misgovernance reported by James Outram

**Answer: D. Explanation: Subtopic 23 draws this precise distinction -- misgovernance annexation with a living, heir-bearing ruler, categorically different from a true Lapse case's succession-without-heir condition.**

## PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

#### Transparent PYQ audit and route decision

**Audit scope:** every Prelims and Mains GS-I/GS-II/Essay routing ledger and integration-audit file currently in the repository, covering 2018 through 2026, was checked line by line for any question mentioning Haidar Ali, Tipu Sultan, the Anglo-Mysore Wars, the Maratha confederacy or Anglo-Maratha Wars, the Treaty of Bassein, the Subsidiary Alliance, Sindh or Napier, Ranjit Singh, the Khalsa army, the Anglo-Sikh Wars, Dalhousie, the Doctrine of Lapse, or the 1856 annexation of Awadh.

**Audit result:** this topic **owns exactly two verified, directly routed PYQs** across the entire 2018-2026 window, confirmed independently against local OCR'd official papers held under `attempts/_pyq_text/`, with no further item found routed here in any checked ledger:

1. **2018 Prelims, GS-I, Q75** -- Subsidiary Alliance, solved in full immediately below, with its answer explicitly labelled `INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED`, since no official answer key for this paper is held locally.
2. **2022 Mains, GS-I, Q2** -- on why Company armies prevailed, solved as PYQ 2 below with a complete, non-bounded, multi-theatre examiner-grade model; this is the same question Topic 04's own package deliberately answered only as a bounded, Bengal-only bridge, explicitly deferring the full answer to this topic.

**No further PYQ is claimed for this topic.** Where this package's own original MCQs and Mains questions appear below, they are clearly original practice material, not represented as previous UPSC questions.

### PYQ 1 solved -- 2018 Prelims, GS-I, Q75 (Subsidiary Alliance)

**Question (verbatim, original option order preserved):** "Which one of the following statements does not apply to the system of Subsidiary Alliance introduced by Lord Wellesley?

(a) To maintain a large standing army at other's expense

(b) To keep India safe from Napoleonic danger

(c) To secure a fixed income for the Company

(d) To establish British paramountcy over the Indian States."

**Official key status:** not held locally; a targeted search for the official Civil Services Preliminary Examination 2018 answer key for this paper was carried out before concluding this, and no locally verifiable official key text was found. The label below therefore applies in full.

`INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED`**: (c) To secure a fixed income for the Company.**

**Confidence:** moderate-to-high (independent web corroboration converged on option (c) across multiple sources on a second search attempt; this package's own elimination logic, set out below, independently reaches the same option).

**Elimination reasoning:**

- **(a) does apply:** subtopic 14 establishes that a permanently stationed subsidiary force, maintained at the allied ruler's own expense (by cash subsidy or ceded revenue), was the Subsidiary Alliance's defining first clause -- this is precisely what the system did.
- **(b) does apply:** subtopic 7 and subtopic 14 both confirm that Wellesley repeatedly invoked the danger of French/Napoleonic influence reaching India (via Tipu's outreach, and via the wider European war) as a stated justification for his forward, systematised alliance policy, whatever later historians conclude about how exaggerated that danger actually was.
- **(d) does apply:** subtopic 16's entire analysis of sovereignty erosion, and the case sequence in subtopic 15, show that establishing British paramountcy over Indian states was the system's central strategic effect and openly stated aim.
- **(c) is the best-supported exception:** the Subsidiary Alliance's payment mechanism (subtopic 14, subtopic 16) was structured as cost recovery for maintaining an externally stationed force, or as a compensating territorial cession, not as a scheme to generate a net "fixed income" surplus for the Company's general treasury; describing the system's purpose as securing "a fixed income for the Company" mischaracterises a cost-recovery and control mechanism as a revenue-generation scheme, making it the statement least accurately describing the system's actual design purpose among the four options.

**Why this matters for exam technique:** this is a "does NOT apply" negative-framing question; the safest method is to confirm each of the other three options against a named subtopic before selecting the exception, exactly as done above, rather than guessing directly at the "odd one out."

### PYQ 2 solved -- 2022 Mains, GS-I, Q2 (why Company armies won consistently; this topic's own PYQ, answered in full)

**Question (verbatim, verified against local official paper):** "Why did the armies of the British East India Company -- mostly comprising of Indian soldiers -- win consistently against the more numerous and better equipped armies of the then Indian rulers? Give reasons."

**Boundary note:** Topic 04's own package answered this question only as a bounded, Bengal-only bridge, explicitly deferring the complete, subcontinent-wide answer to this topic. What follows is that complete answer, drawing on Mysore, Maratha, Sikh and fiscal-diplomatic evidence across this entire package.

**Directive alignment:** "Why... Give reasons" calls for a multi-factor causal answer, not a chronological retelling of any single campaign.

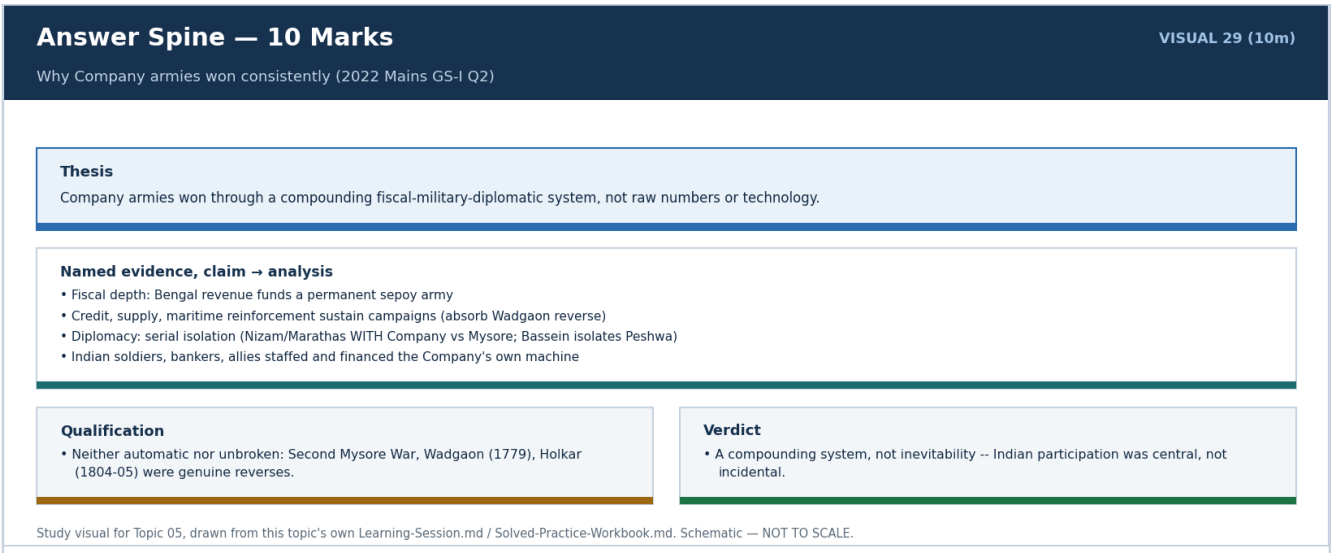
**Introduction:** Company armies, though "mostly comprising of Indian soldiers," won consistently because they combined a larger, more reliable fiscal base with organisational discipline and a diplomacy that kept opponents divided -- not because of any single technological or racial advantage.

**Answer: Four reinforcing reasons explain this consistency. First, fiscal depth: Bengal's revenue base funded a permanent sepoy army, composed mostly of Indian soldiers, that combined regular pay with a comparatively thin professional officer corps, standardised artillery and organised logistics -- capacity rival states like Mysore and the Marathas could approach but not sustain with equal continuity. Second, credit, supply and maritime reinforcement let the Company sustain campaigns (and absorb reverses like Wadgaon) that would have broken a less resourced state. Third, and most decisively, diplomacy repeatedly isolated opponents serially: the Nizam and Marathas fought with the Company against Mysore in three of four wars; Bassein (1802) removed the Maratha Peshwa from the field, letting Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar be fought one at a time; Ranjit Singh's death (1839) produced Sikh succession chaos the Company then exploited. Fourth, Indian soldiers, bankers and regional allies staffed and financed the Company's own machine throughout.**

**Qualification:** This advantage was neither automatic nor unbroken -- the Second Mysore War, Wadgaon (1779), and Holkar's 1804-05 resistance were genuine Company reverses, confirming contingency rather than inevitability.

**Verdict:** Company armies won consistently through a compounding fiscal-military-diplomatic system, not raw numbers or technology alone -- and Indian soldiers, credit and allies were central to that system's own operation, not incidental to it.

**Why this earns marks:** Full marks require naming at least three distinct reason-categories (fiscal, diplomatic/isolation, organisational) across more than one theatre, citing the sepoy-growth figures, and acknowledging at least one genuine Company reverse to avoid an inevitability overstatement.




*Visual 29: answer spine, 10 marks -- why Company armies won consistently, 2022 Mains GS-I Q2*

*Visual 29: answer spine, 10 marks -- why Company armies won consistently, 2022 Mains GS-I Q2. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

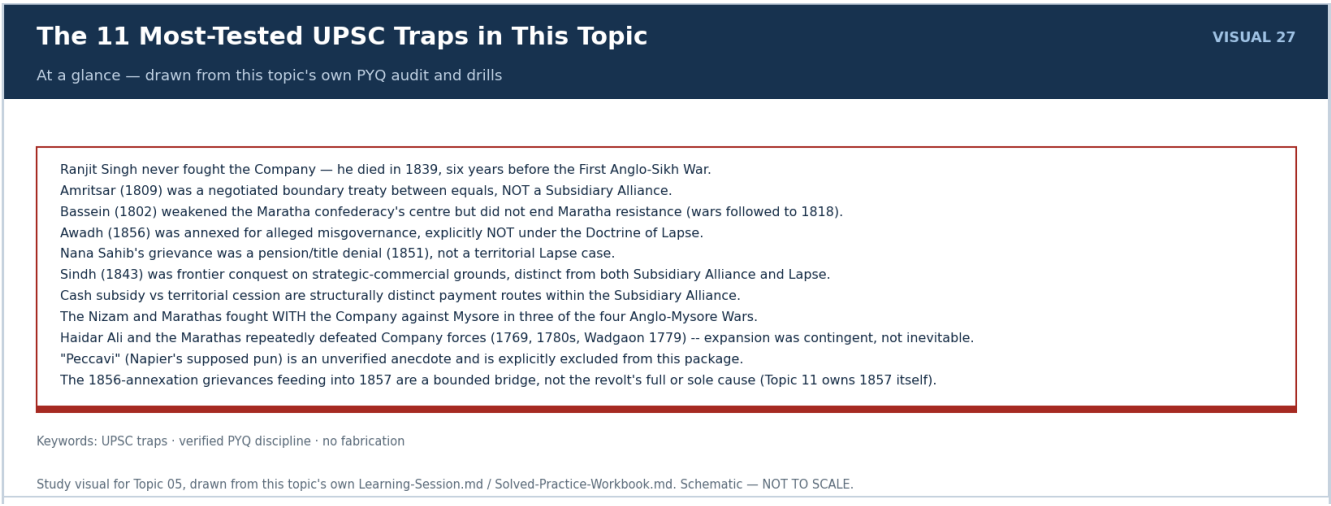
**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why did the armies of the British East India Company -- mostly comprising of Indian soldiers...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Why did the armies of the British East India Company -- mostly comprising of Indian soldiers...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Evidence and answer-writing drills




*Visual 27: the eleven most-tested UPSC traps in this topic, at a glance*

*Visual 27: the eleven most-tested UPSC traps in this topic, at a glance. Schematic; NOT TO SCALE where marked.*

#### Drill 1 - Company armies were overwhelmingly Indian, not "British"

**Claim:** State explicitly, as the 2022 PYQ itself frames it, that these armies were "mostly comprising of Indian soldiers" under a comparatively thin layer of British officers. Never describe Company victories as demographically "British"; explain how Indian recruitment was integrated with regular finance, command, artillery and logistics.

**Exam move:** Any answer that explains Company success purely through "British" military or technological superiority, without naming the Indian sepoy composition, has misread the question's own framing and lost an easy opening mark.

#### Drill 2 - Contingency, not inevitability

**Claim:** Present expansion as a sequence of case-by-case choices shaped by local alliance opportunities and each ruler's internal politics (subtopic 2), not as a predetermined "rise of British power" narrative; cite the Company's own reverses (Wadgaon 1779, the Second Mysore War, Holkar's 1804-05 resistance) as direct evidence against inevitability.

**Exam move:** A question asking "how" or "why" expansion succeeded rewards naming at least one specific Company reverse alongside the successes -- this single habit demonstrates the contingency argument rather than merely asserting it.

#### Drill 3 - Tipu's reforms were real but bounded, not myth and not modern industry

**Claim:** Credit Tipu's revenue centralisation, agrarian and irrigation encouragement, and "military fiscalism" (Burton Stein's term) as genuine and source-attested, while also naming Irfan Habib's caution that Mysore's modernising ambition ran ahead of its actual resources -- never claim Mysore rivalled contemporary European industrial capacity, and never dismiss the reforms as fabricated nationalist myth either.

**Exam move:** A balanced answer on Tipu names one specific reform (direct revenue assessment, replacing intermediaries) and one specific limit (resource constraint per Habib) in the same paragraph.

### Drill 4 - The Mysore wars' alliance pattern shifted every time; it was never fixed

**Claim:** State precisely: Marathas and the Nizam sided WITH the Company in the First (1767-69) and Third (1790-92) wars, but WITH Haidar Ali AGAINST the Company in the Second (1780-84) war; only in the Fourth (1799) was there no comparable counterweight, because Hyderabad was already a Subsidiary Alliance dependency since 1798.

**Exam move:** Never write "the Marathas and the Nizam always supported the Company against Mysore" -- this is factually wrong for the Second War specifically and is one of the most common alliance-sequencing errors in this topic.

### Drill 5 - Tipu's French connection was real diplomacy, not proof of an imminent French invasion

**Claim:** Confirm Tipu's genuine outreach to Revolutionary France, Kabul, Arabia and Turkey (subtopic 7), while also naming Edward Ingram's assessment that the actual probability of French military intervention by 1798-99 was low -- Wellesley's invocation of the "French danger" functioned significantly as a pretext for a war he had independent reasons to want.

**Exam move:** State both halves together -- "real diplomatic outreach, exaggerated invasion threat" -- rather than either denying the French contact occurred or accepting Wellesley's threat assessment at face value.

### Drill 6 - Bassein (1802) was a turning point, not the end of Maratha resistance

**Claim:** Bassein removed the Peshwa -- the confederacy's nominal head -- from the field of opposition, but Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar all continued fighting through the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05), and the confederacy was defeated only by 1818 in the Third War; never state that Bassein ended Maratha resistance outright.

**Exam move:** A "significance of Bassein" answer earns full marks only by explaining WHY it mattered (removing the confederacy's legitimating head, enabling serial isolation) rather than by overstating WHAT it immediately ended.

### Drill 7 - Distinguish a cash subsidy from a territorial cession precisely

**Claim:** A cash subsidy was a direct annual payment; a territorial cession transferred revenue-yielding land in lieu of, or partial substitution for, that payment (as at the Nizam's 1800 treaty and Awadh's 1801 settlement) -- both produced dependency, but only cession permanently reduced the state's own resource base.

**Exam move:** For any named Subsidiary Alliance case, state explicitly whether payment was in cash or in ceded land; this is a frequently tested precision point, and the 2018 Prelims PYQ solved above turns on a closely related distinction.

### Drill 8 - Name the responsibility paradox in both directions

**Claim:** State both halves explicitly -- the Subsidiary Alliance stripped a ruler of army, treasury and diplomacy while leaving him formally responsible for governance outcomes, and the Company then used resulting administrative strain (fiscal pressure, Resident interference, disbanded soldiers turning to Pindari banditry) as its own justification for further intervention.

**Exam move:** An answer naming only "the ruler lost power" or only "the Company blamed misgovernance," without connecting the two as cause and consequence, has described half the mechanism -- exactly as Topic 04's Dual Government paradox required both halves.

### Drill 9 - Napier's Sindh quote is genuine; the "Peccavi" pun is not

**Claim:** Cite only Napier's attested diary entry ("We have no right to seize Sind, yet we shall do so...") as evidence of the annexation's dubious legality; do not repeat the popular "Peccavi" ("I have sinned"/"I have Sindh") telegram story, which is a widely circulated but historically unverified anecdote excluded from this package.

**Exam move:** If a question invites a quotation on Sindh's annexation, use the diary entry only, and never present the Peccavi pun as a sourced historical fact.

### Drill 10 - Ranjit Singh never fought an Anglo-Sikh War

**Claim:** State plainly that Ranjit Singh died in June 1839, a full six years before the First Anglo-Sikh War began in December 1845; the Treaty of Amritsar (1809) was a negotiated boundary settlement between the Company and a militarily strong, sovereign equal, not a Subsidiary Alliance and not a war treaty.

**Exam move:** Any statement implying Ranjit Singh fought, negotiated after defeat, or was annexed by the Company is a basic actor-timeline error; the wars followed only after his death produced succession chaos (subtopic 19).

### Drill 11 - Match each Anglo-Sikh war to its own battles and settlement, never mix them

**Claim:** First War (Dec 1845-Feb 1846): Mudki, Ferozeshah, Aliwal, Sobraon, then the Treaty of Lahore and the Treaty of Bhyrowal (dependency, not annexation). Second War (1848-49): the Multan rebellion trigger, Ramnagar, Chillianwala, Gujrat, then outright annexation of Punjab in March 1849.

**Exam move:** A statement placing Chillianwala or Gujrat in the First War, or Mudki/Sobraon in the Second, is a common date-battle mismatch; anchor each battle to its correct war using the trigger event (Sutlej crossing in 1845; Multan rebellion in 1848) as the memory hook.

### Drill 12 - Keep Lapse, title/pension denial, and misgovernance annexation as three separate mechanisms

**Claim:** The Doctrine of Lapse applied specifically where a dependent ruler died without a natural heir and an adoption was refused (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi); Nana Sahib's case was a personal pension/title denial, not territorial Lapse (the Peshwaship itself had already been abolished in 1818); Awadh's 1856 annexation rested on alleged misgovernance, with a living Nawab and no succession dispute at all.

**Exam move:** A question naming "Dalhousie's annexations" collectively still expects each case correctly assigned to its own mechanism; grouping Awadh under "Doctrine of Lapse" is one of the single most common and heavily penalised errors on this topic.

### Drill 13 - The 1857 bridge is bounded evidence, never a monocausal claim

**Claim:** Name only the specific, attested links this topic owns -- Nana Sahib's pension denial, the Rani of Jhansi's refused adoption, Awadh's dispossessed taluqdars, disbanded soldiers -- as antecedent grievances feeding into 1857, while stating explicitly that the rising's fuller causation (military grievances, religious anxiety, peasant taxation pressure) belongs to Topic 11.

**Exam move:** Never write "territorial expansion and annexation caused the 1857 revolt" as a standalone, sufficient claim; always pair named antecedents with an explicit hand-off statement naming Topic 11 for the fuller picture.

**Demand decoding:** Treat "PYQ 1 solved -- 2018 Prelims, GS-I, Q75 (Subsidiary Alliance)" as a statement-level chronology and attribution problem: verify every date, Act/provision, person, organisation, region and causal claim independently, without inventing an official key.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** Fix the tested time window; separate event/enactment/commencement; match each actor and provision; eliminate the closest distractor with one named record, treaty, session or regional fact.

**Why this earns marks:** It preserves exact chronology and answer-text mapping, uses named evidence and keeps inferred elimination distinct from an official key.

**How to improve this answer:** For "PYQ 1 solved -- 2018 Prelims, GS-I, Q75 (Subsidiary Alliance)", add one explicit line showing why the nearest distractor fails on date, legal status, geography, attribution or degree.

### Drill 14 - Never invent a PYQ, an official key, or a topic boundary

**Claim:** This topic owns exactly two verified routed PYQs (2018 Prelims Q75; 2022 Mains Q2), per this package's own audit above; the 2018 answer is explicitly labelled INFERRED ANSWER -- NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED because no local key exists, and no further PYQ, troop strength, subsidy sum, territorial share, casualty figure or quotation is invented anywhere in this package.

**Exam move:** When a question edges toward Topics 02, 04, 06, 07 or 11's material, state the boundary explicitly (e.g., "Topic 02's material," "Topic 11's material") rather than silently absorbing or refusing to engage with adjacent content.

### Mains practice: solved model answers

Word limits scale with marks in this package's own convention: 10 marks = 150 words, 15 marks = 250 words, 20 marks = 300 words. The "Directive alignment" and "Why this earns marks" notes are examiner-craft scaffolding around the answer, not part of the counted word limit.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Drill 14 - Never invent a PYQ, an official key, or a topic boundary", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Drill 14 - Never invent a PYQ, an official key, or a topic boundary", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Mains 1 - 10 marks | 150 words

**Question:** Examine why the Treaty of Bassein (1802) is considered the single most consequential turning point in Company-Maratha relations.

**Directive alignment:** "Examine" requires explaining the mechanism of Bassein's significance, not merely narrating its terms.

**Introduction:** Bassein mattered less for its clauses than for what it removed from the confederacy's chessboard.

**Answer: Nana Phadnis's 1800 death removed the confederacy's most experienced unifying figure, and succession rivalry between Holkar and Sindhia/Peshwa Baji Rao II intensified. Holkar's decisive victory near Poona (25 October 1802) drove Baji Rao II to accept a Subsidiary Alliance at Bassein (31 December 1802), ceding territory, admitting a Resident, and accepting a permanent British force. This removed the Peshwa -- the confederacy's nominal head and legitimating authority -- from opposition, turning a unified Maratha response into separable conflicts the Company fought individually against Sindhia, Bhonsle and Holkar.**

**Qualification:** Bassein did not end Maratha resistance -- the Second (1803-05) and Third (1817-18) wars followed -- its significance is structural, not terminal.

**Verdict:** Bassein's importance lies in fragmenting the confederacy's political unity, enabling the Company's serial-isolation diplomacy to operate at full effect thereafter.

**Why this earns marks:** Full marks require explaining WHY Bassein mattered (removing the Peshwa's legitimating authority), not just WHAT it said, and explicitly denying that it ended Maratha resistance outright.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why the Treaty of Bassein (1802) is considered the single most consequential...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Examine why the Treaty of Bassein (1802) is considered the single most consequential...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Mains 2 - 10 marks | 150 words

**Question:** Account for the differing outcomes of the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05) for Sindhia and Bhonsle on one hand and Holkar on the other.

**Directive alignment:** "Account for the differing outcomes" requires explaining WHY the outcomes differed, not merely listing each chief's treaty.

**Introduction:** All three major Maratha chiefs faced the Company in 1803-05, but only two were decisively defeated within the war itself.

**Answer: Sindhia and Bhonsle fought as a coordinated force and suffered concentrated defeats -- Assaye and Laswari (Sindhia, 1803) and Delhi/Argaon-adjacent actions (Bhonsle) -- leading both to accept subsidiary terms by late 1803, ceding territory and accepting Residents. Holkar stayed outside this coalition and fought**

**on alone into 1804, achieving real successes before a costly campaign produced the Treaty of Rajghat (1805) on comparatively less punitive terms.**

**Qualification:** This divergence itself illustrates Maratha disunity as a Company advantage -- serial, not simultaneous, engagement -- while confirming Holkar's genuine resistance capacity.

**Verdict:** Differing outcomes reflect differing degrees of coalition unity at the point of engagement, not differing intrinsic strength among the three chiefs.

**Why this earns marks:** Full marks require naming the specific battles/treaties for each chief and explaining the coalition-unity variable, not treating "the Marathas" as a single undifferentiated actor.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Account for the differing outcomes of the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05) for Sindhia...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Account for the differing outcomes of the Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05) for Sindhia...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Mains 3 - 15 marks | 250 words

**Question:** Compare Wellesley's application of the Subsidiary Alliance system at Hyderabad (1798), Mysore (1799), Awadh (1801) and the Maratha Peshwa (Bassein, 1802).

**Directive alignment:** "Compare" requires identifying both the shared mechanism and the case-specific variations, not four separate unconnected narratives.

**Introduction:** Wellesley applied the same six-clause Subsidiary Alliance template in each case, but the immediate trigger and payment form varied by case.

**Shared mechanism:** In all four cases, the ruler accepted a permanently stationed British force, a Resident, a ban on employing Europeans without approval, and loss of independent diplomacy, in exchange for a formal (if seldom honoured) protection promise.

**Case-specific variation:** Hyderabad (1798, enlarged 1800) came first, driven by fear of Maratha encroachment, with payment partly converted from cash to ceded territory in 1800. Mysore (1799) followed immediately after Tipu Sultan's defeat and death at Seringapatam -- a post-conquest settlement restoring the Wodeyar dynasty under subsidiary control, not a peacetime negotiation. Awadh (1801) involved outright cession of Rohilkhand and the Doab in place of an enlarged cash subsidy, alongside British "advice" on internal administration. The Peshwa's Bassein (1802) was extracted from Baji Rao II only after Holkar's battlefield defeat of the combined Peshwa-Sindhia force, exploiting a succession-era Maratha crisis rather than any external Company war.

**Qualification:** Bassein alone triggered further war (the Second Anglo-Maratha War), since Sindhia and Bhonsle rejected the Peshwa's subordination -- a consequence none of the other three cases produced.

**Verdict:** The template was constant; the leverage behind each signature -- conquest, fiscal fear, cession bargaining, or internal rivalry -- was specific to each case.

**Why this earns marks:** A strong answer names the exact years, the payment form (cash/cession) for each case, and explains why only Bassein triggered a subsequent war.

**Demand decoding:** The directive **compare** requires a direct position on "Compare Wellesley's application of the Subsidiary Alliance system at Hyderabad (1798),...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Compare Wellesley's application of the Subsidiary Alliance system at Hyderabad (1798),...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Mains 4 - 15 marks | 250 words

**Question:** "Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan built one of the most capable states of eighteenth-century India, yet Mysore fell to the Company." Examine this apparent paradox.

**Directive alignment:** "Examine this apparent paradox" requires reconciling genuine state capacity with eventual defeat -- not choosing one side of the paradox and ignoring the other.

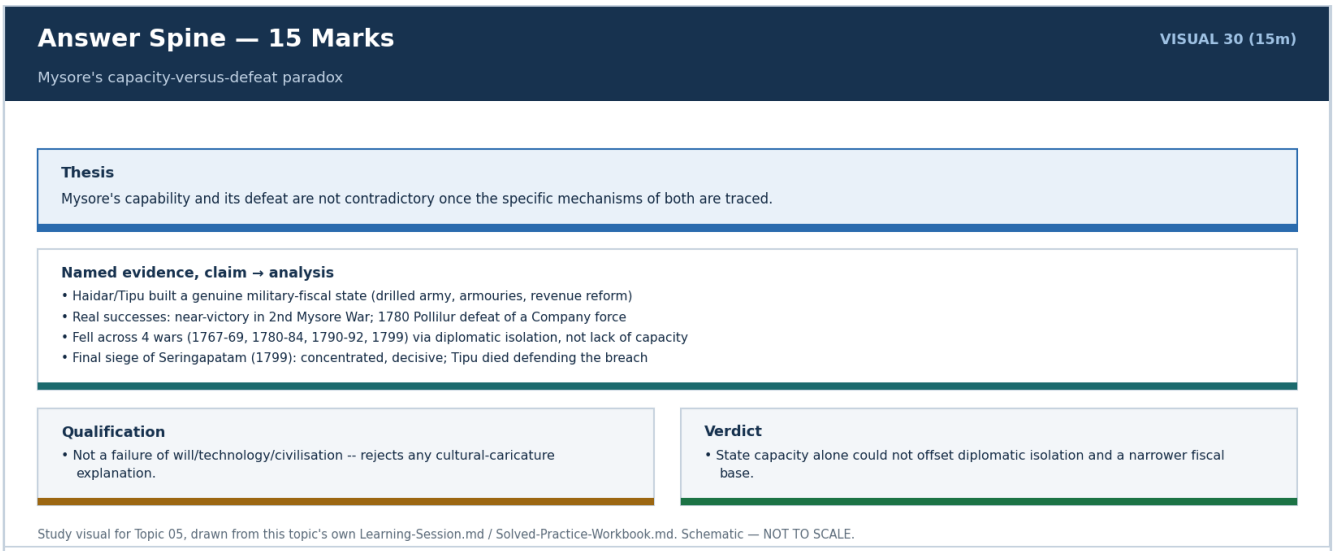
**Introduction:** Mysore's capability and its defeat are not contradictory once the specific mechanisms of both are traced.

**Answer: Haidar Ali and Tipu built real capacity: a standing, drilled infantry-artillery army, state-organised armouries and (under Tipu) state trading agencies, and administrative reorganisation of revenue collection -- a genuine "military-fiscal" state by regional standards. This capacity explains Mysore's real successes: near-victory in the Second Anglo-Mysore War and the humiliating 1780 Pollilur defeat of a Company force. Yet Mysore fell across four wars (1767-69, 1780-84, 1790-92, 1799) because of compounding disadvantages beyond capacity alone: geographic isolation without a matching subcontinental fiscal base comparable to Company Bengal; repeated diplomatic isolation, as the Nizam and Marathas fought WITH the Company against Mysore in three of the four wars; Tipu's French connections and Malabar/Travancore friction supplying repeated pretexts without ever delivering matching material support; and the concentrated, decisive nature of the final siege of Seringapatam (1799), where Tipu died defending the breach.**

**Qualification:** This was not a failure of will, technology, or "civilisational" capacity -- explicitly rejecting any cultural-caricature explanation -- but a specific, contingent combination of isolation and relative fiscal-military scale.

**Verdict:** Mysore's fall illustrates that state capacity alone could not offset diplomatic isolation and a narrower fiscal base against a rival operating at greater and more resilient scale.

**Why this earns marks:** Full marks require citing specific evidence for BOTH sides of the paradox (a genuine Company reverse like Pollilur, AND the isolation/fiscal explanation for defeat), while explicitly rejecting cultural-caricature framing.




*Visual 30: answer spine, 15 marks -- Mysore's capacity-versus-defeat paradox*

*Visual 30: answer spine, 15 marks -- reconciling Mysore's genuine state capacity with its eventual defeat.*

**Demand decoding:** The directive **examine** requires a direct position on ""Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan built one of the most capable states of eighteenth-century...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For ""Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan built one of the most capable states of eighteenth-century...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Mains 5 - 20 marks | 250 words

**Question:** "British territorial expansion in India after 1798 proceeded through a variety of mechanisms, not a single method of conquest." Discuss with reference to Mysore, the Marathas, Sindh and the Sikh Empire.

**Directive alignment:** "Discuss with reference to" four named cases requires a genuinely comparative essay, not four disconnected mini-narratives.

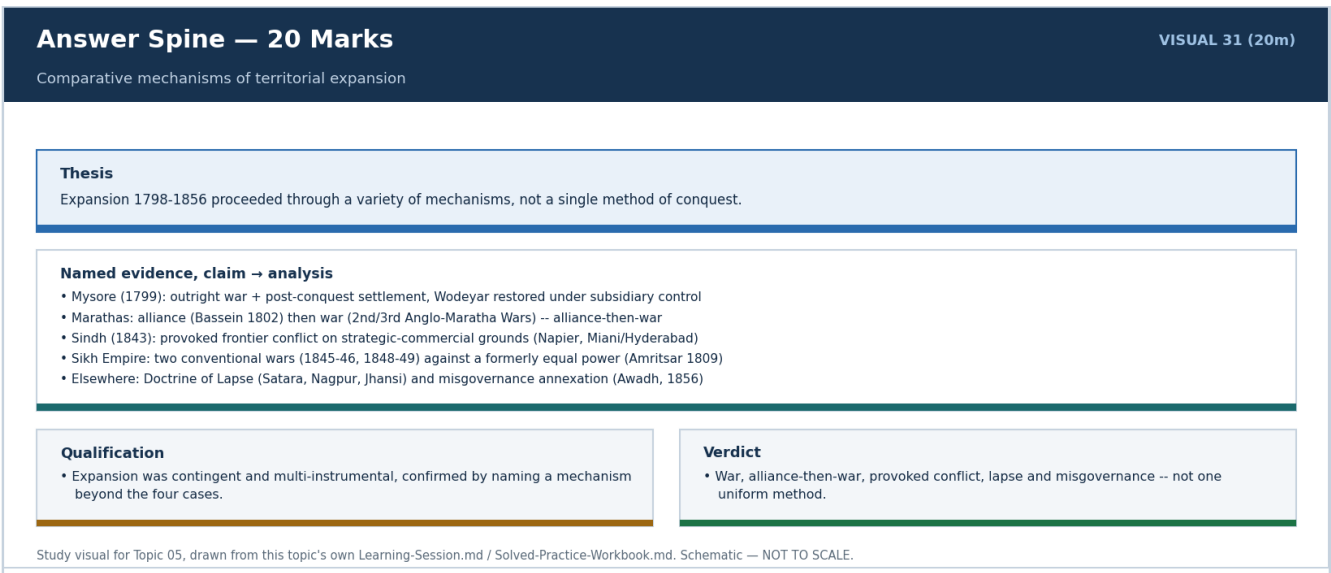
**Introduction:** Between 1799 and 1849, the Company annexed Mysore-adjacent control, Maratha territory, Sindh and the Punjab through four distinct legal-political mechanisms, not a uniform method.

**Answer: Mysore (1799) fell through outright war and post-conquest settlement -- Tipu's death at Seringapatam followed by Wodeyar restoration under subsidiary control, not lapse or misgovernance annexation. The Marathas experienced a graduated sequence: Subsidiary Alliance (Bassein, 1802) fragmenting the confederacy, then war against the remaining chiefs (Second, 1803-05; Third, 1817-18), ending in Baji Rao II's exile and the Peshwaship's abolition -- alliance-then-war, not either mechanism alone. Sindh (1843) was annexed under Napier through disputed treaty violations and a deliberately provoked frontier conflict at Miani/Hyderabad, in a strategic (Russo-Persian frontier anxiety) rather than fiscal context -- war on a manufactured pretext, distinct from both subsidiary dependency and lapse. The Sikh Empire fell through two conventional wars (1845-46, 1848-49) fought against a militarily formidable, previously independent equal (Ranjit Singh's Khalsa army), following his death and a succession crisis the British did not create but exploited -- outright annexation after conventional war, not a subsidiary relationship, since the Treaty of Amritsar (1809) had been a negotiated boundary settlement between equals, not a dependency instrument.**

**Qualification:** Doctrine of Lapse (Satara, Nagpur, Jhansi) and misgovernance annexation (Awadh, 1856) supply two further, distinct mechanisms outside these four cases, confirming the multi-mechanism thesis further (Part VII).

**Verdict:** Expansion after 1798 was contingent and multi-instrumental -- war, alliance-then-war, provoked frontier conflict, and (elsewhere) lapse/misgovernance -- not a single uniform method of conquest.

**Why this earns marks:** Full marks require correctly differentiating the mechanism (not just outcome) for all four named cases and explicitly naming at least one further mechanism (lapse or misgovernance) to demonstrate range beyond the question's own four cases.




*Visual 31: answer spine, 20 marks -- comparative mechanisms of territorial expansion*

*Visual 31: answer spine, 20 marks -- comparing war, alliance, provoked conflict, lapse and misgovernance as distinct mechanisms.*

**Demand decoding:** The directive **discuss** requires a direct position on ""British territorial expansion in India after 1798 proceeded through a variety of...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For ""British territorial expansion in India after 1798 proceeded through a variety of...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

### Mains 6 - 20 marks | 250 words

**Question:** Critically evaluate the competing historiographical explanations for British territorial expansion in India, 1798-1856.

**Directive alignment:** "Critically evaluate... competing" requires presenting multiple named schools of interpretation and weighing them against each other, not describing one framework as settled fact.

**Introduction:** At least four distinct historiographical lenses have been applied to this period's expansion, each foregrounding a different causal mechanism (Part VIII).

**Answer: The nationalist "conquest and drain" critique (R.C. Dutt, later Bipan Chandra) reads expansion as extractive dispossession serving metropolitan and Company commercial interests, with subsidiary payments and ceded revenue continuous with Bengal-style resource transfer. The fiscal-military/corporate-state framework (Seema Alavi; for the wider corporate-state literature, P.J. Marshall) foregrounds the Company's own organisational capacity -- army, credit, logistics -- as the primary variable, treating expansion as institutional capability rather than ideological design alone. A collaboration/Indian-agency framework (C.A. Bayly) stresses that Indian bankers, sepoys, regional allies and rival rulers' own strategic choices actively shaped outcomes, cautioning against reducing Indians to passive victims. A military-revolution/contingency framework (Douglas Peers; Burton Stein on Mysore) emphasises tactical-organisational advantages and the genuinely contingent, reversible nature of individual campaigns (Wadgaon, the Second Mysore War) over any inevitabilist reading.**

**Qualification:** These frameworks are not mutually exclusive -- fiscal capacity, institutional organisation, Indian collaboration, and contingent battlefield outcomes can all operate simultaneously within a single case (Bassein illustrates fiscal-diplomatic exploitation of Maratha succession politics AND genuine Indian agency at once).

**Verdict:** No single lens fully explains this period; the strongest answer treats expansion as an overdetermined outcome of compounding, not competing, causal mechanisms, examined case by case rather than through one master narrative.

**Why this earns marks:** Full marks require naming at least three distinct schools with an associated scholar or scholarly tradition for each, and explicitly stating that the frameworks can combine rather than simply competing to "win."

**Demand decoding:** The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Critically evaluate the competing historiographical explanations for British territorial...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

**Detailed examiner-grade model status:** The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

**Executable exam-length answer / compression plan:** For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

**How to improve this answer:** For "Critically evaluate the competing historiographical explanations for British territorial...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

## OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

> **Subject:** History (Modern India) · **Tier:** Advanced (deeper understanding) · **GS Paper:** GS-I (also Prelims).
> **Grounded in:** Bipin Chandra, *Modern India* (Ch. IV) + *India's Struggle for Independence* (backdrop) - with historiography on indirect rule, paramountcy and colonial expansion. FACT: = from source book · ANALYSIS: = inference / standard knowledge · CURRENT: = current affairs. *Companion:* `basic/05_British-Territorial-Expansion.md`. *Chronology spine:* `00_Master-Chronology.md`.

### Mini-timeline

| Date | Event |
|---|---|
| FACT: 1767-69 | First Anglo-Mysore War ends with Treaty of Madras |
| FACT: 1775-82 | First Anglo-Maratha War ends with Treaty of Salbai |
| FACT: 1780-84 | Second Anglo-Mysore War; Haidar dies in 1782; Treaty of Mangalore |
| FACT: 1790-92 | Third Anglo-Mysore War; Treaty of Seringapatam; Tipu cedes half his territory |
| FACT: 1798 | Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance system begins aggressively; Hyderabad accepts it |
| FACT: 1799 | Fourth Anglo-Mysore War; Tipu dies; Wodeyars restored under British control |
| FACT: 1803-05 | Second Anglo-Maratha War; Assaye; Scindia and Bhonsle submit |
| FACT: 1817-18 | Third Anglo-Maratha War; Peshwa Baji Rao II deposed and pensioned at Bithur |
| FACT: 1843 | Sindh annexed by Charles Napier |
| FACT: 1845-46 | First Anglo-Sikh War; Treaty of Lahore |
| FACT: 1848-49 | Second Anglo-Sikh War; Punjab annexed under Dalhousie |
| FACT: 1848-56 | Dalhousie's annexations by Doctrine of Lapse and misgovernance culminate before 1857 |

### 1. Snapshot & core idea

**Deeper - expansion moved from ring-fence to paramountcy.**

- FACT: Early Company policy often sought buffers, but after Bengal the Company increasingly used war, diplomacy, Residents and subsidies to dominate Indian states.
- FACT: Wellesley's **Subsidiary Alliance** transformed rulers into dependent allies: they hosted British troops, paid subsidies, accepted a Resident and surrendered independent external relations.
- ANALYSIS: This produced **indirect rule**: Indian rulers survived formally, but sovereignty shifted to the Company.
- FACT: Dalhousie's **Doctrine of Lapse** moved from indirect control to annexation by denying adoption rights in selected states.
- FACT: Awadh's annexation in **1856** used the separate justification of alleged misgovernance, showing that British expansion used multiple legal pretexts.

**Deeper - Indian resistance differed by region.**

- FACT: Mysore under Haidar Ali and Tipu Sultan resisted through military reform, diplomacy and attempts to balance British power.
- FACT: Maratha weakness lay in confederate rivalries; British diplomacy exploited divisions among the Peshwa, Scindia, Holkar, Bhonsle and Gaekwad.
- FACT: Sikh power was consolidated under Ranjit Singh, but after his death court factionalism and military tensions enabled British victory in the Anglo-Sikh wars.

- ANALYSIS: Bengal revenues, sepoy armies and superior logistics allowed the Company to fight repeated wars far beyond its original coastal bases.

## 2. Key classification / data

| Instrument/front | Dates | Mechanism | Result | Advanced significance |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FACT: Mysore wars | 1767-69; 1780-84; 1790-92; 1799 | Direct war against Haidar/Tipu | Tipu killed; Wodeyars restored | ANALYSIS: Anti-Company modernising state defeated |
| FACT: Maratha wars | 1775-82; 1803-05; 1817-18 | War + diplomacy + exploitation of confederacy | Peshwa deposed; confederacy broken | ANALYSIS: Divided sovereignty made conquest easier |
| FACT: Subsidiary Alliance | From 1798; Hyderabad first | Troops, subsidy, Resident, no foreign policy | Dependency without annexation | ANALYSIS: Indirect drain through subsidy and military costs |
| FACT: Doctrine of Lapse | 1848-56 | Denial of adopted heirs | Satara, Jhansi, Nagpur and others annexed | ANALYSIS: Legalistic annexation deepened resentment |
| FACT: Sikh wars | 1845-46; 1848-49 | Frontier war after Ranjit Singh's death | Punjab annexed | ANALYSIS: Completes northwest expansion |
| FACT: Misgovernance annexation | Awadh, 1856 | Administrative pretext | Awadh annexed | ANALYSIS: Major grievance before 1857 |

## 3. Study links

**Study link:** FACT: The powers conquered here emerged from the 18th-century regional-state order -> `advanced/02_Indian-States-and-Society-18th-Century.md`. **Study link:** FACT: Bengal's Diwani supplied fiscal resources for Company armies -> `advanced/04_British-Conquest-of-Bengal.md`. **Study link:** ANALYSIS: Expansion forces parliamentary control and administrative restructuring -> `advanced/06`.

## 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

- FACT: **Treaty of Madras (1769)** ended the First Anglo-Mysore War.
- FACT: **Treaty of Mangalore (1784)** ended the Second Anglo-Mysore War; Haidar Ali died in **1782**.
- FACT: **Treaty of Seringapatam (1792)** ended the Third Anglo-Mysore War; Tipu ceded half his territory.
- FACT: **Fourth Anglo-Mysore War (1799)**: Tipu died; Wodeyars restored under Subsidiary Alliance.
- FACT: **Treaty of Salbai (1782)** ended the First Anglo-Maratha War.
- FACT: **Second Anglo-Maratha War (1803-05)**: Wellesley; Battle of Assaye; Scindia and Bhonsle submitted.
- FACT: **Third Anglo-Maratha War (1817-18)**: Peshwa Baji Rao II deposed; pensioned at Bithur.
- FACT: **Subsidiary Alliance**: Wellesley; Hyderabad first in **1798**; Resident and no independent diplomacy.
- FACT: **Doctrine of Lapse**: Satara 1848; Jaitpur, Sambalpur and other cases; Jhansi annexed in **1854** after the 1853 succession dispute; Nagpur 1854. Lists of minor lapse cases vary by classification.
- FACT: **Sindh** annexed in **1843** by Charles Napier; **Punjab** annexed in **1849** after the Second Anglo-Sikh War.
- FACT: **Awadh** annexed in **1856** on alleged misgovernance.

## 5. UPSC Traps

MEMORY: Trap: Expansion was not only battlefield conquest; it was a spectrum - buffer policy, Subsidiary Alliance, Resident control, Lapse, misgovernance and direct annexation.

- WRONG: Subsidiary Alliance and Doctrine of Lapse were the same policy. -> Alliance created dependency; Lapse annexed states by succession doctrine.
- WRONG: Dalhousie introduced Subsidiary Alliance. -> **Wellesley** systematised it from 1798.
- WRONG: Wellesley annexed Jhansi under Lapse. -> **Dalhousie** annexed Jhansi in 1853 under Lapse.

- WRONG: British defeated united Maratha nationalism. -> They defeated a **confederacy** weakened by internal rivalries.
- WRONG: Anglo-Sikh wars were fought against Ranjit Singh. -> They occurred after his death, when Punjab politics was unstable.
- WRONG: Awadh's annexation was legally a lapse case. -> It was justified by alleged **misgovernance**.

### 6. CURRENT: Current link

- ANALYSIS: **1857 grievance memory and princely-state legacies.** Jhansi, Awadh, Nagpur, Bithur, Srirangapatam and Punjab remain central to heritage circuits, museum narratives and debates on colonial legalism. *(Escalate to CURRENT: when pegged to a verified news item.)*

### 7. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Assess the role of Subsidiary Alliance in converting Indian rulers into dependent allies without immediate annexation.
- ANALYSIS: Compare Mysore's centralised resistance, Maratha confederate resistance and Sikh frontier resistance.
- ANALYSIS: Explain how subsidies, Residents and military protection became instruments of colonial drain and paramountcy.
- ANALYSIS: Discuss Dalhousie's annexations as a major cause of political resentment before 1857.

### □ Historiography note (PYQ-gap)

ANALYSIS: Advanced answers should frame expansion as the growth of **paramountcy**. The Company did not simply conquer territory; it built graded sovereignty: protected allies, subsidiary states, annexed provinces and frontier buffers. Historians of indirect rule stress that subsidies transferred Indian revenues to support British armies, while Residents reshaped court politics. The trajectory runs from **ring-fence** and buffer logic to Wellesley's **Subsidiary Alliance**, then to Dalhousie's annexationist legalism.

### Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

> **Status:** Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: `_PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md`.

- **Years represented:** 2022
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

| Year | Paper | Q | PYQ demand (neutral rendering) | Directive / format | Source status | Owner requirement |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2022 | GS-I | 2 | East India Company armies winning against Indian rulers | Why and Give reasons · 10 marks · 150 words | Routed to owning topic | Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion. |

### What this owner must now support

- East India Company armies winning against Indian rulers

> The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

# CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

## COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

### ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Expansion was a ladder, not one method

```
RING-FENCE -> friendly buffer protects Company territory
SUBSIDIARY ALLIANCE -> ruler survives but loses army, diplomacy and fiscal autonomy
PARAMOUNTCY -> Company claims a superior right to arbitrate Indian-state conduct
ANNEXATION -> conquest, lapse or alleged misgovernment brings direct administration.
MUST REMEMBER: Keep the Anglo-Mysore, Anglo-Maratha and Anglo-Sikh wars in their distinct
  sequences, and separate Wellesley's Subsidiary Alliance from Dalhousie's Doctrine of Lapse.
```

### ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: The Company fiscal-military flywheel

```
BENGAL DIWANI -> predictable revenue and credit
REVENUE -> salaried sepoys + officers + artillery + supply
ARMY + INDIAN ALLIES -> serial victory against isolated opponents
VICTORY -> indemnity / ceded territory -> more revenue -> a larger military machine.
```

### ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Mysore resistance and four-war sequence

```
1767-69 FIRST -> Treaty of Madras; Haidar forces a negotiated peace
1780-84 SECOND -> Haidar dies 1782; Treaty of Mangalore restores conquests
1790-92 THIRD -> anti-Tipu coalition; Treaty of Seringapatam cuts Mysore
1799 FOURTH -> Tipu dies; Wodeyars restored under subsidiary dependence.
```

### ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Tipu: reform, diplomacy and bounded interpretation

```
STATE CAPACITY -> direct revenue, army reform, state commerce and strategic ports
DIPLOMACY -> Ottoman, Afghan and French contacts sought counterweights to Company power
LIMIT -> outreach did not create a dependable anti-British coalition
SAFE VERDICT -> real reform and resistance, neither caricature nor modern nation-state myth.
```

### ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Maratha confederacy and the cohesion problem

```
PESHWA at Pune -> nominal confederate centre
SCINDIA | HOLKAR | BHONSLE | GAEKWAD -> regional houses with separate interests
STRENGTH -> reach, cavalry, revenue claims and experienced commanders
WEAKNESS -> no durable common command; Company bargains and fights one house at a time.
```

### ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Three Anglo-Maratha Wars

```
1775-82 FIRST -> Raghunath Rao crisis -> Wadgaon reverse -> Treaty of Salbai
1802 BASSEIN -> Peshwa accepts subsidiary terms after Holkar's victory
1803-05 SECOND -> Scindia and Bhonsle defeated; Holkar resists and settlement follows
1817-18 THIRD -> Peshwaship abolished; Baji Rao II pensioned at Bithur.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Subsidiary Alliance dismantled sovereignty

```
BRITISH FORCE STATIONED -> ruler pays cash or cedes revenue territory
RESIDENT AT COURT -> continuous political leverage
NO INDEPENDENT WAR / DIPLOMACY / EUROPEAN EMPLOYMENT -> external sovereignty removed
RESULT -> protection without capacity; ruler bears blame for a state Britain constrains.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Alliance case sequence and consequences

```
HYDERABAD 1798/1800 -> French-trained force removed; dependence deepens
MYSORE 1799 -> restored Wodeyar state enters subsidiary control
AWADH 1801 -> territorial cession substitutes for enlarged subsidy
BASSEIN 1802 -> Peshwa's acceptance transforms a Maratha civil conflict into Company war.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Sindh and the northwest strategic corridor

```
INDUS COMMERCE + AFGHAN FRONTIER ANXIETY -> rising Company attention
1832 COMMERCIAL OPENING -> river navigation without military transport
1839 PRESSURE -> subsidiary obligations linked to the Afghan campaign
1843 MIANI + DABO -> Napier defeats the Amirs; Sindh is annexed.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Sikh strength, succession crisis and two wars

```
RANJIT SINGH -> consolidated Punjab + modernised Khalsa army
AMRITSAR 1809 -> Sutlej boundary stabilises Company-Sikh relations
POST-1839 -> court faction, rapid succession and army politicisation
1845-46 FIRST -> Lahore/Bhyrowal | 1848-49 SECOND -> Gujrat -> Punjab annexed.
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Awadh was annexed in 1856 on the stated ground of misgovernment, not under
  the Doctrine of Lapse; treaty, subsidiary control, conquest and annexation are not synonyms.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Lapse, title denial and misgovernment are distinct

```
LAPSE -> adopted heir not recognised -> Satara, Jhansi and Nagpur annexed
TITLE / PENSION DENIAL -> Nana Sahib's pension claim is not a territorial lapse case
MISGOVERNMENT -> Awadh annexed in 1856 despite a recognised ruling dynasty
EXAM RULE -> identify the legal pretext before naming the annexation policy.
EVIDENCE LIMIT: Campaign maps, treaty clauses, succession disputes and Indian alliance choices
  qualify any account of uniform British military superiority or passive regional defeat.
```

## ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Comparative answer spine and 1857 bridge

```
MYSORE -> centralised reform but diplomatic isolation
MARATHAS -> wide confederate power but fractured command
SIKHS -> strong army and state under Ranjit Singh; destabilised after 1839
1857 BRIDGE -> dispossessed rulers, taluqdars and soldiers add grievances, not one cause.
```